Beyond Average Effects: The Uneven Promise of Child Marriage Bans

Preliminary Version[*]

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Abstract

Child marriage remains widespread even though most countries have adopted a legal minimum marriage age of 18. Previous studies find that reforms rarely delay marriage on average, but evidence on how they affect women's life-cycle outcomes and how effects vary across contexts, remains limited. I study the causal effects of child marriage bans (CMBs), reforms setting 18 as the minimum marriage age without a parental-consent exception, combining WORLD policy data with Demographic and Health Surveys from 20 countries that adopted a CMB between 1995 and 2023. Using a regression discontinuity design based on birth-month eligibility, I estimate effects on marital timing and women's life-cycle outcomes, and how these vary across individual and country characteristics. I find that while CMBs are not effective on average, they do reduce child marriage in countries where its initial prevalence was low. I find evidence of similar, albeit weaker, effects in countries with low adolescent fertility or a pre-reform legal age close to 18, and among girls aged 16 and 17. Independent of marriage timing, CMBs also increase women's likelihood of marrying a more educated husband and reduce the justification of intimate partner violence. These findings suggest that CMBs can reinforce pre-existing social shifts but cannot independently alter well-established marital institutions.

Keywords: Child marriage; child marriage bans; regression discontinuity design; heterogeneous treatment effects; women's life-cycle outcomes; intimate partner violence
JEL Classification: C21, I26, J12, J13, J16, O15

[*]This is a preliminary draft of my Job Market Paper. The most current version can be accessed *here*. A declaration on the use of AI tools can be found in Appendix Section A

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1 Introduction

Child marriage remains widespread despite the global commitment to eliminating it by 2030 (UN General Assembly, 2015). Approximately 12 million girls under the age of 18 marry globally each year, corresponding to one girl every three seconds (UNFPA, 2026).[1] Beyond constituting a human rights violation (UN General Assembly, 2019), child marriage is a disruptive economic and social institution, capable of fundamentally reshaping girls' life trajectories. Early marriage is associated with lower educational attainment (Sunder, 2019), earlier and higher fertility (Wodon et al., 2016; Onagoruwa and Wodon, 2018), an elevated risk of experiencing intimate partner violence (IPV) (Kidman, 2016; Omidakhsh and Heymann, 2020), and reduced labour-force participation (Wilson, 2022). These consequences make child marriage more than a demographic outcome: it is an important constraint on women's human-capital accumulation and economic opportunities, with implications extending to households and societies more broadly.

In recent decades, governments have increasingly adopted legislation prohibiting child marriage, most prominently by establishing 18 as the minimum legal age of marriage, but evidence shows that these laws frequently fail to bind (Collin and Talbot, 2023; Batyra and Pesando, 2021). Crucially, it largely remains unknown under which socio-economic conditions child marriage bans (hereafter CMBs)[2] successfully constrain early marriage, and how they reshape women's life-cycle outcomes beyond marital timing. Although some recent studies document that effects vary along a few dimensions, such as rural residence and CMB exposure (Collin and Talbot, 2023; Wilson, 2022), much about when CMBs bind remains unclear, including how their effectiveness varies with baseline child marriage and adolescent fertility rates. As the baseline prevalence of child marriage captures the extent to which a CMB departs from the prevailing marriage norm, understanding how it affects policy effectiveness is crucial to anticipate when a CMB can have the intended protective effect. Addressing these questions also speaks to a central debate in development and gender economics regarding when legal reforms generate behavioural change, offering insights for designing policies adapted to local institutional and socio-economic realities.

In this paper, I exploit reform-specific age cutoffs in a regression discontinuity design (RDD) across 20 countries. My results suggest that CMB legislation cannot unilaterally alter marriage practices shaped by broader socio-economic conditions, but it can reinforce social change that is already underway where child marriage is comparatively rare. This highlights the importance of context-sensitive policy design and local ownership. More broadly, the results inform the debate on when legal reforms generate behavioural change, suggesting that laws are most effective as a complement to, rather than a substitute for, underlying socio-economic change.

My analysis reveals four main findings. *First*, CMBs do not decrease child marriage on

[1] Although child marriage affects both boys and girls, this paper focuses on girls and women, who are six times more likely to marry before adulthood and disproportionately bear its adverse effects (UNFPA, 2026).

[2] I define CMBs as legislative reforms that establish 18 years as the minimum legal age of marriage for women irrespective of parental consent.

average. This null result is robust to alternative bandwidths, functional-form choices, and a coarser yearly running variable, and consistent with existing evidence (Collin and Talbot, 2023; Batyra and Pesando, 2021).

However, *second*, CMB eligibility reduces child marriage in settings where it was already less prevalent. I find a large, statistically significant effect of 6.8 percentage points on the probability of marrying as a minor in countries with a low pre-reform child marriage rate, a relative reduction of about 39%. I find similar albeit smaller, suggestive effects in countries where adolescent fertility was low and where the previous legal minimum age of marriage was already 16 or 17, with reductions of 2.1 and 2.9 percentage points respectively.[3] In countries with no prior minimum legal marriage age, I find an unanticipated increase in child marriage, this estimate is however unstable.[4] By contrast, I find no systematic heterogeneity by individual characteristics or by regime type, government effectiveness, or rule of law.

Third, CMBs seem to delay marriage among women just below the new legal age. While the effect at age 18 is null on average, I find suggestive evidence that CMBs delay marriage at ages 16 and 17, raising the probability of not being married by 1.5 percentage points at each age.[5] This suggests that CMBs may have the potential to delay marriage among cohorts just below the new legal age, even where they fail to do so at 18 itself.

Fourth, CMBs shape marriage markets even when they do not delay marriage. CMB eligibility is associated with a significant increase in husbands' educational attainment and a reduction in the justification of IPV. These effects emerge even in the full sample, where the average effect of eligibility on marriage timing is null, indicating that legal reform can reshape marriage markets and household bargaining through channels other than solely delayed marriage itself, for instance, by altering who is considered an eligible partner once the legal minimum age rises or by shifting social norms around IPV. In contrast, I find no effects on the respondent's fertility, education, decision-making, or employment.

Existing studies of child marriage legislation fall into two strands, mostly estimating average effects across or within countries, reporting small or null effects. One strand of literature focuses on the effectiveness of CMBs in reducing the incidence of marriage before the age of 18 (Batyra and Pesando, 2021; Collin and Talbot, 2023). A second strand evaluates the effects of CMBs and of child marriage itself on women's subsequent life trajectories, including early childbearing (Kidman et al., 2024; Kim et al., 2013; Maswikwa et al., 2015; Rokicki, 2021), attitudes toward IPV (Omidakhsh and Heymann, 2020), educational attainment and employment (Wilson, 2022), and infant mortality (Le et al., 2025).[6] Sample sizes range from single-country case studies (e.g.,

[3] I treat these as suggestive as while significant, they do not survive controlling for multiple hypothesis tests.

[4] An increase of 3.7 percentage points, significant uncorrected but not after correction for multiple testing. It also sign reverses depending on which single country is excluded from the subsample. I thus do not interpret this as evidence of a genuine backfire.

[5] This is estimated in an extended 24-country sample with sufficient data at these younger ages. The effect weakens in the main 20-country sample, remaining only marginally significant at age 17 and losing significance at age 16. Placebo cutoffs at other ages show no significance.

[6] Table A1 gives an overview of the most relevant studies for this paper.

Bellés-Obrero and Lombardi, 2023, for Mexico; McGavock, 2021, for Ethiopia) to a maximum of 17 countries (Le et al., 2025; Wilson, 2022).

Within both strands of literature, evidence on heterogeneous treatment effects remains very limited. Existing work suggests that CMBs may be more effective in urban areas (Wilson, 2022; Collin and Talbot, 2023), in countries with higher average education (Collin and Talbot, 2023), and where the pre-reform legal minimum age was already closer to 18 (Wilson, 2022). However, this evidence is very recent and still narrow in scope, leaving almost nothing known about how effects vary along the many other individual and institutional characteristics plausibly relevant to whether a CMB binds. This matters because a null average effect can still conceal substantial variation across groups, precisely the information policymakers need to design context-sensitive policy and target enforcement effectively.

There are three main reasons for the gap between legal prohibition and continued prevalence of child marriage. First, laws are often inconsistently enforced. Collin and Talbot (2023) find that only around 10% of countries in their analysis show detectable enforcement. Second, legal prohibitions can shift marriages involving minors from formal into informal or customary unions, as recorded by Melnikas et al. (2021) for Malawi and Bellés-Obrero and Lombardi (2023) for Mexico. As a consequence, women would lose the legal rights associated with marriage. Third, many legal frameworks contain exceptions, most prominently allowing marriage below 18 with parental consent (Arthur et al., 2018).[7] Because parents are commonly involved in arranging child marriages, such provisions significantly undermine the effectiveness of the legal minimum age. This is precisely why the definition of a CMB excludes reforms that retain a parental-consent exception. Yet, weak formal enforcement does not imply that CMBs cannot change behaviour, as laws can also shift expectations and norms (see Section 2.2), which makes it an empirical question when and how they bind.

This paper contributes to the literature in four distinct ways. *First*, I construct what is, to the best of my knowledge, the largest cross-country dataset assembled to study the consequences of CMB legislation without parental-consent exception. The final sample covers 20 countries that implemented a CMB between 1995 and 2023, combining all available waves of the Demographic and Health Surveys (DHS) with the latest WORLD Policy Analysis Center (WORLD) (2023) dataset, not yet incorporated by existing cross-country evaluations, which rely on the 2013 or 2019 releases. This extends coverage beyond the 17-country maximum of prior cross-country studies (Le et al., 2025; Wilson, 2022), providing the statistical power and institutional variation needed for the heterogeneity analysis. To analyze the effects on girls aged 16 and 17, I additionally construct an extended sample of 24 countries by relaxing the restriction to age 18 used elsewhere in the paper.

Second, I provide a unified cross-country causal evaluation of CMBs, applying a consistent definition and econometric approach throughout. Existing quasi-experimental studies vary

[7] Other exceptions include the girl being pregnant or having given birth, religious or customary laws, and the approval of a court or similar entity (Arthur et al., 2018).

substantially in how they define a CMB, most prominently in whether they account for parental-consent exceptions.[8] This distinction matters: Kim et al. (2013) find that while CMBs without parental-consent exception significantly reduce adolescent fertility, those retaining such exceptions are indistinguishable from having no legal minimum age at all.

Studies also differ in their econometric approach, alternating between difference-in-differences and RDDs with considerable variation in bandwidth, clustering, and polynomial choice, limiting cross-study comparison and generalisability. This methodological heterogeneity alone can shift the picture starkly. For instance, Wilson (2022)'s difference-in-differences estimates show that CMBs increase age at first marriage on average. At the same time, Collin and Talbot (2023)'s discontinuity test finds detectable enforcement in only around 10% of countries, and Batyra and Pesando (2021)'s cohort-based design finds a decline in only two of six countries studied, a result itself sensitive to specification choices.[9]

I address both sources of inconsistency directly by applying a single CMB definition throughout and by identifying causal effects via an RDD around reform-specific age cutoffs, pooling reform-eligibility variation across the full sample rather than testing compliance with an existing legal minimum or comparing cohorts country by country. By prohibiting legal unions below age 18 and, to differing extents, penalising non-compliance (UNFPA and UNICEF, 2020), CMBs introduce a discontinuity in the costs of early marriage, which naturally lends itself to an RDD. Because compliance is imperfect, I primarily estimate intention-to-treat (ITT) effects of CMB eligibility and use a fuzzy RDD to scale them by the effect on marital timing where it is strong. Because eligibility is determined by birth timing relative to reform implementation, a running variable individuals cannot manipulate, this design isolates the policy effect from confounding regional and cohort trends. I implement the robust bias-corrected local-polynomial inference framework of Calonico et al. (2014) to adjust for non-parametric smoothing bias under a discrete running variable. Crucially, I extend the policy dataset to incorporate enactment months and combine these with month-level birth and marriage records. This monthly precision substantially improves identification around reform cutoffs relative to the annual eligibility measures standard in the literature.[10]

Third, I provide the most comprehensive evidence to date on treatment heterogeneity, extending well beyond the narrow set of margins already documented in the literature. Treating average effects as representative risks masking exactly the variation that determines when legislation binds. I therefore examine how CMB effectiveness varies with individual characteristics, including household wealth, education, religious affiliation, and rurality. I also examine country-level characteristics, including the baseline prevalence of child marriage, adolescent fertility, the size of the legal change, regime type, government effectiveness, and rule of law, moderators no

[8] See Appendix Table A1.

[9] See Section 5 for the full comparison of results.

[10] Only Batyra and Pesando (2021) similarly employ monthly timing in an RDD context. Collin and Talbot (2023) rely on a coarser annual measure due to reporting heaping. I use monthly data in my baseline specification, test for digit preference by country, and report results using an annual running variable as a robustness check.

existing study tests jointly or systematically.

Fourth, I test whether CMBs reshape women's life-cycle and marriage market outcomes even where they fail to delay marriage itself. Existing evidence on downstream effects is fragmented across studies with a single or only a few outcomes. I instead consider a comprehensive set of outcomes, spanning fertility, education, employment, decision-making, IPV justification and experience, as well as marriage-market outcomes such as spousal education and the age gap, within one framework. To do so, I rely primarily on ITT effects via reduced-form estimates, interpreting fuzzy local average treatment effects (LATE) only where the first stage is sufficiently strong. Thereby, I detect effects even where CMB eligibility does not reduce child marriage.

The remainder of this paper is organised as follows. Section 2 provides an overview of the institutional setting and conceptual framework. Section 3 describes the data employed in this analysis. In Section 4, I outline the empirical strategy, Section 5 presents and discusses the results, Section 5.3 presents robustness checks, and Section 6 concludes.

2 Background

2.1 Institutional Setting

The *Convention on the Rights of the Child* defines a child as every human being below the age of eighteen years (United Nations, 1989). Consequently, in this paper, child marriage refers to any marriage or similar union, such as informal or customary unions, entered into by a person below eighteen years. In 1995, governments articulated a global commitment to eradicate child marriage in the *Beijing Declaration and Platform for Action* (UN Women, 1995). The declaration explicitly targets forced and underage marriage by calling on governments to take legislative action.[11]

Since then, many countries have enacted legislation aimed at protecting minors from child marriage. As of 2023, 92% of countries had established 18 as the legal minimum age of marriage, a share that falls to 67% once parental-consent exceptions are taken into account (WORLD, 2023). The latter represents an increase of 19 percentage points, or 36 additional countries, relative to 2013 (WORLD, 2013). Globally, between 1999 and 2024, the share of women aged 20 to 24 who married before 18 declined by 6 percentage points, from 25% to 19%, while the share who married before age 15 fell by half, from 8% to 4% (UNICEF, 2025). Despite this progress, child marriage remains prevalent, with one in five women aged 20 to 24 worldwide still married before age 18 (UNICEF, 2025), with stark variation by region, with particularly high rates in Sub-Saharan Africa (31%) and Southern Asia (26%), compared to just 6% in Central Asia (UNICEF, 2025). This illustrates that CMB legislation does not need to be a binding constraint in actual behaviour, underscoring the empirical challenge central to this paper.

The potential consequences of not abiding by CMBs vary by country. While some countries

[11] Paragraph 274e: "Enact and strictly enforce laws to ensure that marriage is only entered into with the free and full consent of the intending spouses; in addition, enact and strictly enforce laws concerning [. . .] the minimum age for marriage and raise the minimum age for marriage where necessary" (UN Women, 1995)

solely set a minimum age without explicitly criminalising it, others enforce clear measures for perpetrators, including annulment of the marriage, warnings, fines, and imprisonment (UNFPA and UNICEF, 2020). As per international standards, it is never the minor that should face any form of punishment, but the parents, guardians, officials, or other adult person who was involved in carrying out the child marriage (UNFPA and UNICEF, 2020). For instance, in Benin any responsible adult relative may face both prison sentences of several years as well as a fine, and between 2019 and 2023, of 3,310 registered child marriages 3,063 received some form of intervention (CGRA, 2025).[12] Nonetheless, even though the minor bride does not face legal consequences, both refusing the marriage as well as reporting it may have socio-economic consequences for her, due to family rejection, social exclusion, stigma, or the mental distress of having caused legal action against family members.

Similarly to the potential consequences, the social norms around child marriage also differ across contexts. While studies show that child marriage is more common when parents and communities support it, internalised norms do not necessarily equal social pressure to marry before adulthood (Psaki et al., 2021). For instance, Steinhaus et al. (2019) find that while in a region with a high child marriage rate in Malawi the empirical expectation for women in their community to marry before age 18 is very high (89%), the normative expectation to do so is significantly lower (53%). Taken together, this continued prevalence of child marriage paired with the variation in enforcement and socio-economic contexts underscores the need to understand when CMBs effectively delay marriage to adulthood, a global goal re-emphasised by Sustainable Development Goal (SDG) target 5.3, which seeks to eliminate child marriage by 2030.

2.2 Conceptual framework

The diffusion of CMBs has been driven largely by international norms and commitments such as the United Nations Committee on the Rights of the Child (CRC) and the Committee on the Elimination of Discrimination against Women (CEDAW), so that CMBs have also been adopted where marriage below 18 remained a common practice (Kim et al., 2013; Ebetürk, 2021). Economically, CMBs regulate a decision that is typically taken by parents, but whose consequences fall largely on daughters. Particularly in low-income households and where a bride price is customary, an early marriage can provide parents with a marriage payment, reduce the number of household members to support, and serve as informal insurance against income shocks (Corno et al., 2020; Corno and Voena, 2023). At the same time, early marriage frequently ends girls' schooling and thus reduces their human capital (Becker, 1964; Field and Ambrus, 2008), a cost borne mainly by the daughter herself. Since a minor cannot credibly commit to compensating her parents later for the costs of postponing her marriage, even altruistic parents may choose a marriage timing that is earlier than would be optimal for the family as a whole (Bergstrom, 1989; Baland and Robinson, 2000).

[12]The form of intervention was not defined. Since the passing of the CMB in 2004, different laws have defined different fine amounts and imprisonment lengths.

Child marriage can also persist as a coordination failure. In contexts where age at marriage signals a bride's quality, communities may remain in an early-marriage equilibrium even if all families would prefer and benefit from a delay, since no single family can deviate on its own without incurring a cost (Wahhaj, 2018; Buchmann et al., 2023). As a CMB applies to all families at once, it can in principle shift such an equilibrium. Crucially, weak formal enforcement therefore does not imply that no effect is to be expected: laws can act as focal points and signals of societal values (McAdams, 2000; Bénabou and Tirole, 2026) and anchor customary practice even where courts are rarely invoked (Aldashev et al., 2012), while enforcement itself relies partly on private reporting and is thus shaped by local norms (Acemoglu and Jackson, 2017).

The same mechanisms imply that CMBs bind only under certain conditions. Where a law is close to prevailing practice, private reporting and coordination reinforce it, whereas laws in strong conflict with prevailing norms may remain ineffective or even backfire (Acemoglu and Jackson, 2017; Aldashev et al., 2012), suggesting larger effects where child marriage is already less common and the legal change is moderate. By raising the expected age at marriage, CMBs may moreover affect premarital investments and matching, and thus whom women marry (Bergstrom and Bagnoli, 1993; Chiappori et al., 2009). The welfare effects of CMBs, however, are ambiguous. Given missing credit and insurance markets and limited alternatives, early marriage can be a rational response of families to the constraints they face (Corno and Voena, 2023), and a ban that removes this option without an adequate alternative may leave households worse off, as documented for child labour bans (Bharadwaj et al., 2020), or shift unions into informal arrangements without legal protection (Melnikas et al., 2021; Bellés-Obrero and Lombardi, 2023).[13] A CMB is therefore most likely to raise women's welfare where it corrects one of the failures described above and where viable alternatives to early marriage, such as schooling and employment opportunities, exist (Jensen, 2012; Baird et al., 2011; Bandiera et al., 2020). This paper does not estimate welfare effects, which depend on individual circumstances the data do not capture, but evaluates whether and where CMBs change marriage behaviour and a broad set of welfare-relevant outcomes, thereby identifying the settings in which the conditions for welfare gains are more likely to hold.

3 Data

3.1 Data Sources & Sample

To identify countries with a CMB, I utilise country-level data from WORLD (2023).[14] Based on primary legal sources, this dataset tracks whether marriage at a given age is legally permitted across all UN member states on an annual basis since 1995. Furthermore, and crucial for this analysis, it distinguishes between legal marriage age with and without parental consent. Because

[13] Governments have also justified exceptions to the minimum age with cases of elopement and premarital pregnancy, an argument that has been contested (Asadullah and Wahhaj, 2016).

[14] As exceptions for parental consent effectively legalise marriage below the stated minimum age, I define a CMB as a legislative change establishing a minimum legal age of marriage of 18 or older, irrespective of parental consent.

identification is based on age in months relative to CMB implementation, I extend the dataset by constructing a new variable capturing the month of enactment of each CMB within this sample. These enactment months are extracted from the original legislative sources.

As of 2023, 129 countries have set the minimum legal age of marriage at 18 years or older (WORLD, 2023). To identify the year of CMB implementation, I require longitudinal data at the year level, as otherwise I can only assess whether there was a change between the three available datasets dating from 2023, 2019, and 2013, without the possibility of assessing changes prior to 2013. This data is available for 114 countries, predominantly located in the Global South.[15] Within this subset, 53 countries implemented a CMB between 1995 and 2023, of which 45 are featured in the DHS.[16] Subsequently, I restrict the sample to countries with at least 36 months of birth-cohort coverage on each side of the cutoff, defined as the birth month of women who turned 18 in the month the CMB was implemented.[17] This yields a final sample of 20 countries.

The source of individual- and household-level data used in this empirical analysis is the DHS. It provides nationally representative datasets for 91 countries on a wide array of socio-demographic variables, including family planning, domestic violence attitudes, and poverty indicators (ICF, 2025). The data employed stems from the women's questionnaire, which includes responses from women aged between 15 and 49.[18] I restrict the sample to women aged 18 and above at the time of interview, since for younger respondents it cannot yet be known whether they will marry before turning 18.[19]

Table 1 provides an overview of the countries included in the analysis with their respective CMB implementation date, the cutoff birth cohort, the DHS rounds employed, and their share of the full sample. Besides the 20 countries included in the main sample, it also includes four additional countries that fulfil the data coverage requirements when considering effects on women aged 17 and younger. The cutoff cohort corresponds to individuals who turned 18 in the month of CMB enactment, thereby generating a discontinuity in eligibility for legal protection under the reform.[20] The majority of countries in the sample are located in Sub-Saharan Africa (14), with the remainder in West Asia and North Africa (2), South Asia (2), Central Asia (1) and Europe (1). Because Sub-Saharan Africa is also the region where child marriage remains most common

[15]This subset of countries excludes almost universally high-income countries, small states and microstates, similar to the DHS, with 95.6% of DHS countries included in the WORLD longitudinal subset.

[16]Following verification of CMB years using WORLD (2023) and supplementary legislation, Peru and Nigeria were excluded. Peru's cited CMB year could not be confirmed. Ley Nº 31945 instead set a CMB in November 2023, too recent for this analysis. Nigeria's 2003 national CMB is not adopted by nine states and coexists with parallel Sharia legal systems (Fang et al., 2024), preventing clear identification of eligible individual.

[17]The threshold corresponds to the median of the country-level MSE-optimal first-stage bandwidths, so that each included country has enough data to support its own optimal estimation window, rather than merely a nominal presence on both sides of the cutoff. This affects four countries.

[18]Where available, I use consistently coded datasets from the Integrated Public Use Microdata Series (IPUMS) (Boyle et al., 2024). The remaining datasets were downloaded and integrated manually.

[19]Without this restriction, respondents aged 15 to 17 could only be coded zero (if already married) or missing (if not, since it is not yet known whether they will marry before 18), never one, mechanically inflating the measured child-marriage rate and biasing cohort comparisons, since eligibility is itself defined by birth cohort.

[20]I define eligibility using age 18 rather than the pre-reform legal minimum, since several countries lacked a clearly defined minimum age prior to reform, and separately examine heterogeneity by the pre-reform minimum age.

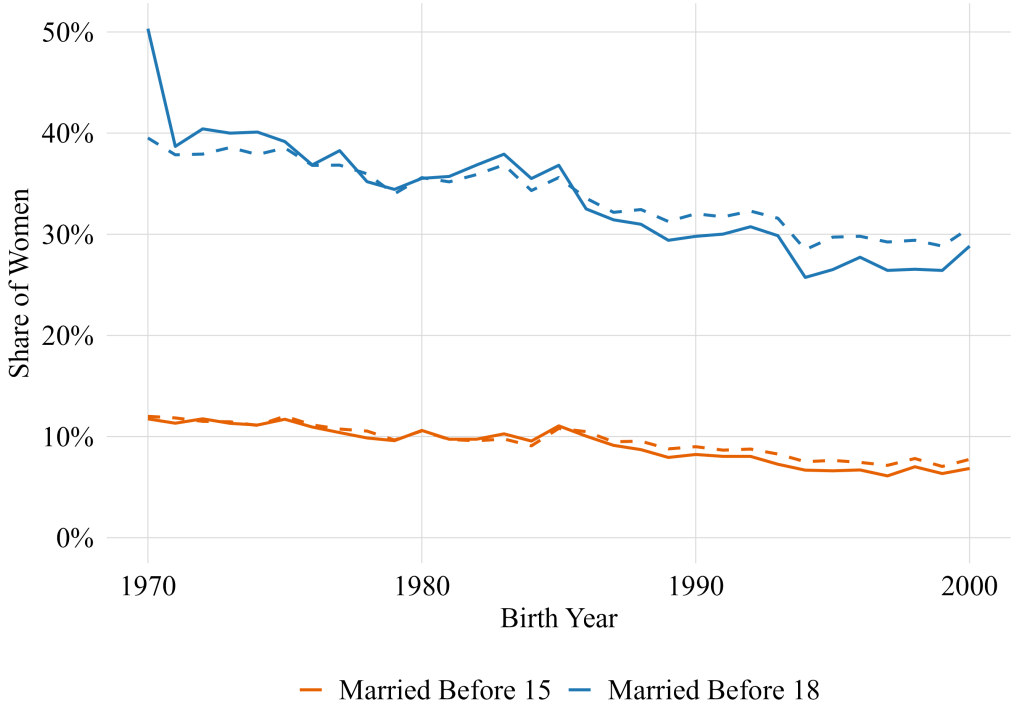
(UNICEF, 2025), the prevalence of child marriage in this sample is higher than the global average. Figure 1 depicts, by birth year, the share of women in the sample married before age 18 and before age 15, both declining steadily across cohorts, from around 50% to 30% and from 12% to 7% respectively. Figure 2 complements this by comparing marriage timing directly between women eligible and ineligible for protection under a CMB, restricting the sample to those born within three years of their country's cutoff so the two groups are drawn from comparably-aged cohorts. Eligible women are consistently less likely to be married at any given age than ineligible women, with the gap opening early and persisting through age 35.

Table 1: Sample Countries and CMB Implementation Dates

	Child Marriage Ban		DHS Survey Rounds		
Country	CMB Date	Cutoff Cohort	Oldest	Newest	% of Sample
Albania	May 2003	May 1985	2008	2017	2.32
Benin	Sep 2004	Sep 1986	1996	2017	6.83
Chad†	Mar 2015	Mar 1997	1997	2015	
Comoros	Jan 2002	Jan 1984	1996	2012	0.88
DR Congo	Jan 2009	Jan 1991	2007	2024	6.47
Egypt	Jun 2008	Jun 1990	1988	2014	7.78
Ethiopia	Jul 2000	Jul 1982	2000	2019	8.13
Gabon†	Oct 2021	Oct 2003	2000	2021	
Gambia	Jul 2005	Jul 1987	2013	2019	2.72
Ghana	Jan 1999	Jan 1981	1988	2022	5.13
Guinea	Sep 2008	Sep 1990	1999	2021	4.01
Jordan	Apr 2001	Apr 1983	1990	2023	9.66
Kazakhstan†	Jan 1999	Jan 1981	1995	1999	
Kenya	May 2014	May 1996	1998	2022	9.53
Liberia	Feb 2012	Feb 1994	2007	2019	2.39
Madagascar	Aug 2007	Aug 1989	1992	2021	8.41
Maldives	Jan 2001	Jan 1983	2009	2016	2.00
Mozambique	Dec 2019	Dec 2001	2003	2022	3.13
Namibia	Jul 1996	Jul 1978	1992	2013	3.64
Nepal	Sep 2002	Sep 1984	1996	2022	7.64
Sierra Leone	Sep 2007	Sep 1989	2008	2016	3.71
Tajikistan	Jan 2012	Jan 1994	2012	2023	3.39
Togo	Jul 2007	Jul 1989	1988	2017	2.23
Zambia†	Aug 2022	Aug 2004	1992	2024	

Notes: † featured in the extended sample only. CMB date refers to the date on which the minimum legal age of marriage for women irrespective of parental consent was increased to a minimum of 18 years. The cutoff cohort refers to the birth month of women who turned 18 in the month the CMB was implemented, the first cohort eligible for protection under the CMB. % of Sample is calculated over the 20 countries in the main sample only, and is therefore left blank for the four countries featured in the extended sample only.

Figure 1: Share of Women Married Before Age 18 and 15, by Birth Year



Notes: Share of women married before age 18 (blue) and before age 15 (orange), by birth year, in the full sample (20 countries, 615,771 women). Solid lines are weighted, dashed unweighted.

3.2 Child Marriage & Life-Cycle Outcomes

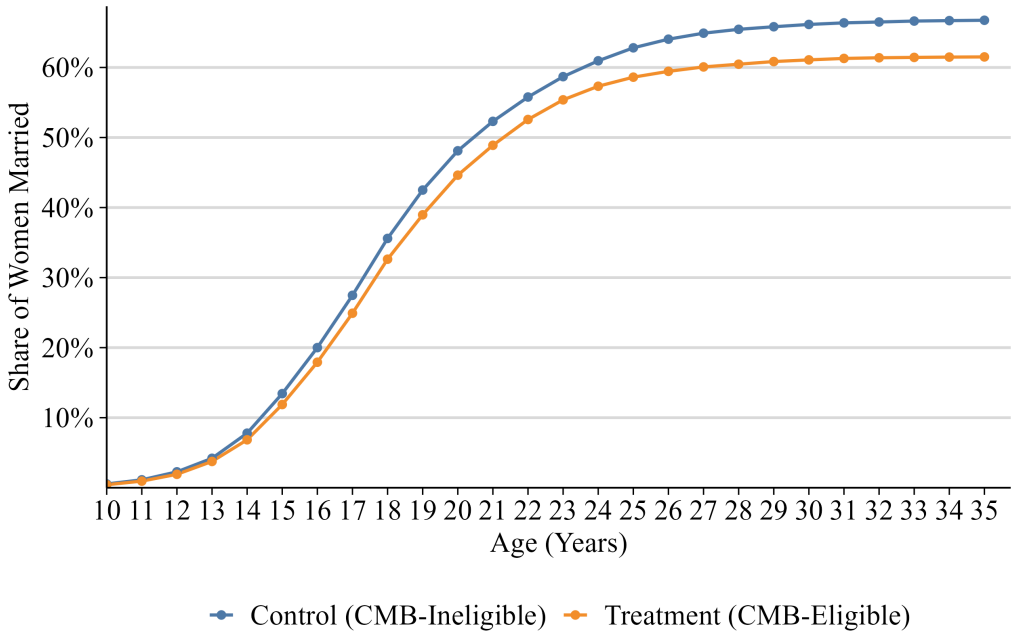
Marital Timing. To measure marital timing, I rely on the self-reported age at first marriage or cohabitation. As the DHS does not report whether a woman's first union was a formal marriage or informal cohabitation, this variable necessarily captures both together. While the DHS does record the type of a woman's current union, information on the type of her first union is available for only 2 of the 129 surveys used in this analysis, which is insufficient for a meaningful analysis.[21] The variable therefore captures union formation more broadly, including civil, religious, and customary unions as well as informal cohabitation, but potentially masks a substitution effect from formal to informal marriage. My main outcome is a binary indicator equal to one if a woman first married or cohabited at or after age 18, or has never married, and zero otherwise, so that a positive estimate indicates a reduction in child marriage. I use this binary indicator rather than continuous age at first marriage, since the latter is only defined for women who are currently or were formerly married and would exclude women not yet married at the time of interview. I test robustness using age at first marriage as the outcome instead (see Section 5.3).

Life-Cycle Outcomes. To assess the effect of CMBs on women's life-cycle outcomes, I consider the following variables, categorised into four panels.[22] Each life-cycle outcome is assessed primarily as the ITT effect of CMB eligibility, and additionally as the LATE for

[21] Among women currently in a union, 88.7% are married and 11.3% are cohabiting.

[22] See Table A2 for the respective DHS variable code, and descriptive statistics for the full sample and by treatment status.

Figure 2: Cumulative Share of Women Married, by Age and Eligibility



Notes: Weighted cumulative share of women married by each age, separately for the CMB-eligible (treatment) and CMB-ineligible (control) groups, restricted to a three-year bandwidth around each country's eligibility cutoff so the two groups are drawn from comparably-aged birth cohorts.

compliers, women whose marriage timing responds to eligibility (see Section 4). While existing evidence points to adverse average effects of child marriage on each of these outcomes, less is known about the effects of CMBs themselves, as discussed below.

Panel A: Fertility. Child marriage is associated with earlier childbearing (Wodon et al., 2016) and higher completed fertility (Onagoruwa and Wodon, 2018). As CMBs seek to reduce child marriage, they should mechanically delay the onset of fertility. For completed fertility, this mechanism is less direct, as even if the first birth occurs later, women could compensate by having children in closer succession thereafter. To test whether CMBs affect fertility, I consider two outcomes. First, *Total Fertility*, measured as the total number of children the respondent has given birth to as of the time of the survey, including children who have since died. Second, a binary indicator, *Birth After 18*, equal to one if the respondent's first birth occurred at or after age 18, so that a positive coefficient corresponds to a lower incidence of adolescent childbearing.

Panel B: Education and Employment. Research shows that child marriage is associated with lower educational attainment (Sunder, 2019) and reduced labour-market participation (Wilson, 2022). Early marriage may negatively affect schooling by imposing domestic responsibilities before girls complete their education. Consequently, CMBs should, by delaying marriage, raise educational attainment. However, this mechanism presumes that marriage timing itself drives the schooling decision, while it might also be the case that girls who never attended school or dropped out at an early age are more likely to marry early regardless of the legal minimum age, in which case CMBs would have no effect on educational attainment. Because women are already above primary-school age at the age-18 cutoff, I only assess effects on completing

secondary or higher education (*Secondary Education*, *Higher Education*), leaving secondary education, through remaining in school rather than marrying, and higher education, through pursuing a university degree, as the plausible margins. The reverse-causality concern above applies to both. Similarly, child marriage may constrain a woman's ability to engage in paid work, both directly through domestic responsibilities and indirectly through the education channel above, as reduced human-capital accumulation lowers the returns to, and likelihood of, labour-market participation (Becker, 1964). However, using an instrumental-variable strategy in India, Dhamija and Roychowdhury (2020) find that while delayed marriage raises education, it does not significantly affect labour market outcomes, attributing this null result to a backlash effect, whereby older brides face greater resistance from their husbands that offsets the labour-market gains otherwise expected from more schooling. I measure this outcome using a binary indicator, *Worked Last Year*, equal to one if the respondent engaged in any paid work outside the household in the past year.

Panel C: Decision-Making & IPV. Evidence suggests that reduces women's intra-household bargaining power and increases their risk of experiencing IPV. Tauseef and Sufian (2024) find that women who marry later have higher empowerment scores, while Kidman (2016) show that women who marry as children face an increased risk of experiencing IPV, with significant variation across countries. If a later age at marriage increases a woman's relative bargaining power within the household, CMBs should, by delaying marriage, reduce exposure to and acceptance of IPV. *Decision-Making* captures who usually makes household decisions, such as purchases or the respondent's own health care, across seven questions. Each response is assigned one point if the respondent decides alone, 0.5 if jointly, and zero if she is not involved, and the index is the average across all available answers. IPV attitudes are captured via *IPV Justification*, an indicator derived from five DHS questions on whether the respondent considers it justified for a man to beat his wife or partner in specific circumstances, such as arguing or burning food. The indicator captures the fraction of yes answers, ranging from 0 to 1. A higher value means greater justification of IPV. The variables that capture the personal experience of IPV stem from an optional module that is not available for all countries or survey rounds, resulting in a smaller sample size for these outcomes of approximately 22% of the full sample. The module contains eleven questions asking whether the respondent has experienced different forms of IPV, including emotional, physical, and sexual abuse. *IPV Experience* is an indicator capturing the proportion of experienced dimensions among all eleven IPV forms. To assess the potential differential effects on different dimensions of IPV, I further include indicators for three subcategories: *IPV Experience: Emotional*, *IPV Experience: Physical* and *IPV Experience: Sexual*.

Panel D: Marriage Market Outcomes. Evidence on how child marriage shapes partner selection is more limited than for the other panels considered here. Standard marriage-market reasoning suggests that women who marry later have greater agency in partner selection (Becker, 1973), so CMBs may affect not only the timing of marriage but also whom a woman marries through positive assortative matching (Chiappori et al., 2017), predicting older, better-educated,

employed husbands and a narrower spousal age gap.[23] However, using a reform-based design in Bangladesh, Tauseef and Sufian (2024) find that delayed marriage raises bargaining power without producing observably higher-quality spouses, suggesting the two need not move together, making this panel a complement to the previous panel. Husband characteristics are only observed for currently married women and reflect their current rather than necessarily their first husband. If CMBs mainly reduce the probability of marrying rather than change partner selection, this comparison is drawn on an endogenously selected subsample, so estimates here reflect sorting among women who remain married, not unconditional effects of the reform. Reassuringly, CMB eligibility does not predict the likelihood of being married by age 30 (coefficient ≈ 0, $p = 0.998$), suggesting no differential selection into the currently-married sample used for this panel. Accordingly, I assess whether eligible women marry more educated husbands, using a continuous variable ranging from 0 (no education) to 3 (higher education). I also include a dummy for each education level to disentangle these effects: husband has no formal education (*Husband: No Education*), completed primary education (*Husband: Primary Education*), completed secondary education (*Husband: Secondary Education*), or completed higher education (*Husband: Higher Education*). Whether CMB eligibility's effect on husbands' education is a favourable outcome for the wife is itself unclear, and existing evidence is divided on this. From a bargaining perspective, relative spousal education, a wife's education relative to her husband's, rather than either spouse's absolute level, is commonly used as a proxy for her intra-household bargaining power, so a widening gap in the husband's favour could plausibly signal reduced rather than improved standing for the wife (Frempong and Stadelmann, 2024). Conversely, more educated husbands are sometimes found to be less likely to justify or perpetrate IPV, consistent with a protective, more gender-equitable effect of male education, though this relationship is inconsistent across countries and can even reverse (Tsala Dimbuene et al., 2024), a status-threat pattern running in the opposite direction. Given this ambiguity, I do not take a stance on which mechanism dominates and instead let the data speak to the direction of the effect. Further, evidence suggests that women who marry before adulthood tend to marry significantly older men (Dommaraju, 2024; Pru et al., 2024). I therefore construct three binary indicators based on the age gap between the respondent and her current husband: *Age gap < 5 years*, *Age gap ≥ 5 years* and *Age gap ≥ 10 years*.[24] Lastly, I consider a binary indicator that captures whether the husband is currently working (*Husband Works*).

3.3 Heterogeneity Analysis

This subsection describes the individual- and country-level characteristics used to examine heterogeneity in CMB effects.[25] These subsamples test whether CMB effectiveness and

[23] Husband characteristics refer to different-sex couples only, reflecting the DHS survey design, which collects spousal information exclusively within the context of heterosexual marriage.

[24] Because the DHS reports information only on the current husband, this may bias the age-gap results downward, since women who married significantly older men may since have been widowed or remarried a younger husband.

[25] See Appendix Table A2 for individual-level and Appendix Table A3 for country-level descriptive statistics for the full sample and by treatment status.

downstream life-cycle outcomes vary systematically with individual characteristics and the institutional environment. All individual-level variables are measured at the time of survey, and all country-level variables refer to the year of CMB implementation unless otherwise indicated.

Individual-Level Heterogeneity. At the individual level, I first restrict the sample to ever-married women (*Ever Married*) to isolate the population for whom the treatment margin is actively binding. In other words, this subsample investigates whether among those women, who did marry at some point in their life, CMB eligibility delayed their marriage to adulthood. This includes all women who were ever married or living in union, including women who are separated, divorced or widowed. This restriction deliberately excludes women who potentially remain unmarried due to factors not related to the CMB.

Second, I construct the subsample (*Excluding Pregnancy-Driven Marriage*) for two reasons. First, some child marriage legislation exempts marriages linked to pregnancy or childbirth even where parental-consent exceptions are not allowed. Such marriages may therefore occur regardless of the CMB, and excluding them isolates the effect on the marriages the CMB is most likely to affect. Second, marriage can benefit children through greater parental resources (Kearney and Levine, 2017; Yan, 2025), so excluding these cases also removes marriages that may have mitigated the risks associated with an early pregnancy. Accordingly, using the month and year of first marriage and first birth, I exclude women whose first birth occurred within the 12 months preceding marriage or the first 8 months following it. This drops 10.3% of the full sample. Although this measure cannot perfectly identify marriages driven by pregnancy, it substantially reduces the likelihood that observed marriages were directly linked to a pregnancy or recent birth. I repeat all subsequent heterogeneity analyses for both the *Ever Married* and *Excluding Pregnancy-Driven Marriage* subsamples in Section 5.3.

Wilson (2022) shows that location matters for CMB enforcement. Using this paper's larger sample and unified estimation strategy, I test whether this finding still holds by distinguishing between women living in rural and urban areas (*Rural vs. Urban*). To assess whether CMB impacts vary by age, I stratify the sample into three roughly equally sized groups by age at survey: *Age 18–24*, *Age 25–34* and *Age 35+*. This allows me to assess separately the short-, medium- and long-term consequences of delayed marriage. A potential concern is that this stratification reflects differences in which countries implemented their CMB when, rather than genuine variation by age. This is not the case, however, since I pool all available DHS survey rounds, and each age subsample includes all 20 sample countries.

Osili and Long (2008) shows that higher education is associated with later marriage, while Ahonsi et al. (2019) find that girls who never attended school are more likely to marry as children than those who ever attended. Unfortunately, I do not observe the education level at the time of first marriage. Given the reverse causality underlying the relationship, I only consider primary education, as it is credibly pre-determined. Only 1.04% of women in the sample married before

age 12, a common benchmark for primary school completion.[26] Accordingly, I distinguish between women without and with completed primary education (*No Primary Education* / *Primary Education*). Additionally, because education does not necessarily equal learning (Pritchett and Beatty, 2015), I construct a binary indicator distinguishing individuals who can read a simple sentence from a flashcard from those who cannot (*Not Literate* / *Literate*).

Evidence shows that child marriage is often economically motivated (Corno et al., 2020; Anderson, 2007; Ashraf et al., 2020). To account for differences by wealth, I construct two binary poverty indicators from the respondent's DHS wealth index, which measures asset-based household wealth: splitting at the median (*Poor (Median)* / *Non-Poor (Median)*) and at the 75th percentile (*Poor (75P)* / *Non-Poor (75P)*). The 75th-percentile split better captures poverty in low- and middle-income countries, where wealth distributions are often skewed towards a small elite rather than a distinguishable middle class, by covering the bottom three-quarters of the population rather than only the poorer half (Ravallion, 2010). Each measure is constructed relative to the respective sample year and country.[27] Lastly, I split the sample by whether the respondent identifies as *Christian* or *Muslim*, the two prominent religions in the sample, as religious affiliation has been shown to shape fertility and family-planning behaviour (Heaton, 2011; Westoff and Bietsch, 2015).

Country-Level Heterogeneity. The prevalence of child marriage varies substantially by country (UNICEF, 2025). Legislation does not immediately change the underlying socio-economic context, and existing literature indicates that informal unions may replace formal ones once a CMB is introduced where child marriage is common, rather than preventing underage unions altogether (Bellés-Obrero and Lombardi, 2023; Melnikas et al., 2021). I thus hypothesise that CMBs have a smaller effect in countries with a higher pre-reform child marriage rate, as the perceived risk of non-compliance may be lower where the practice is relatively widespread. Thus, I classify countries into three groups based on the pre-reform share of women married before 18, constructed as the weighted mean among the five pre-reform cohorts within each country: 0-20% (*Low Child Marriage Rate*), 20-40% (*Medium Child Marriage Rate*), and above 40% (*High Child Marriage Rate*). I use round percentage thresholds rather than sample-specific terciles, since several countries' pre-reform rates cluster too tightly for a data-driven cutoff to be robust, and fixed thresholds are more easily interpretable and comparable across studies.

Following Wilson (2022), who similarly examines heterogeneity by the pre-reform legal minimum age, I consider the extent of legislative change by splitting the sample into three subsamples based on the previous legal age: *Previous Age 16/17*, *Previous Age 14/15* and *No Previous Age*. This allows me to assess whether the pattern observed by Wilson (2022) holds across this larger sample and unified estimation strategy. As child marriage is commonly

[26] By contrast, secondary school is typically completed around age 17 or 18, by which point 23.6% and 32.1% of women in the sample, respectively, had already married.

[27] Since wealth is measured at the time of the survey, it could in principle respond to eligibility. I find no discontinuity at the cutoff in the DHS wealth quintile (0.004, p=0.88), the within-survey standardised wealth score (−0.005, p=0.80), or either poverty indicator (Poor (Median) 0.001, p=0.94, Poor (75P) 0.001, p=0.95).

associated with higher adolescent fertility (Onagoruwa and Wodon, 2018), I split based on the adolescent fertility rate (*Low / High Adolescent Fertility*). This is constructed by splitting the sample at the cross-country median of the weighted mean among the five pre-reform cohorts.

Besides socio-economic conditions, the effectiveness of policy implementation also depends on state capacity, institutional quality, and governance (Besley and Persson, 2009, 2010). To capture this, I consider the following stratifications. First, I categorise countries into *Autocracies*, *Anocracies*, and *Democracies* based on their Polity Project Polity Score (Marshall and Gurr, 2020). This score ranks regimes on a 21-point scale from hereditary monarchy to consolidated democracy. Second, as a proxy for a state's economic capacity to enforce a new minimum marriage age I classify countries based on their GDP per capita in constant USD (World Bank, 2026) into *Low / High GDP per capita* countries. Subsequently, since enforcement of a legal reform depends on administrative and judicial capacity, not resources alone, I construct stratifications based on the World Bank Governance Indicators (Kaufmann et al., 2011): Government Effectiveness, capturing the quality of public service delivery, policy formulation, and implementation *Low / High Government Effectiveness*, and Rule of Law, capturing confidence in and adherence to contract enforcement, property rights, and the courts (*Low / High Rule of Law*). Finally, I stratify countries by their pre-existing primary school completion rate (World Bank, 2026), a pre-determined, country-level proxy for the education system's reach, distinct from the respondent's own schooling (*Low / High Primary Education Completion*), to further examine the established relationship between education and delayed marriage in this context (Osili and Long, 2008).[28]

4 Empirical Strategy

To estimate the causal effect of CMBs on marital timing and on women's life-cycle outcomes, I exploit the discontinuity in eligibility for protection under a CMB, comparing women who were just young enough to be protected by the reform with those who were just too old (Lee and Lemieux, 2010). Although governments can prohibit child marriage, they cannot perfectly ensure compliance, as informal and customary unions may still take place despite the prohibition of legal unions involving minors and the establishment of potential penalties (Collin and Talbot, 2023; Bellés-Obrero and Lombardi, 2023). Accordingly, I primarily estimate the effect of CMB eligibility on marital timing (1) and on life-cycle outcomes (2) as ITT effects, which correspond to the policy-relevant quantity. I additionally use eligibility as an instrument for marrying at 18 or later in a fuzzy RDD (3). This scales the ITT on life-cycle outcomes by the effect on marital timing and identifies the effect of delayed marriage for compliers, women near the cutoff who marry at 18 or later if eligible but before 18 otherwise. Although compliers are the women the CMB targets, they are a specific subpopulation, so the fuzzy estimate speaks only to them and is informative where the effect on marital timing is strong.

[28] The stratifications by GDP per capita, government effectiveness, and rule of law instead use each country's value from the year closest to its own reform year, split at the cross-country median of that single-year measure.

$$Married_{ijt}^{18+} = \alpha_0 + \alpha_1 Z_i + \alpha_2(B_{ij} - c_j) + \alpha_3(B_{ij} - c_j)Z_i + \alpha_k X_k + \mu_j + \lambda_t + e_{ijt} \quad (1)$$

Equation (1) estimates the effect of CMB eligibility on marital timing, where, following Batyra and Pesando (2021), $Married_{ijt}^{18+}$ is a binary indicator for the absence of child marriage. It equals one if individual i in country j, observed in DHS survey year t, reports that her first marriage or cohabitation occurred at or after age 18, or if she has never married, and zero if it occurred before age 18. The coefficient α_1 is the ITT effect of eligibility on this probability and is also the first stage of the fuzzy design introduced below. A positive coefficient thus indicates that eligibility delays marriage.

Eligibility is assigned by comparing the respondent's birth month to a country-specific cutoff, set so that eligible respondents had not yet turned 18 when the CMB took effect. Formally, $Z_i = \mathbb{1}[B_{ij} \geq c_j]$, where B_{ij} is the individual's month of birth and c_j is the country-specific cutoff birth month. The running variable is the month of birth centred relative to the country-specific cutoff, $B_{ij} - c_j$, so that the coefficient of interest, α_1, can be interpreted as the size of the discontinuity in the probability of marrying at 18 or later at the cutoff.[29] The specification includes an interaction between the centred running variable and the eligibility indicator Z_i to allow for separate linear trends on either side of the threshold, as recommended by Cattaneo and Titiunik (2022). All specifications include separate country fixed effects, μ_j, and survey-year fixed effects, λ_t, which account for time-invariant institutional differences across countries and global survey-year shocks, respectively. I also include two plausibly predetermined control variables, X_k. First, I control for whether the woman resides in an urban or rural area, as location has been shown to influence the enforcement of CMBs (Wilson, 2022). Second, I control separately for the respondent's religion, as it can shape gender norms and attitudes towards family planning (Makate and Makate, 2018; Turner and Götmark, 2023). Both of these control variables are also considered separately for the heterogeneity analysis.

$$Y_{ijt} = \gamma_0 + \gamma_1 Z_i + \gamma_2(B_{ij} - c_j) + \gamma_3(B_{ij} - c_j)Z_i + \gamma_k X_k + \mu_j + \lambda_t + v_{ijt} \quad (2)$$

Equation (2) estimates the corresponding ITT effect on each life-cycle outcome Y_{ijt}, regressing it directly on the eligibility indicator Z_i and using the same running variable, interaction term and fixed effects as (1). The coefficient γ_1 captures the effect of being eligible for protection under a CMB regardless of whether the individual's own marriage timing responded to the reform. Because γ_1 requires neither monotonicity nor the exclusion restriction to be interpreted causally, it remains valid even where the effect on marital timing is weak, unlike the fuzzy estimate in (3).

$$Y_{ijt} = \beta_0 + \beta_1 \widehat{Married}_{ijt}^{18+} + \beta_2(B_{ij} - c_j) + \beta_3(B_{ij} - c_j)Z_i + \beta_k X_k + \mu_j + \lambda_t + u_{ijt} \quad (3)$$

[29] As a robustness check, I additionally construct the running variable using year of birth rather than month, since birth month is more prone to recall error and heaping in DHS data. See Section 5.3.

Equation (3) is the fuzzy second stage, in which Y_{ijt} is regressed on the predicted probability of marrying at 18 or later, $\widehat{Married}_{ijt}^{18+}$, obtained from (1). β_1 identifies the LATE for compliers and equals the Wald ratio γ_1/α_1 when both are estimated on the same bandwidth, although each estimate here uses its own MSE-optimal bandwidth.

Estimation. Equations (1) to (3) are estimated using the robust bias-correction procedure of Calonico et al. (2014), implemented through local linear regression within a data-driven mean squared error (MSE) optimal bandwidth on each side of the cutoff.[30] Standard errors are clustered at the primary sampling unit level, the finest geographic unit available in the DHS. Survey weights are normalised within each country-survey cell so that every survey contributes equally to the pooled sample, regardless of its underlying size.[31] First-stage instrument strength is evaluated using the first-stage robust F-statistic against the conventional weak-instrument threshold of $F \geq 10$.

Although the marital timing outcome and the majority of life-cycle outcomes are binary, I estimate them using local linear regression rather than a parametric link function. Modelling a binary treatment-assignment probability as a linear function of the running variable imposes no additional restriction, since the function is otherwise unrestricted on each side of the cutoff (Lee and Lemieux, 2010). Given the large number of subsamples and outcomes considered throughout the results section, I additionally report Benjamini-Hochberg adjusted p-values, correcting for the expected share of false positives from testing many subsamples at once (Section 5.3).

Identification Assumptions. Identification of the ITT effects in (1) and (2) rests on the following two assumptions.[32] First, in the absence of the reform, both the conditional expectation of potential outcomes and the density of the running variable itself would be smooth through the cutoff. This fails if individuals are able to manipulate their recorded birth month and subsequently their eligibility status. While actual birth and marriage months are not manipulable, imputation of missing information as well as misreporting or recall bias in the self-reported DHS data is technically possible. I test for this directly using the manipulation test of Cattaneo et al. (2020), run both on the pooled sample and separately for each country. Heaping is detected in nine countries, but excluding them makes the estimated effect on marital timing larger rather than smaller, the opposite of what strategic manipulation towards eligibility would produce, and the first stage does not strengthen as a donut hole is widened around the cutoff, ruling out manipulation concentrated at the cutoff itself. Both checks point to a recall or imputation mechanism rather than intentional misreporting.

Second, since identification requires conditional expectations to be continuous at each country's own reform date, a confound coinciding with any single country's cutoff would bias that country's local estimate, and I check this directly with the leave-one-country-out analysis (Section 5.3). A confound biasing the pooled estimate systematically, rather than through

[30] Robustness to a CER-optimal bandwidth and a local quadratic specification is reported in Section 5.3.
[31] Robustness to instead scaling survey weights with each survey's own sample size is reported in Section 5.3.
[32] Detailed results for the respective tests can be found in Section 5.3.

one country, would additionally require coinciding independently with several countries' own idiosyncratic reform dates and affecting precisely the age cohort that was just eligible at each of them, which is unlikely given that these dates are staggered and unrelated to one another. I also check covariate balance at the cutoff as an indirect test.

Identification of the LATE in (3) additionally rests on the following three assumptions. First, the instrument must be relevant, resulting in a genuine discontinuous change in the probability of marrying at 18 or later, so that α_1 in (1) is not zero. Where the first stage is weak, I flag this explicitly and rely on the reduced form (2), rather than interpret the corresponding unreliable fuzzy estimate.

Second, monotonicity requires that crossing the eligibility cutoff weakly increases the probability of marrying at 18 or later for every woman, so that no woman is induced to marry earlier by becoming legally eligible for protection (Hahn et al., 2001; Imbens and Lemieux, 2008). This is plausible given the direction of the legal change, since a binding minimum-age law raises the cost of marrying before 18 and cannot lower it.

Third, the exclusion restriction requires that eligibility affects outcomes only through marrying at 18 or later. This is a strong assumption, since eligibility may also operate through other channels, such as partner selection or attitudes towards IPV, and the ITT effects I find where marital timing is unaffected suggest it may not hold. I therefore interpret fuzzy estimates cautiously and treat the ITT as my primary estimates. Under monotonicity and the exclusion restriction, the fuzzy RDD estimate identifies the LATE for compliers, the subset of women near the cutoff whose marriage timing responds to the reform, and not the average treatment effect for the full population.

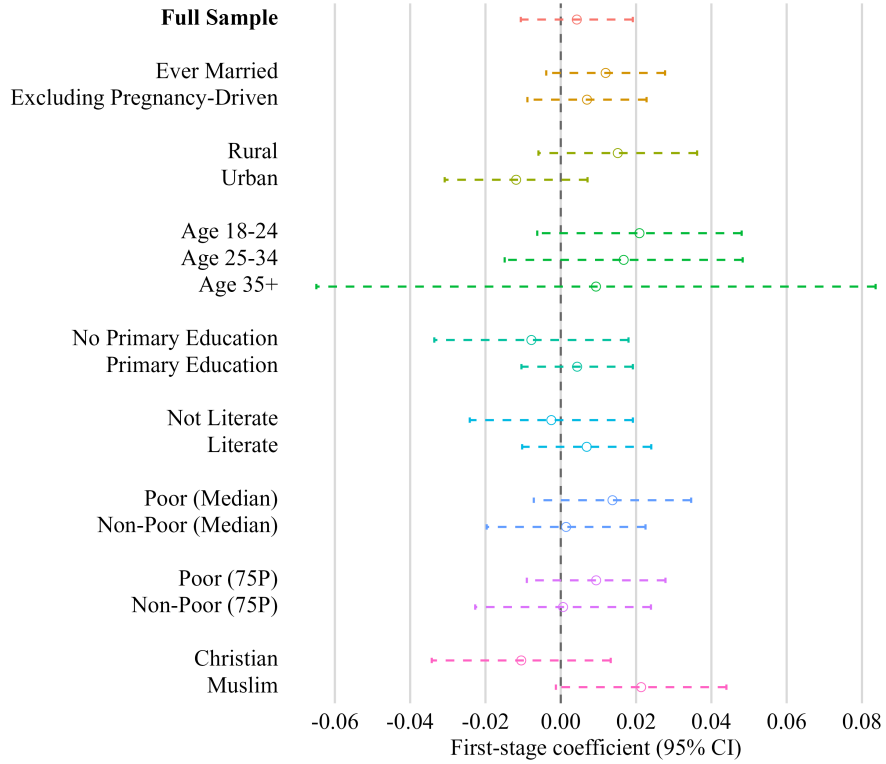
5 Results

5.1 Child Marriage Bans and Early Marriage

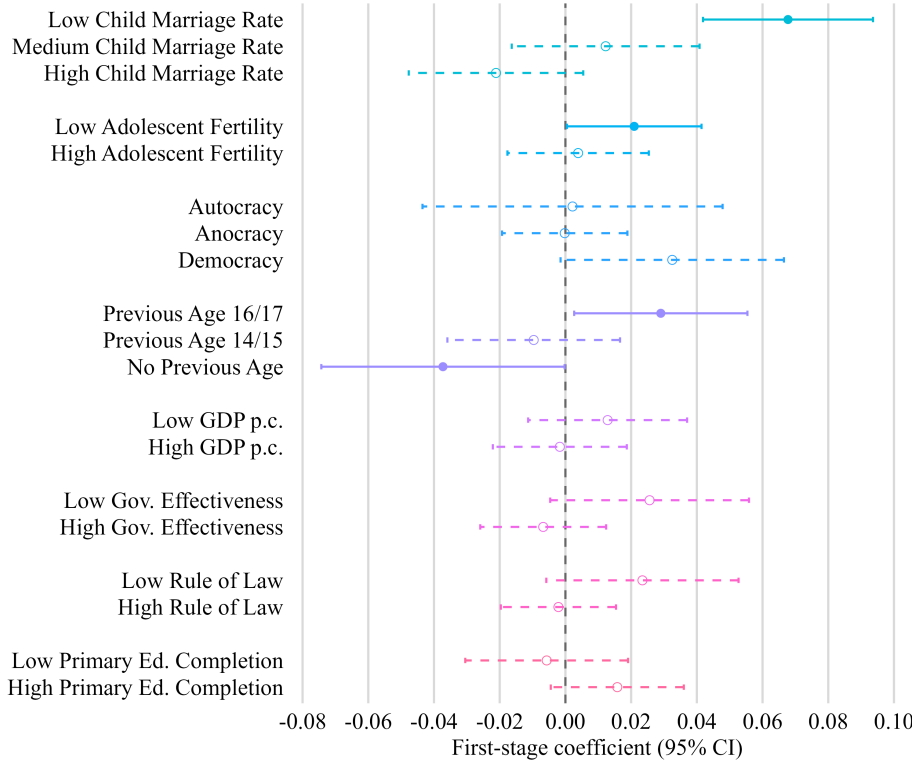
This section examines the effect of CMB eligibility, defined by birth month relative to the reform date, on marital timing, measured by the probability of not marrying or cohabitating before age 18, so that a positive estimate indicates a reduction in child marriage. This is the ITT effect in equation (1), which also serves as the first stage of the fuzzy design. While the main results are presented in this section, detailed robustness checks can be found in Section 5.3.

Figure 3 presents the effect on marital timing graphically for the full sample and across all heterogeneity dimensions, on the left for the individual-level subsamples, and on the right for country-level subsamples. Table 2 reports the estimates for the full sample and the four subsamples that are statistically significant uncorrected, alongside Benjamini-Hochberg adjusted p-values for each.

Figure 3: Effect of CMBs on Marital Timing: Heterogeneity



(a) Individual-Level Heterogeneity



(b) Country-Level Heterogeneity

Notes: Each point is the robust bias-corrected local-linear RD coefficient (Calonico et al., 2014) for the probability of not marrying before age 18 at the reform cutoff, estimated separately within each subsample. Horizontal bars are 95% confidence intervals. All regressions control for rural residence, religion, and country and survey-year fixed effects, and cluster standard errors at the primary sampling unit level. Solid lines and filled markers denote significance at the 5% level, dashed lines and hollow markers denote non-significance. The left panel reports the full sample and individual-level heterogeneity dimensions. The right panel reports country-level heterogeneity dimensions.

Table 2: Effect of CMBs on Marital Timing: Full Sample and Significant Subsamples

Subsample	Coefficient	SE	p-value	BH p-value	Mean	BW	N (Left / Right)
Full Sample	0.004	(0.008)	0.574	0.574	0.666	54.0	94,893 / 80,101
Significant After Correction for Multiple Testing							
Low Child Marriage Rate	0.068***	(0.013)	<0.001	<0.001	0.825	41.4	21,780 / 18,946
Significant Uncorrected Only (Suggestive)							
Low Adolescent Fertility	0.021*	(0.010)	0.045	0.398	0.790	46.7	38,947 / 31,464
Previous Age 16/17	0.029*	(0.013)	0.031	0.398	0.658	40.4	28,514 / 21,833
No Previous Age	-0.037*	(0.019)	0.049	0.398	0.682	44.5	12,151 / 12,074

Notes: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05, + p<0.1. Robust bias-corrected local-linear RDD coefficients for not marrying before age 18, estimated at the reform cutoff using Calonico et al. (2014). Robust standard errors (SE) in parentheses, clustered at the primary sampling unit level. BH is the Benjamini-Hochberg adjusted p-value, to account for multiple-hypotheses testing. Control Mean is the weighted mean of the outcome among untreated-side observations within the estimation bandwidth. All regressions control for rural residence, religion, and country and survey-year fixed effects.

Full Sample. In the full pooled sample, CMB eligibility has no perceptible effect on child marriage, with the coefficient being small and statistically indistinguishable from zero. This null result matches Wilson (2022), whose difference-in-differences design across 17 countries, using a continuous measure of local ban intensity, also finds no significant average effect on the probability of marrying before 18, and is consistent with Collin and Talbot (2023), who find detectable enforcement in only around 10% of countries, and Batyra and Pesando (2021), who find no decline in child marriage following the reform in four of six countries studied. However, this null average effect masks substantial country-level heterogeneity.

Low Child Marriage Rate. In countries with a pre-reform child marriage rate below 20%, CMB eligibility raises the probability of not marrying before age 18 by 6.8 percentage points, relative to a control mean of 0.825, significant at the 0.1% level and the only one among the significant subsamples that survives correction for multiple testing. The result is robust to the CER-optimal bandwidth, fixed bandwidths, and a local quadratic specification. However, leave-one-out checks show that this result is disproportionately driven by Tajikistan. TThe effect also loses significance when the running variable is collapsed to years rather than months (0.004, p=0.81). This underlines the importance of monthly variation for identification, as annual cohorts pool eligible and ineligible women born in the same year and can blur a discontinuity concentrated at the exact reform date, but it also means that the result depends on this finer timing.

In countries with a pre-reform child marriage rate below 20%, CMB eligibility raises the probability of not marrying before age 18 by 6.8 percentage points, relative to a control mean of 0.825, significant at the 0.1% level and the only one among the significant subsamples that survives correction for multiple testing. The result is robust to alternative bandwidths and functional forms, but leave-one-out checks show it is driven disproportionately by one country. Excluding Tajikistan reduces the coefficient to essentially zero, while the effect remains significant

under exclusion of any other country in the subsample. This should be borne in mind when interpreting the magnitude of this estimate.

Low Adolescent Fertility. A smaller effect is detectable in settings characterised by low adolescent fertility, where CMBs raise the probability of delaying a first marriage or cohabitation to adulthood by 2.1 percentage points, relative to a control mean of 0.789, significant at the 5% level. This result, however, should be read as suggestive rather than a confirmed effect. While it holds under a local quadratic specification, it is not robust to bandwidth choice, losing significance under the CER-optimal bandwidth and under fixed bandwidths more generally. Leave-one-out checks further show it is sensitive to sample composition, holding only once Ghana is excluded from the subsample. It also does not survive the Benjamini-Hochberg correction.

Previous Age 16/17. In countries where the previous legal minimum marriage age was just below 18, CMB eligibility raises the probability of not marrying before age 18 by 2.9 percentage points, relative to a control mean of 0.657, significant at the 5% level. This result, again, should be read as suggestive rather than robust, as it does not survive correction for multiple testing. Further, while it does hold under the CER-optimal and wider fixed bandwidths, it is not robust to a local quadratic specification or narrower fixed bandwidths. It is also sensitive to sample composition, remaining significant under exclusion of three of the nine countries in the subsample, and is most sensitive to Albania.

No Previous Age. Where no previous minimum age existed, eligibility is associated with an increased probability of 3.7 percentage points of marrying before age 18, significant at the 5% level, indicating at first glance a backfire effect of the abrupt legislative change. This result, however, holds only under a fixed bandwidth of ten years. It does not hold under a local quadratic specification, the CER-optimal bandwidth, or narrower fixed bandwidths, and it does not survive the Benjamini-Hochberg correction either. It is also highly unstable in sample composition, with the sign reversing entirely when Maldives is excluded. Therefore, I do not treat this as a genuine backfire.

Across the remaining subsamples, which stratify the sample by individual-level characteristics such as location, wealth, education and religion, as well as country-level institutional and demographic dimensions, the first stage is uniformly insignificant. These results contrast with two heterogeneity results already established in the literature. Both Wilson (2022) and Collin and Talbot (2023) find CMBs more effective in urban areas, and Collin and Talbot (2023) additionally finds greater effectiveness in countries with higher average education. I find no significant first-stage heterogeneity by either rurality or education anywhere in this sample.

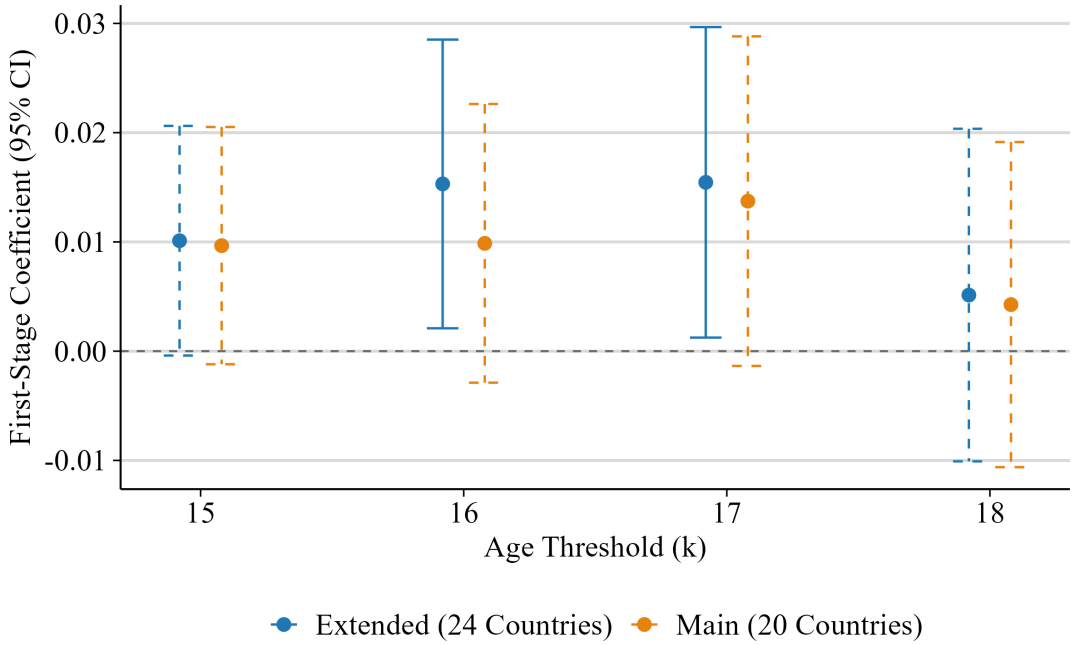
Taken together, these results indicate that CMBs have the clearest potential to alter marital timing where child marriage was already comparatively rare before the reform, rather than attempting to change a well-established and highly common marital institution. The suggestive patterns in low-adolescent-fertility and countries with a previous legal age of just below 18 point in the same direction but do not meet the same robustness bar. In other words, CMBs seem most likely to succeed when they accompany social change already underway rather than attempting

to shift a well-established social institution through legislation alone.

Effect by Age Cohort. The results above investigate whether CMB eligibility shifts marriage probability by age 18, the new legal minimum age of marriage. A separate question is whether the same eligibility delays marriage at younger ages even where it does not, on average, delay marriage by age 18. For this purpose, I include, for each age threshold, only respondents who have already reached that age. This allows the inclusion of four additional countries that now have sufficient observations on each side of the cutoff. For comparability with the main sample, I additionally provide results for the main sample of 20 countries.

Table A5 presents the respective results of CMB eligibility on the probability of not being married at ages 15 to 18, as well as at ages 20, 25 and 30, for both the extended 24-country sample and the main 20-country sample. Figure 4 presents this graphically. While the effect at age 18 itself, and at ages 20 and beyond, remains indistinguishable from zero throughout, I observe a significant positive effect at both ages 16 and 17 of 1.5 percentage points in the extended sample, as well as a marginally significant effect at age 15. Within the main sample, the coefficients remain similar in size. The marginal effect at age 15 persists, but the effect at age 16 loses statistical significance, and age 17 remains only marginally significant. This indicates that while CMBs do not delay marriage at the new legal age of 18 itself, they may have the potential to delay marriage among cohorts just below this age. However, this effect is sensitive to the four additional countries that enter the sample once the age floor is relaxed below 18.

Figure 4: Effect of CMBs on Not Marrying Before Ages 15 to 18



Notes: Robust bias-corrected coefficients with 95% confidence intervals. Treatment is fixed at the true eligibility cutoff. Blue is the extended 24-country sample, orange the main 20-country sample. Solid lines and filled markers denote significance at the 5% level, dashed lines and hollow markers denote non-significance.

Re-estimating the effect at ages 16 and 17 across the same subsamples used for the main

first-stage results shows a substantially larger number of subsamples reaching significance in the extended sample than in the main sample, with limited overlap in which subsamples drive significance in each.[33] A small number of subsamples are consistent and significant in both samples at both ages, including rural residence, exclusion of pregnancy-driven marriage, and low GDP per capita.

The most notable instance of instability concerns countries where no previous minimum marriage age existed. At age 17, this subsample is highly significant in both samples, but with opposite signs, corresponding to a 7.5 percentage-point decline in the extended sample and an 11.0 percentage-point increase in the main sample. As this reversal follows entirely from a change in country composition rather than from any leave-one-out exclusion within a fixed sample, it indicates that country-level heterogeneity at ages 16 and 17 should be interpreted with caution, and reinforces the earlier conclusion that the corresponding result for this subsample at age 18 does not constitute evidence of a genuine backfire effect.

This pattern is worth reading alongside Wilson (2022), who finds a robust positive average effect on continuous age at marriage despite finding, like this paper, no significant average effect on the probability of marrying before 18. A continuous outcome, or a lower age threshold as used here, can pick up marginal delays that a single binary cutoff at 18 misses, without the underlying delay needing to be large or stable enough to shift whether a girl marries before 18 at all. Read together, the evidence across both papers points toward the same modest, uneven story. CMB eligibility may nudge marriage timing at the margin for some cohorts and countries, but this falls well short of preventing child marriage outright.

5.2 Child Marriage Bans and Life-Cycle Outcomes

This section investigates effects of CMB eligibility on women's life-cycle outcomes across the four panels discussed in Section 3.2. I report reduced-form ITT estimates as the primary specification. As the previous section established that the effect of eligibility on marital timing is on average and across most subsamples statistically insignificant and weak ($F<10$), scaling the reduced form by it would yield an unreliable, and potentially misleading, LATE, since under a weak instrument two-stage least squares estimates are biased towards OLS and have poor finite-sample properties (Bound et al., 1995). Every magnitude and significance level discussed below refers to the ITT effect rather than to any implied LATE. Full results for each life-cycle outcome, including reduced-form and fuzzy RD estimates, can be found in Appendix Table A8 to Appendix Table A27.

Given the number of outcomes and subsamples considered throughout this section, some individual findings could arise from chance alone. I address this by reporting Benjamini-Hochberg adjusted p-values for every reduced-form estimate, correcting for multiple testing within each

[33] Full results in Appendix Table A6 and Appendix Table A7.

outcome across subsamples.[34]

Table 3 presents reduced-form estimates of CMB eligibility on life-cycle outcomes for the full sample and Figure 5 graphically depicts effects across the full sample and the three headline samples, low child marriage rate, low adolescent fertility, and previous legal age of 16 or 17, using normalised reduced-form coefficients in standard deviation units for each outcome, so that magnitudes and significance can be compared across outcomes measured on different scales. The full-sample averages again mask important heterogeneity within subsamples, and, notably, not only in those where eligibility affects marital timing. In the subsamples where eligibility reduced child marriage, effects on life-cycle outcomes are mixed, with the clearest improvement being a lower justification of IPV in low-child-marriage-rate countries. The following paragraphs provide an overview of the results by panel.

Panel A: Fertility. On average, CMB eligibility has no significant effect on total fertility or on the probability of the first birth not occurring before age 18. In the low-adolescent-fertility subsample, however, eligible women are 2.5 percentage points more likely to have their first birth after 18, against a control mean of 0.63. This is significant at the 5% level uncorrected but does not survive the Benjamini-Hochberg correction, and should be read as suggestive rather than confirmed. Leave-one-out checks show this result holds under exclusion of 8 of the 10 countries in the subsample, and is most sensitive to Ghana. The full-sample null itself is less clear-cut than it first appears. It turns significant under exclusion of 12 of 20 countries individually, most notably Guinea, indicating that the pooled zero reflects offsetting country-level effects rather than a uniform absence of any effect. This outcome also shows a broader pattern across the sample. Restricting to the 32 subsamples where the first stage itself is statistically indistinguishable from zero, births after age 18 is significant in 12 of them, well above the 1.6 significant subsamples one would expect from chance alone at the 5% level across 32 tests, so this effect is not confined to subsamples with a credible instrument.

Panel B: Education and Employment. I find no significant effects on completed secondary or higher education, or on employment in the past year, and none of the subsamples with a significant first stage show a deviation from this pattern. Leave-one-out checks confirm that this null is robust for both years of education and employment in the full sample, with exclusion of any single country never producing a significant effect for either outcome. Across the full set of subsamples, only 8 of 156 tests for this panel's outcomes reach significance at the 5% level, in line with chance alone, so this null extends well beyond the full sample.

Panel C: Decision-Making & IPV. This panel yields the clearest full-sample result. CMB eligibility reduces the justification of IPV by 2.1 percentage points, significant at the 0.1% level and robust to the Benjamini-Hochberg correction, while intra-household decision-making power

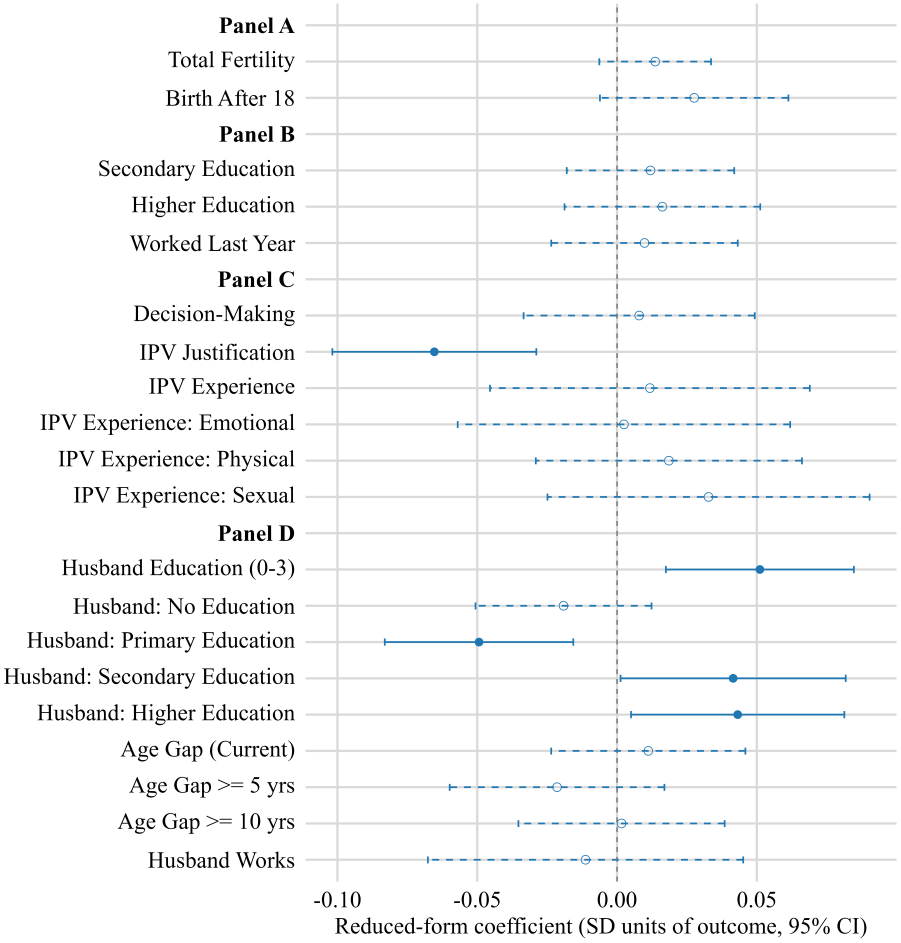
[34]The findings on IPV justification and husband's education, in the full sample and in the low-child-marriage-rate subsample, and on physical IPV experience in the previous-legal-age-16/17 subsample, remain significant after this correction. The weaker single-star subsample findings on births after age 18, decision-making, emotional IPV experience, and the spousal age gap do not survive correction and are read as suggestive rather than confirmed throughout this section.

Table 3: Reduced-Form Effects on Life-Cycle Outcomes: Full Sample

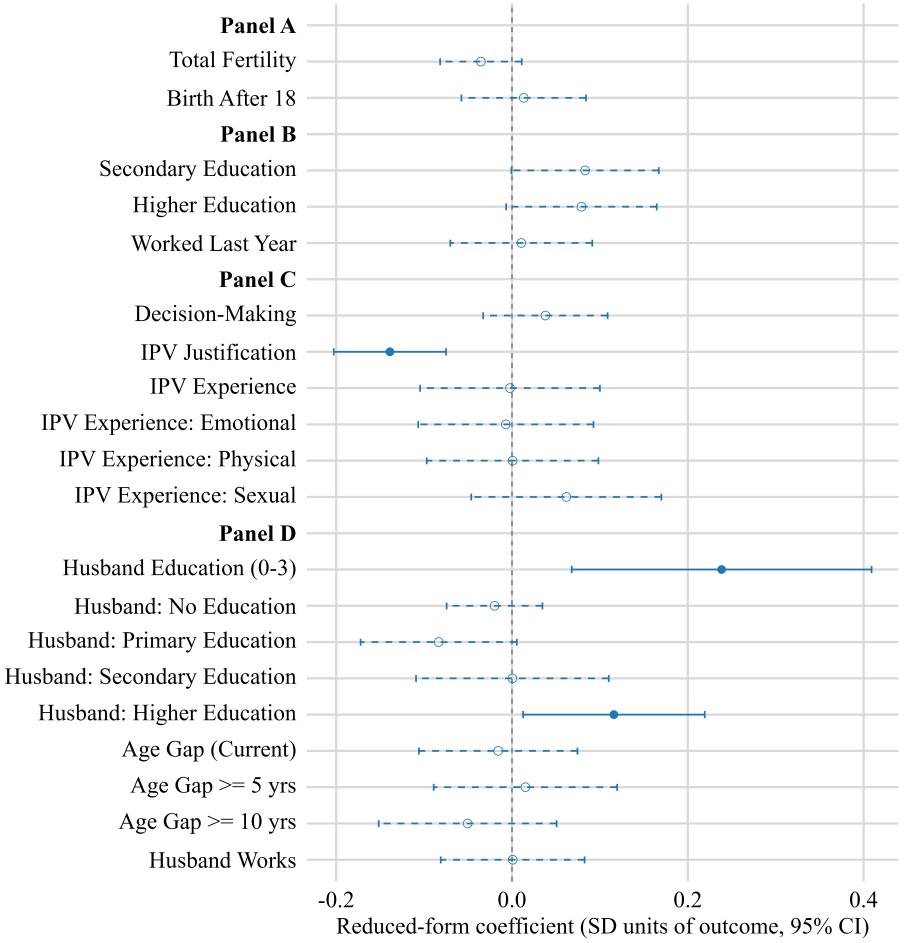
Outcome	Estimate	Control Mean	Bandwidth	N
Panel A: Fertility				
Total Children	0.031 (0.023)	2.08	49.4	181,145
Births After Age 18	0.014 (0.009)	0.53	42.6	145,215
Panel B: Education and Employment				
Completed Secondary Education	0.005 (0.006)	0.21	59.5	210,171
Completed Higher Education	0.005 (0.005)	0.09	61.3	215,956
Worked Last Year	0.005 (0.008)	0.59	53.5	160,957
Panel C: Decision-Making & IPV				
Decision-Making (Empowerment)	0.002 (0.006)	0.44	43.2	103,015
IPV Justification	-0.021*** (0.006)	0.19	27.6	101,330
IPV Experience	0.002 (0.006)	0.12	57.1	47,409
IPV Experience: Emotional	0.001 (0.009)	0.16	58.9	48,169
IPV Experience: Physical	0.004 (0.006)	0.11	77.3	62,302
IPV Experience: Sexual	0.007 (0.007)	0.06	50.8	41,672
Panel D: Marriage Market Outcomes				
Husband Education Level	0.051** (0.017)	1.41	49.0	117,729
Husband Education: None	-0.008 (0.007)	0.25	56.4	134,255
Husband Education: Primary	-0.021** (0.007)	0.21	52.9	124,658
Husband Education: Secondary	0.020* (0.010)	0.41	43.6	104,783
Husband Education: Higher	0.014* (0.006)	0.12	65.2	154,216
Spousal Age Gap (Current)	0.077 (0.122)	6.92	50.8	118,254
Spousal Age Gap >= 5 yrs	-0.011 (0.010)	0.60	54.4	127,787
Spousal Age Gap >= 10 yrs	0.001 (0.008)	0.25	53.0	123,012
Husband Works	-0.003 (0.008)	0.92	54.3	52,719

Notes: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05, + p<0.1. Estimates are robust bias-corrected reduced-form RD coefficients (SE in parentheses) of CMB eligibility on each outcome, using Calonico et al. (2014), for the full sample. Control Mean is the weighted mean of the outcome among untreated-side observations within the estimation bandwidth (BW, in months). N is total effective observations. Robust standard errors clustered at the primary sampling unit level in parentheses.

Figure 5: Standardised Reduced-Form Life-Cycle Effects: Full Sample and Headline Subsamples

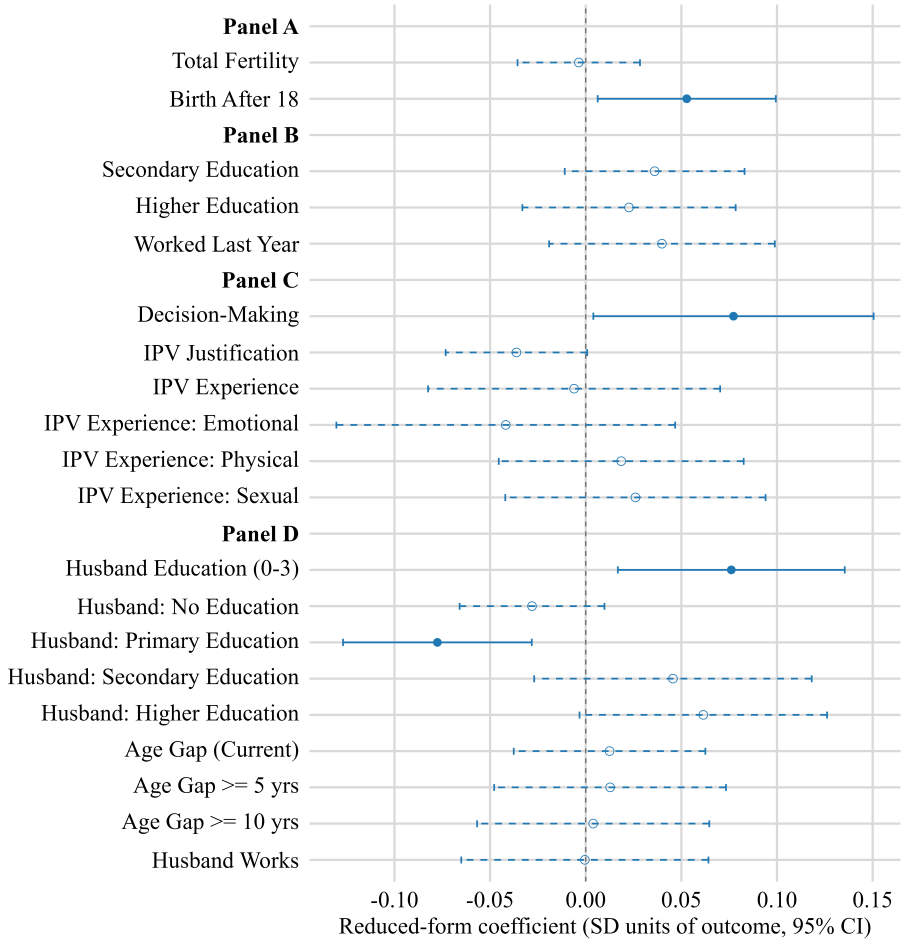


(a) Full Sample

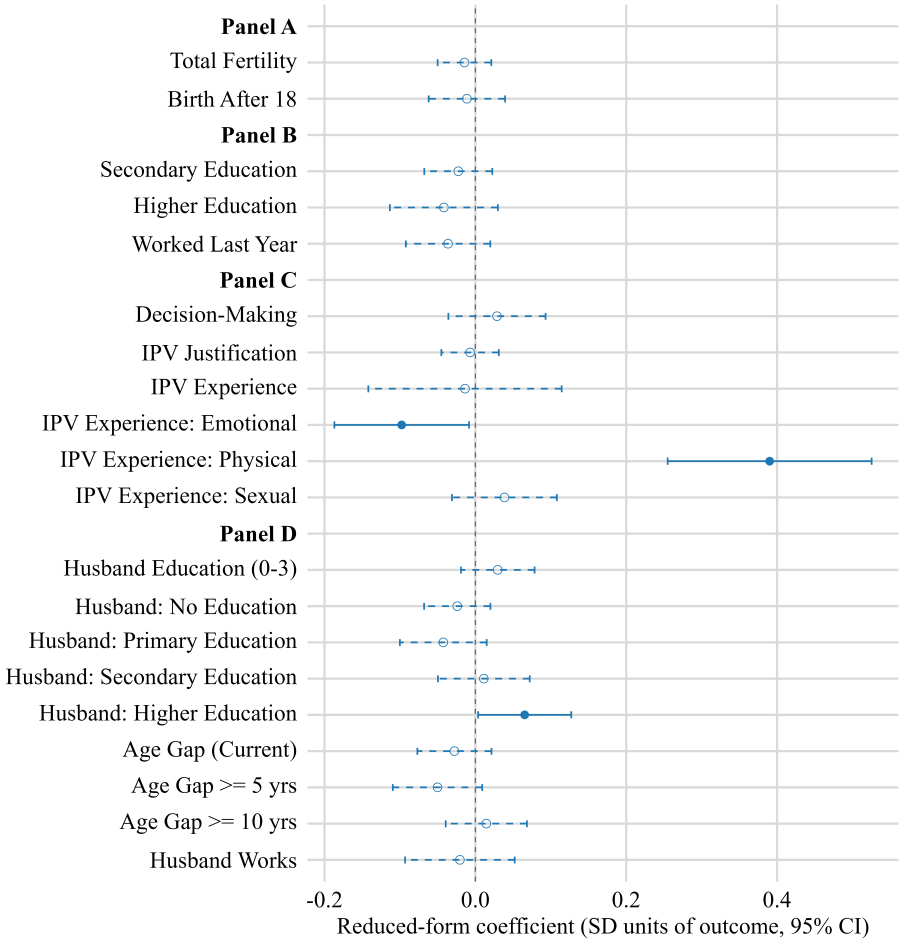


(b) Low Child Marriage Rate

Figure 5: (*continued*)



(c) Low Adolescent Fertility



(d) Previous Age 16/17

Notes: Each point is the robust bias-corrected reduced-form (ITT) RD coefficient (Calonico et al., 2014), standardised by the outcome's own standard deviation, (a) for the full Sample or (b)–(d) the respective subsample. Thus,coefficients are not directly comparable in magnitude across panels. Solid lines and filled markers denote significance at the 5% level, dashed lines and hollow markers denote non-significance. All regressions control for rural residence, religion, and country and survey-year fixed effects, and cluster standard errors at the primary sampling unit level.

and the experience of IPV are unaffected on average. This full-sample IPV-justification result holds under exclusion of 17 of 20 countries, most sensitive to Guinea, while the full-sample null on IPV experience is robust to exclusion of any single country. In countries with a low child marriage rate, IPV justification falls sharply, by 4.0 percentage points, significant at the 0.1% level and robust to the Benjamini-Hochberg correction. Unlike the corresponding first-stage estimate, this result is not driven by Tajikistan, excluding it leaves the coefficient nearly unchanged and still significant. It is, however, sensitive to Jordan specifically, whose exclusion alone removes significance, so some caution about country composition remains warranted.

In the low-adolescent-fertility subsample, decision-making power rises by 2.0 percentage points, significant at the 5% level uncorrected, but this does not survive the Benjamini-Hochberg correction and should be treated as a fragile point estimate rather than a confirmed effect. The same subsample's IPV-justification coefficient points in the same direction, a decline of 1.0 percentage point, but falls just short of conventional significance even before any correction and should likewise be read as suggestive only.

In the subsample where the previous legal age was 16 or 17, reported physical IPV experience rises sharply, by 9.4 percentage points against a control mean of 0.11, significant at the 0.1% level and robust to the Benjamini-Hochberg correction, even as reported emotional IPV experience falls by 2.9 percentage points. The latter is significant at the 5% level uncorrected but does not survive the Benjamini-Hochberg correction, so the weight of the interpretation below rests on the physical-IPV result alone. However, despite its extreme statistical significance, this result is highly sensitive to country composition: excluding Kenya alone collapses the coefficient to essentially zero, and five of the remaining eight countries similarly remove significance when excluded individually, so this finding should be read with the same caution as the low-child-marriage-rate first-stage estimate rather than treated as confirmed. Importantly, I would not necessarily interpret the rise in physical IPV as a sign that CMBs increase abuse. IPV is known to suffer from underreporting, with more educated and empowered women more likely to disclose experienced IPV (Cullen, 2023), so the increase in stated experience may counter-intuitively support the empowerment narrative rather than contradict it. This is, however, a speculative rather than causal interpretation. As with births after age 18, the full-sample IPV-justification effect is not confined to subsamples with a credible first stage. It is significant in 12 of the 32 subsamples where the first stage itself is null, again far more than what would be expected from chance.

Panel D: Marriage Market Outcomes. On average, eligible women marry more educated husbands, with the husband's education level rising by 0.051 points on the 0–3 scale. This is driven by a lower probability of marrying a husband with only primary education (2.1 percentage points) and, more tentatively, a higher probability of marrying a husband with secondary (2.0 percentage points) or higher education (1.4 percentage points), while the age gap between women and their partners as well as the husband's employment status are unaffected. The effects on the husband's education level and on primary education are robust to the Benjamini-Hochberg correction, whereas the effects on secondary and higher education are significant at the 5%

level uncorrected only. The gap between spouses' own education levels widens too, not only husband's education in absolute terms. CMB eligibility raises the education gap, both measured on the same 0–3 scale, by 0.042 points in the full sample, significant at the 1% level, against a control-group gap of 0.276. While statistically significant, this effect is small in absolute terms. Taking a full category step (e.g. Primary to Secondary) as roughly six years of schooling, 0.042 points corresponds to approximately three months of additional schooling, or roughly a quarter of a school year. This result is comparatively stable, holding under exclusion of 17 of the 20 countries in the sample, and is most sensitive to Guinea.

Given the inclusion of country and survey-year fixed effects, as well as the absence of an effect on women's own education or fertility, the effect on husband's education is unlikely to reflect a trend but rather a genuine effect of partner selection. This is further supported by the fact that the likelihood of getting married by age 30 is the same for eligible and non-eligible women, ruling out selection on whether husband characteristics are observable at all. This effect is also visible in the subsamples with a significant first stage, though with less consistent statistical support. In the low-adolescent-fertility subsample, husband's education rises by 0.07 points on the 0–3 scale, significant at the 5% level and robust to the Benjamini-Hochberg correction, holding under exclusion of 9 of the 10 countries in the subsample. In the low-child-marriage-rate subsample, the point estimate is considerably larger, a rise of 0.20 points, significant at the 1% level, but leave-one-out checks reveal this to be rather unstable. Excluding Jordan or Tajikistan individually inflates the coefficient to more than half the variable's entire range, and excluding Namibia reverses the sign. Accordingly, I do not treat this estimate as informative about the size of a genuine effect. In the subsample where the previous legal age was 16 or 17, the probability of a wide spousal age gap falls by 2.5 percentage points, only marginally significant at the 10% level uncorrected, does not survive the Benjamini-Hochberg correction, and remains non-significant under every one of the nine leave-one-out exclusions, so I do not treat this as an effect either.

As with the outcomes discussed in Panels A and C, the husband's-education finding is not confined to subsamples with a credible first stage. Restricting to the 32 subsamples where the first stage itself is null, husband's education level is significant in 20 of them and the probability of marrying a husband with only primary education in 17, both far above the roughly 1.6 hits expected from chance at the 5% level. This suggests that CMB eligibility shifts marriage-market outcomes through a channel that does not operate exclusively through a detectable delay in marriage itself.

Throughout this discussion, I cannot observe whether the shift in husband's education is favourable for the wife or not. Relative spousal education is sometimes used as a proxy for a wife's bargaining power, so a widening gap in the husband's favour could plausibly signal reduced rather than improved standing for the wife (Frempong and Stadelmann, 2024), while other evidence links more educated husbands to lower IPV perpetration, though this relationship is inconsistent across countries and can even reverse (Tsala Dimbuene et al., 2024). Given this ambiguity in the literature, I report the effect on husband's education as a marriage-market

outcome without characterising it as an improvement or a setback for the wife.

The described null pattern on fertility, education, and employment contrasts with Wilson (2022), who finds significant positive average effects on employment and age at first birth in the full sample, despite the null on child marriage itself noted above, though his schooling effect is null too, matching the result here.

Taken together, these life-cycle results point to a channel distinct from delayed marriage itself. CMB eligibility reshapes marriage markets and attitudes towards IPV broadly, including in subsamples where the first stage is entirely null, while leaving fertility, education, and employment generally unaffected.

5.3 Robustness

Ever-Married Subsample. To rule out that pooling women who for unknown reasons never married is biasing the effect of the CMB on the probability of marrying at age 18 or later, I restrict the sample to women who were ever married and re-estimate. Appendix Table A28 reports the full results and Appendix Figure A2a graphically displays the statistically significant subsamples. The overall first stage remains weak (0.012, p=0.14), but nine subsamples are significant at the 10% level, including the three subsamples from the main estimation where CMBs delayed first marriage. These are in order of effect size: women aged 18–24 (0.045, p=0.01), Low Child Marriage Rate countries (0.030, p=0.01), Previous Age 16/17 countries (0.027, p=0.09), Low Adolescent Fertility countries (0.026, p=0.05), rural residence (0.023, p=0.05), people who are relatively poor based on the median of the wealth distribution (0.019, p=0.07) and based on the 75th percentile (0.019, p=0.07), Anocracies (0.019, p=0.05), and the subsample excluding Pregnancy-Driven Marriage (0.017, p=0.06). Restricting to ever-married women therefore does not itself recover a strong instrument, but it reproduces the heterogeneity pattern from the full sample and adds several new subsamples (age, regime type, wealth, rurality) that were not significant at baseline. This indicates that CMBs have a stronger effect among women who did eventually get married.

Excluding Pregnancy-Driven Marriage. Since a pregnancy-driven marriage plausibly does not respond to a minimum-age law the way other marriages do, I re-estimate the first stage excluding women whose marriage was potentially caused by pregnancy. Appendix Table A29 reports the full results and Appendix Figure A2b graphically displays the statistically significant subsamples. As a direct complement, I also estimate the first stage on only the marriages plausibly caused by pregnancy. The overall first stage excluding pregnancy-driven marriages is, if anything, weaker (0.007, p=0.39), but twelve subsamples reach significance at the 10% level. Previous Age 14/15 stands out sharply (0.103, p<0.001). Medium Child Marriage Rate (0.071, p=0.003), Low Rule of Law (0.038, p=0.01), and Low Child Marriage Rate (0.034, p=0.003) countries follow. Christian women show a significant negative first stage here (-0.029, p=0.02), the only sign reversal among the subsamples that reach significance. Previous Age 16/17 countries (0.024, p=0.05), Low Government Effectiveness countries (0.023, p=0.08), High

Primary Education Completion countries (0.023, p=0.04), Low Adolescent Fertility countries (0.020, p=0.07), Muslim women (0.018, p=0.10), women with higher education (0.018, p=0.05), and the Ever-Married subsample itself (0.017, p=0.06) complete the list. Among women whose marriage could potentially be driven by pregnancy, the first stage is null (-0.016, p=0.48), consistent with these marriages being driven by the pregnancy itself rather than by the legal minimum age, and indicating that the reform does not detectably shift timing for this specific, welfare-relevant group either.

Manipulation Test. I run Cattaneo et al. (2020)'s density test on the running variable, pooled and by country. The pooled test rejects continuity at the 1% level, a validity concern I do not want to understate, and nine countries are flagged at the 10% level after a Benjamini-Hochberg adjustment.[35] However, contrary to the mechanism of a heaping-driven bias, excluding them roughly triples the first-stage point estimate (0.015 vs. 0.004 at baseline). A separate check for whether respondents might disproportionately report the same month for their birth and marriage due to recall bias or heaping shows only a modest excess of month-matches (10.3% vs. expected 8.3%), concentrated in the same countries flagged for heaping. Besides misreporting, either unintentionally or intentionally, this could also reflect known imputation mechanisms when the respondent cannot recall either date. The first stage also does not strengthen as a donut hole is widened around the cutoff, ruling out manipulation concentrated at the cutoff itself. Both checks are consistent with a recall or imputation mechanism rather than intentional misreporting, so the heaping I detect is if anything diluting rather than driving the, still statistically weak, first stage.[36]

Covariate Balance. As I cannot rule out with absolute certainty that another policy coincides with the reform cutoff, I test for continuity at the cutoff in the covariates most likely to reveal such a coincidence (Appendix Table A32). At the individual level, these are the variables I include as controls in the main specification, namely rural residence and religion, where I test the two predominant religions in the sample, Christian and Muslim. At the country level, I test GDP per capita, Government Effectiveness, Rule of Law, and Primary Education Completion, broad institutional and economic conditions through which an unrelated concurrent policy shock would plausibly manifest. I do not test the country-level dimensions used to construct the paper's own heterogeneity analysis (child marriage rate, adolescent fertility, the previous legal age, regime type), since these are demographic outcomes closely tied to the practice under study or discrete legal classifications, rather than independent institutional confounds. Five of the seven are balanced. Rule of Law and Primary Education Completion are not ($p<0.001$ and $p=0.015$ respectively). Both are country-level and, within the estimation window, effectively time-invariant, so this most plausibly reflects compositional change in which countries dominate the pooled running variable near versus far from the cutoff, rather than a genuine within-country discontinuity. Neither the Rule of Law nor the Primary Education Completion split shows a statistically significant effect on marital timing in the main specification.

[35] Benin, Ghana, Comoros, Guinea, Tajikistan, Sierra Leone, Madagascar, Mozambique, Liberia.
[36] See Table A30 for the density table, Figure A3 and Table A31 for the country-level heaping table.

Continuous Age at First Marriage. I re-estimate the effect on marital timing using age at first marriage in months as a continuous outcome, addressing the concern that the binary indicator collapses within-category variation in marriage timing (Table A33). Because age at first marriage is only observed for ever-married respondents, this specification necessarily restricts the estimation sample relative to the binary specification. The average effect remains statistically indistinguishable from zero, consistent with the main binary specification. CMB eligibility delays age at first marriage by 5.5 months in Low Child Marriage Rate countries (p=0.002) and by 3.3 months in Previous Age 16/17 countries (p=0.028), while the estimate for Low Adolescent Fertility is positive but insignificant (0.9 months, p=0.54). No Previous Age shows a negative but insignificant estimate (−3.6 months, p=0.18), so the unstable backfire result from the binary specification is not replicated. Age 18–24 additionally shows a significant delaying effect of 3.7 months (p=0.005) not evident in the binary specification, suggesting the binary threshold may obscure some heterogeneity in marriage timing among younger, married respondents. This check uses a different outcome and estimation sample rather than a different correction for multiple testing, so it does not itself change which results are confirmed versus suggestive. It shows only that the direction of the main effects is not an artefact of the binary threshold.

Multiple Testing. Because the heterogeneity analysis tests 37 subsamples for the first stage alone, and a comparable number for each life-cycle outcome, some apparently significant results are expected to arise by chance. I address this by applying the Benjamini-Hochberg procedure, which controls the expected proportion of false discoveries among rejected hypotheses, separately within each family of tests (the 37-subsample first-stage search, and each life-cycle outcome across subsamples). Appendix Table A34 reports adjusted p-values for the first-stage search. Of the four subsamples significant at the 5% level uncorrected, only Low Child Marriage Rate survives correction (adjusted p<0.001); Previous Age 16/17, Low Adolescent Fertility, and No Previous Age do not (adjusted p≈0.40 each), and are treated as suggestive throughout this paper rather than as confirmed findings. A binomial test on a separate pattern, the number of first-stage-null subsamples in which husband's education, IPV justification, and births after age 18 remain individually significant, confirms this is not attributable to chance either. Observing 20 or more significant results out of 32 independent 5% tests has a probability below 10^{-20} under the null of no true effect, and even the weakest of these outcomes (12 of 32) has a chance probability of roughly 2×10^{-8}. Full results for each life-cycle outcome are similarly BH-adjusted; see Section 5 for which specific downstream findings survive.

Annual Running-Variable. I collapse the running variable to years since the reform in place of months, to check that the baseline result is not an artefact of the finer monthly running variable and in line with Collin and Talbot (2023). The full-sample first stage is essentially unchanged (Coef = 0.002, p=0.81, against a monthly baseline of Coef = 0.004, p=0.57). Across the subsamples, the pattern shifts rather than repeating exactly, and not in a reassuring direction for the paper's confirmed result. Low Child Marriage Rate, the only subsample that survives correction for multiple testing in the main specification, loses significance under the coarser annual running

variable (0.004, p=0.81). Previous Age 16/17, one of the two suggestive subsamples, instead strengthens (0.052, p<0.001, against 0.029 at baseline), and Low Adolescent Fertility, the other suggestive subsample, also loses significance (-0.001, p=0.94). Appendix Table A35 reports the full comparison. This is consistent with Previous Age 16/17 tracking the previous statutory age rather than fine within-year timing, whereas Low Child Marriage Rate and Low Adolescent Fertility depend on the finer monthly bandwidth to isolate the discontinuity, a dependency that should be read as a genuine limitation of the child-marriage-rate result rather than a footnote, given how much weight that finding otherwise carries in this paper.

Bandwidth Selection. I re-estimate using Calonico et al. (2014)'s CER-optimal bandwidth instead of the baseline MSE-optimal bandwidth. Appendix Table A37 reports the comparison across all subsamples. For the full sample, the CER-optimal estimate is somewhat larger than the baseline (Coef = 0.012, $F = 1.83$, on a narrower bandwidth of 31 vs. 54 months) but remains insignificant. The subsamples Low Child Marriage Rate (0.041, p=0.005) and Previous Age 16/17 (0.032, p=0.030) remain significant, but Low Adolescent Fertility (p=0.135) and No Previous Age (p=0.065) are either no longer or just marginally significant. New subsamples become significant, namely Rural (0.025, p=0.041), Muslim (0.032, p=0.017), Medium Child Marriage Rate (−0.072, p<0.001), and High Primary Education Completion (0.024, p=0.039). Democracy produces an implausible coefficient, in all likelihood due to insufficient observations within the bandwidth. Taken together, this indicates that the bandwidth selector matters, and reinforces treating the subsample of Low Child Marriage Rate as the most robust finding.

Fixed Bandwidth. As a further check independent of any bandwidth selector, I re-estimate the first stage at a grid of fixed, non-data-driven bandwidths between 2 and 10 years rather than the MSE- or CER-optimal choice.[37] Appendix Table A36 reports the full comparison and Appendix Figure A4 plots the four headline subsamples. Low Child Marriage Rate is significant at least at the 5% level at every single bandwidth, the most uniformly robust result. Previous Age 16/17 requires a wider window to emerge, moving from insignificant at 2–3 years to significant at 4 years (p=0.048), dipping back to only marginal significance at 5–6 years (p=0.060 and p=0.052), and returning to significance from 8 years onward, strengthening to p<0.01 at 10 years, consistent with its dependence on the coarser annual running variable discussed above. Low Adolescent Fertility is the most fragile of the three. It is significant only at the 10% level at 3–4 years and null from 5 years onward. Full Sample remains null throughout. The fixed-bandwidth grid therefore confirms that Low Child Marriage Rate's result does not depend on bandwidth selection at all, while flagging Low Adolescent Fertility as the subsample most sensitive to the specific bandwidth chosen.

Functional Form. I re-estimate using a local quadratic polynomial in place of the baseline local linear specification, to check that the weak first stage is not an artifact of under-fitting near the cutoff. Appendix Table A38 reports the comparison by subsample. The full sample estimate under the quadratic specification (Coef =0.006, p=0.478) is, if anything, weaker than the

[37]These bandwidths are the month equivalent of 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 8, and 10 years

linear baseline (Coef =0.004, p=0.574), so under-fitting does not explain the null average first stage. The subsamples that are significant at baseline largely survive, with Low Child Marriage Rate (0.038, p=0.006) and Low Adolescent Fertility (0.029, p=0.047) remaining significant, while Previous Age 16/17 drops to the 10% level (0.023, p=0.087) and No Previous Age loses significance (−0.031, p=0.199). None of the positive estimates reverses sign or collapses to zero.

Placebo Thresholds. I re-run the identical first-stage specification treating every age from 15 to 20 as if it were the policy threshold, on the corresponding age-eligible subpopulations. Appendix Figure A5 plots the resulting coefficients. The pattern confirms and sharpens the finding of significance where the previous legal age is 16 or 17. Low Child Marriage Rate is the one subsample with a genuinely clean signature across the whole range. It is null at every age except 18, where it is highly significant (p<0.001). Low Adolescent Fertility and Previous Age 16/17 are each significant at more than one age, not only at 18: Low Adolescent Fertility clears 5% at both 17 (p=0.031) and 18 (p=0.045), and Previous Age 16/17 clears 5% at 15 (p=0.024), 16 (p=0.001), and 18 (p=0.031), with 17 and 19–20 null throughout. The full sample's unexplained discontinuity is isolated to age 16 (p<0.001) and does not extend to any neighbouring age. Taken together, Low Child Marriage Rate is the only one of the four subsamples whose identification is exclusively tied to the true legal cutoff across this wider window. The pattern within the Previous Age 16/17 is particularly noteworthy, and aligns with Batyra and Pesando (2021) who use previous legal age instead of new legal age for their identification. A discontinuity persisting at 15 or 16 alongside the one at 18 plausibly reflects the old law rather than noise. Families and registrars in these countries may already organise marriage timing around the previous statutory age, and that reference point does not disappear once a new one is introduced. Thus, where the previous age is close to 18, the first stage is not attributable to the new CMB at age 18 alone. Low Adolescent Fertility's spillover to age 17 could be explained by some anticipation where potentially previous cohorts already wait to get married as the new law is already announced or accompanies shifts away from child marriage. Neither pattern undermines the paper's headline results, but shows that the context of the previous legal age is important for identification.

Leave-One-Country-Out. I re-estimate the effect on marital timing and the reduced form dropping one country at a time, for the full sample and for each of the four subsamples with a significant effect on marital timing at conventional levels, to check that no single country drives the result. Stability varies sharply by subsample and outcome. In the full sample, IPV Justification is robust throughout, significant with all 20 countries included. Births After Age 18 and Total Children are more fragile, each flipping significance depending on whether Guinea or Egypt, respectively, is included. Previous Age 16/17 is the most stable of the conditioning subsamples for most outcomes: only IPV Justification, IPV Experience, and Worked Last Year change significance, and none by a large margin. This stability does not extend to physical IPV experience, however, where the 9.4-percentage-point effect in this subsample, despite a p-value below 10^{-7}, collapses to essentially zero when Kenya alone is excluded, and loses significance under five of the remaining eight exclusions as well. This result should accordingly

be treated with the same caution as the Low Child Marriage Rate first-stage estimate above, not as confirmed. Low Adolescent Fertility and, especially, Low Child Marriage Rate are considerably less stable overall, consistent with the fragility already documented for their first-stage estimates. The starkest case is Years of Education under Low Child Marriage Rate: the baseline estimate (0.37, significant) more than triples to 1.19 when Egypt is excluded, a six-country subsample in which one country can move the point estimate by 0.82. Tajikistan and Egypt recur as the most influential country across several outcome-subsample combinations, which is worth keeping in mind when interpreting any single downstream result for these two subsamples in isolation. The full-sample widening of the husband-wife education gap (Section 5) is comparatively more stable, holding under exclusion of 17 of the 20 countries and most sensitive to Guinea. Two further Panel D estimates complete this picture. Husband's education in the low-adolescent-fertility subsample is comparatively stable, holding under exclusion of 9 of the 10 countries. The corresponding estimate in the low-child-marriage-rate subsample is not: excluding Jordan or Tajikistan individually inflates the coefficient to more than half the variable's entire range, and excluding Namibia reverses its sign, so I do not treat this estimate as informative about the size of a genuine effect. The spousal age gap in the previous-age-16/17 subsample is more straightforward, it is not significant at baseline and remains non-significant under every one of the nine leave-one-out exclusions, consistent with treating it as a null result rather than a fragile one.

5.4 Limitations and Future Research

Limitations. Several limitations should be noted. First, and most fundamentally, the first stage is weak in the full sample and in most conditioning subsamples, so the paper's causal claims rest on reduced-form estimates rather than fuzzy RDD LATE estimates throughout. Of the four subsamples with a first stage significant at conventional levels, only one, Low Child Marriage Rate, survives correction for multiple testing across the 37-subsample search. The other three are reported as suggestive rather than confirmed for this reason alone, independent of the country-level fragility discussed next. Where a subsample's first stage does clear conventional strength, several of these results are themselves fragile.For instance, the Low Child Marriage Rate estimate is disproportionately driven by a single country and loses significance when the running variable is collapsed to years.

Second, the data themselves carry the usual limitations of retrospective, self-reported survey data. Birth and marriage dates are recalled rather than drawn from administrative registers, and the manipulation test detects heaping in the running variable in nine of twenty countries, most plausibly driven by enumerator or respondent date imputation rather than strategic manipulation, but not fully distinguishable from it in survey data alone. The IPV experience module is available only for a subset of DHS countries and rounds, so those specific outcomes are estimated on a smaller and potentially non-random subsample of countries and years. Husband characteristics are only observed for the current husband, which could understate effects on marriage-market outcomes if women who married substantially older men are disproportionately widowed or

remarried by the time of survey. Individual characteristics such as education, wealth, and literacy are measured at the time of survey rather than at the time of marriage, and while the narrow estimation bandwidth (typically three to five years around the cutoff) makes it plausible that these are close to predetermined, I cannot rule out that some respondents' circumstances changed between the CMB reform and the survey in ways correlated with treatment.

Third, while the cross-country design improves external validity relative to a single-country study, it necessarily abstracts from country-specific mechanisms that plausibly shape reform effectiveness: local enforcement capacity, administrative implementation, and existing social norms around marriage age all vary across the sample, both across and within countries. While I attempt to capture these via country-level subsamples, this could mask regional heterogeneity. For instance, one dimension I do not currently exploit is ethnic and customary variation in marriage practices, in particular bride-price and dowry systems, which the economics literature on marriage markets (e.g. Corno et al. (2020) on bride price and drought-driven child marriage) links directly to the economic incentives underlying early marriage. Linking DHS clusters to ethnic-group-level marriage-custom data would allow a direct test of whether CMB effectiveness varies with the prevailing bride-price regime.

Fourth, this paper only considers effects on women. While girls and women are disproportionately affected by child marriage and its consequences, insights on the effects on boys and men would complement the findings of this paper. Extending the analysis to men is not straightforward, however, as the legal minimum age of marriage, and hence the timing of reform, often differs by sex, requiring CMB eligibility to be recoded separately for each country. The DHS Men's Questionnaires are also considerably less comprehensive than the Women's Questionnaires used throughout this paper, limiting the range of outcomes available for a male sample.

Finally, the outcomes studied here are downstream life-cycle outcomes, not direct measures of enforcement or compliance behaviour. I can document where the first stage is strong or weak, but I do not directly observe why. In other words, I cannot distinguish whether effects in the respective subsamples are due to administrative capacity, awareness campaigns, community-level enforcement, or shifting social norms. IPV outcomes are self-reported attitudes and experiences rather than objective incidence, a well-documented measurement concern in the domestic violence literature more broadly.

Future research. These limitations point to several avenues for future research. Administrative or registry-based birth and marriage data, where available, would sidestep the recall and heaping concerns inherent to retrospective survey data and allow a sharper manipulation test. Marriage histories that record more than the current union would also help establish whether the husband-characteristics results are understated by remarriage. Linking the existing sample to ethnic-level marriage-custom data would allow future work to test bride-price and dowry regimes as moderators of CMB effectiveness directly. Sub-national or district-level measures of state capacity and enforcement, where available, would allow a more precise test of the enforcement-gap mechanism than the rural versus urban or country-level institutional indices used here. Recoding CMB

eligibility separately by sex and drawing on the DHS Men's Questionnaires, despite their more limited scope, would allow a direct test of whether CMBs affect marriage timing and downstream outcomes for men in the same way as for women. Longer panel follow-up would let future work test whether the paper's most robust reduced-form findings, on husband's education and attitudes towards IPV, persist into second-generation outcomes such as children's schooling and health. Finally, as additional DHS rounds become available, several of the underpowered subsamples identified here could be re-estimated on a larger and more stable sample.

6 Conclusion

Child marriage remains a major policy concern, yet evidence on when CMBs actually work, and on whether they change women's broader life trajectories, has remained limited. This study set out to determine, first, whether CMBs, reforms setting the minimum legal age of marriage at 18 without parental-consent exceptions, have the potential to alter marital timing under specific socio-economic conditions, and second, whether they can alter women's life-cycle outcomes. This study provides, to my knowledge, the most comprehensive cross-country evaluation of CMBs to date, covering reforms enacted between 1995 and 2023 by combining harmonised legal reform data from the WORLD Policy Analysis Center with nationally representative DHS data from 20 countries, and exploiting variation in reform eligibility across birth cohorts through a robust bias-corrected RDD.

Excluding reforms that retain parental-consent exceptions matters in practice, as many countries that nominally set a minimum age of 18 still permit marriage below it with parental permission, leaving the reform without any binding force in these cases. This study contributes to the ongoing discussion in development and gender economics, among other disciplines, of when legal reforms translate into actual behavioural change by focusing on reforms that impose a binding constraint on the age of marriage. My results confirm the existing finding that CMBs do not delay marriage on average, but establish two novel findings the literature has not yet documented. First, this average null effect masks meaningful heterogeneity. Where child marriage was already comparatively rare before the reform, CMB eligibility measurably reduces it further, an effect that survives correction for multiple hypothesis testing but is disproportionately driven by one country. I document a similar pattern in countries with low pre-reform adolescent fertility and where the previous legal minimum age was already close to 18, but treat both as suggestive rather than confirmed, since neither subsample survives correction for multiple testing. Further, while I find no average effect on marriage at 18, the new legal age, I find suggestive evidence of an effect at ages 16 and 17 in an extended 24-country sample, though only the effect at age 17 remains marginally significant in the paper's main sample. I find no evidence that individual characteristics, including rural location, religion, household wealth, and primary education, moderate CMB effectiveness.

Second, and independent of whether marriage is delayed, CMB eligibility reshapes marriage markets and attitudes towards IPV. Even in the full sample, where the reform has no detectable

effect on marriage timing, CMB eligibility lowers the justification of IPV and raises the education of the husband a woman goes on to marry. Both effects survive correction for multiple testing and appear even in subsamples where the first stage is entirely null, so they are not confined to the few settings where the law happens to bind. Importantly, whether this effect is welfare-improving cannot be assessed, but it shows that CMBs can alter women's life-cycle outcomes beyond marital timing. At the same time, I find no generalisable effect on women's own education, employment, or fertility.

A number of limitations should be noted. The first stage is weak throughout this paper, so the causal claims rest on reduced-form ITT estimates rather than fuzzy RDD LATE estimates, which would be imprecisely estimated given this weakness. Administrative data in place of self-reported data, a longer panel, and considering the smaller male DHS sample would each strengthen this evidence, particularly for the results on husband's education and IPV attitudes that do not depend on the fragile first stage.

Notwithstanding these limitations, this study points to the specific margin at which policy operates. While CMB legislation cannot overturn a marriage practice sustained by broader social and economic conditions, it can reinforce a shift already underway, and it operates on the marriage market through channels other than its stated goal of delayed marriage. Policy design that treats a CMB as uniformly binding, or writes it off wherever it fails to move the headline marriage-timing statistic, misses both. Legal reform is thus best understood here as a complement to social change already in motion, not a substitute for it. If the goal is to alter marriage age itself, a minimum-age law on its own is unlikely to be sufficient. Its effectiveness depends on the conditions it meets, not on the law alone. Even where those conditions are not yet in place, however, this paper shows the law is not without consequence. It still shifts the marriage market and the attitudes surrounding it, an effect distinct from, and independent of, its stated goal.

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A Declaration on the use of AI tools

In the preparation of this paper "Beyond Average Effects: The Uneven Promise of Child Marriage Bans", I used Claude (Anthropic) in the following ways:

1. Language editing: I used the tool to edit my writing, including proofreading and reformulation. The aim was to reduce typos and grammar mistakes, as English is not my first language, and to improve readability, concision and organisation. After every use, I reviewed and edited the content as needed.

2. Coding assistance: I used the tool to help me write and debug R scripts, particularly for the comprehensive robustness tests I conduct. The empirical strategy, main estimation pipeline, and all reported results are my own work.

3. Literature research: I used the tool to conduct literature research using specific search terms.

All underlying analysis, findings, and interpretation are my own. I take full responsibility for the content, analysis, and conclusions of this paper, including all text and code produced with AI assistance, which I have reviewed and verified.

B Literature

B.1 Literature Overview

Appendix Table A1 provides an overview of the most relevant peer-reviewed articles for this analysis, considering the effects of child marriage reforms on women's socioeconomic outcomes, including health, education, and agency. Column *CMB* details whether the authors exclusively analyse child marriage reforms that set the legal minimum age at marriage for women at 18 years regardless of parental consent. Column *N* presents the number of countries included, with those above 17 including countries both with and without CMBs.

Table A1: Summary of Literature on Child Marriage Reforms and Socioeconomic Outcomes

Article	CMB	N	Data	Model	Outcomes
Batyra and Pesando (2021)	No	6	DHS, MICS, PROSPERED	Fuzzy RDD	Marriage
Bellés-Obrero and Lombardi (2023)	Yes	1	Ministry	Two-way FE DiD	Marriage, fertility, school enrolment
Collin and Talbot (2023)	Mixed	121	DHS, MICS, WORLD	RDD	Marriage
Kidman et al. (2024)	Yes	16	DHS, WORLD	Two-way FE	Marriage, fertility
Kim et al. (2013)	Mixed	115	Country level	FE time series	Fertility
Le et al. (2025)	Yes	17	DHS, WORLD	Generalized DiD	Infant mortality
Maswikwa et al. (2015)	Yes	12	DHS, GRID, WORLD	Multivariate log binomial, Log Poisson	Marriage, fertility
McGavock (2021)	No	1	DHS	DiD, event study	Marriage
Omidakhsh and Heymann (2020)	Yes	5	DHS, WORLD	DiD	IPV
Rokicki (2021)	No	1	DHS, WORLD	DiD, Synthetic control methods	SRH
Wilson (2022)	Yes	17	DHS	DiD	Education, employment, marriage, fertility

Notes: This table outlines literature directly relevant to the study, specifically focusing on CMBs. The overview is limited by the search parameters employed and will be expanded in ongoing work. "CMB" indicates whether the study explicitly analyses reforms setting the minimum marriage age at 18 regardless of parental consent. For studies defining distinct treatment and control groups, the country count N refers to treatment countries only. Abbreviations: Difference-in-Differences (DiD), Fixed-Effects (FE), Multiple Indicator Cluster Surveys (MICS).

C Descriptive Statistics

Table A2: Descriptive Statistics: Individual Characteristics and Outcomes (5 Year Bandwidth)

Variable	DHS ID	Statistic	Full	Control	Treatment
Individual Characteristics					
Age	v012	Mean (SD)	26.34 (5.84)	27.50 (6.12)	24.98 (5.16)
		Median	26.00	27.00	24.00
		[Min, Max]	[18, 47]	[18, 47]	[18, 42]
		n	223,741	121,298	102,443
Age at First Marriage	v511	Mean (SD)	18.72 (3.95)	18.82 (4.09)	18.59 (3.76)
		Median	18.00	18.00	18.00
		[Min, Max]	[4, 44]	[4, 44]	[6, 40]
		n	160,800	91,743	69,057
Married Before 18 (Child Marriage)	v511†	no	134,592 (67%)	72,043 (66%)	62,549 (69%)
		yes	65,558 (33%)	37,301 (34%)	28,257 (31%)
		n	200,150	109,344	90,806
Years of Education	v133	Mean (SD)	6.39 (5.17)	6.12 (5.20)	6.72 (5.11)
		Median	7.00	6.00	7.00
		[Min, Max]	[0, 24]	[0, 24]	[0, 24]
		n	223,633	121,240	102,393
Education Level	v149†	No Education	62,516 (28%)	36,893 (30%)	25,623 (25%)
		Primary	52,618 (24%)	29,343 (24%)	23,275 (23%)
		Secondary	84,180 (38%)	42,691 (35%)	41,489 (41%)
		Higher	24,377 (11%)	12,347 (10%)	12,030 (12%)
		n	223,691	121,274	102,417
Rural	v025	no	95,439 (43%)	51,201 (42%)	44,238 (43%)
		yes	128,302 (57%)	70,097 (58%)	58,205 (57%)
		n	223,741	121,298	102,443
Literate	v155	no	96,837 (47%)	54,392 (50%)	42,445 (45%)
		yes	107,559 (53%)	54,816 (50%)	52,743 (55%)
		n	204,396	109,208	95,188
Poor (Median)	v191†	no	113,269 (51%)	60,804 (50%)	52,465 (51%)
		yes	110,472 (49%)	60,494 (50%)	49,978 (49%)
		n	223,741	121,298	102,443
Poor (75P)	v191†	no	56,910 (25%)	30,580 (25%)	26,330 (26%)
		yes	166,831 (75%)	90,718 (75%)	76,113 (74%)
		n	223,741	121,298	102,443
Christian	v130†	no	123,457 (56%)	66,542 (56%)	56,915 (57%)
		yes	95,509 (44%)	51,881 (44%)	43,628 (43%)
		n	218,966	118,423	100,543

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Appendix Table A2 *(continued)*

Variable	DHS ID	Statistic	Full	Control	Treatment
Muslim	v130†	no	124,090 (57%)	67,133 (57%)	56,957 (57%)
		yes	94,876 (43%)	51,290 (43%)	43,586 (43%)
		n	218,966	118,423	100,543
Ever Married	v502†	no	39,350 (19%)	17,601 (16%)	21,749 (24%)
		yes	163,558 (81%)	92,896 (84%)	70,662 (76%)
		n	202,908	110,497	92,411
Pregnancy-Driven Marriage	v211,v212, v507,v508†	no	203,053 (91%)	109,269 (90%)	93,784 (92%)
		yes	20,688 (9%)	12,029 (10%)	8,659 (8%)
		n	223,741	121,298	102,443
Panel A: Fertility					
Total Children	v201	Mean (SD)	2.11 (1.88)	2.37 (1.97)	1.80 (1.71)
		Median	2.00	2.00	1.00
		[Min, Max]	[0, 17]	[0, 17]	[0, 13]
		n	223,741	121,298	102,443
Birth After 18	v212†	no	95,054 (46%)	47,819 (43%)	47,235 (50%)
		yes	112,050 (54%)	64,324 (57%)	47,726 (50%)
		n	207,104	112,143	94,961
Panel B: Education and Employment					
Worked Last Year	v731	no	79,725 (43%)	41,149 (42%)	38,576 (45%)
		yes	104,728 (57%)	57,901 (58%)	46,827 (55%)
		n	184,453	99,050	85,403
Panel C: Decision-Making & IPV					
Decision-Making	v739, v743a,b,d,f†	Mean (SD)	0.43 (0.27)	0.44 (0.28)	0.41 (0.27)
		Median	0.50	0.50	0.50
		[Min, Max]	[0, 1]	[0, 1]	[0, 1]
		n	142,588	80,928	61,660
IPV Justification	v744a–e†	Mean (SD)	0.21 (0.33)	0.21 (0.33)	0.20 (0.32)
		Median	0.00	0.00	0.00
		[Min, Max]	[0, 1]	[0, 1]	[0, 1]
		n	223,741	121,298	102,443
IPV Experience	d103, d104, d106-108, d110†	Mean (SD)	0.12 (0.21)	0.12 (0.21)	0.12 (0.20)
		Median	0.00	0.00	0.00
		[Min, Max]	[0, 1]	[0, 1]	[0, 1]
		n	50,861	26,782	24,079
IPV Emotional	d104†	Mean (SD)	0.16 (0.30)	0.16 (0.30)	0.15 (0.30)
		Median	0.00	0.00	0.00
		[Min, Max]	[0, 1]	[0, 1]	[0, 1]
		n	50,859	26,780	24,079

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Appendix Table A2 *(continued)*

Variable	DHS ID	Statistic	Full	Control	Treatment
IPV Physical	d106, d107, d110†	Mean (SD)	0.11 (0.23)	0.12 (0.24)	0.11 (0.23)
		Median	0.00	0.00	0.00
		[Min, Max]	[0, 1]	[0, 1]	[0, 1]
		n	50,861	26,782	24,079
IPV Sexual	d105h, d105i, d108†	Mean (SD)	0.07 (0.22)	0.07 (0.23)	0.06 (0.22)
		Median	0.00	0.00	0.00
		[Min, Max]	[0, 1]	[0, 1]	[0, 1]
		n	223,741	121,298	102,443
Panel D: Marriage Market Outcomes					
Spousal Age Gap	v730, v012†	Mean (SD)	6.89 (6.69)	6.91 (6.77)	6.85 (6.59)
		Median	5.00	5.00	5.00
		[Min, Max]	[-22, 77]	[-21, 77]	[-22, 77]
		n	143,145	80,929	62,216
Husband Education Level	v701	No Education	35,906 (25%)	21,174 (26%)	14,732 (23%)
		Primary	31,862 (22%)	18,369 (22%)	13,493 (21%)
		Secondary	59,464 (41%)	32,827 (40%)	26,637 (42%)
		Higher	17,662 (12%)	9,566 (12%)	8,096 (13%)
		n	144,894	81,936	62,958
Husband Works	v704a	no	5,059 (8%)	2,672 (9%)	2,387 (8%)
		yes	54,890 (92%)	26,450 (91%)	28,440 (92%)
		n	59,949	29,122	30,827

Descriptive statistics for individual characteristics and outcomes based on DHS data for the full sample and by reform eligibility for a bandwidth of 5 years on either side of the cutoff. † Author-constructed variable: a recode or composite index derived from DHS survey items, rather than a direct DHS survey item. *Abbreviations:* Demographic and Health Surveys (DHS), Standard Deviation (SD), Intimate Partner Violence (IPV).

Table A3: Descriptive Statistics: Country-Level Characteristics

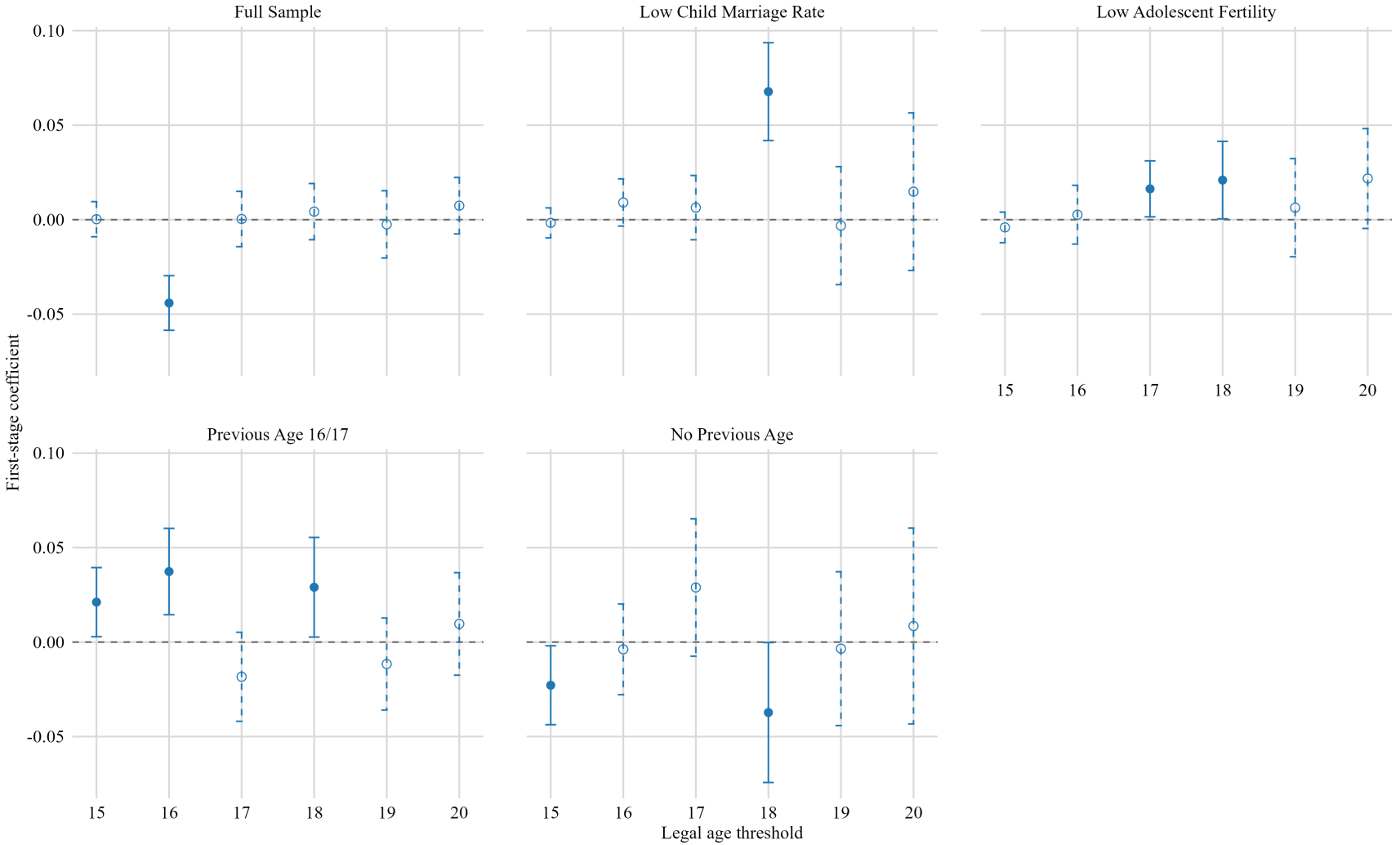
Variable	Source	Statistic	Full	Control	Treatment
Child Marriage Rate (%)	WB WDI	Mean (SD)	32.91 (15.59)	32.51 (15.47)	33.38 (15.71)
		Median	34.91	34.91	34.91
		[Min, Max]	[5.6, 57.34]	[5.6, 57.34]	[5.6, 57.34]
		n	223,741	121,298	102,443
Adolescent Fertility Rate	WB WDI	Mean (SD)	101.18 (40.94)	100.68 (40.83)	101.77 (41.07)
		Median	111.93	111.93	111.93
		[Min, Max]	[15.89, 161.32]	[15.89, 161.32]	[15.89, 161.32]
		n	223,741	121,298	102,443
Regime Type	Polity IV	Anocracy	144,584 (66%)	78,148 (66%)	66,436 (67%)
		Autocracy	41,979 (19%)	24,184 (20%)	17,795 (18%)
		Democracy	31,575 (14%)	16,406 (14%)	15,169 (15%)
		n	218,138	118,738	99,400
Prior Legal Minimum Age	WORLD	Mean (SD)	15.88 (1.20)	15.86 (1.17)	15.90 (1.25)
		Median	16.00	16.00	16.00
		[Min, Max]	[14, 18]	[14, 18]	[14, 18]
		n	223,741	121,298	102,443
GDP per Capita	WB WDI	Mean (SD)	1393.63 (1398.86)	1406.00 (1362.67)	1378.97 (1440.40)
		Median	849.52	872.69	849.52
		[Min, Max]	[247.51, 6647.65]	[247.51, 6647.65]	[247.51, 6647.65]
		n	223,741	121,298	102,443
Government Effectiveness	WB WGI	Mean (SD)	-0.68 (0.60)	-0.68 (0.58)	-0.69 (0.63)
		Median	-0.52	-0.52	-0.66
		[Min, Max]	[-1.65, 0.88]	[-1.65, 0.88]	[-1.65, 0.88]
		n	223,741	121,298	102,443
Rule of Law	WB WGI	Mean (SD)	-0.63 (0.49)	-0.63 (0.48)	-0.64 (0.50)
		Median	-0.55	-0.55	-0.55
		[Min, Max]	[-1.62, 0.49]	[-1.62, 0.49]	[-1.62, 0.49]
		n	223,741	121,298	102,443
Primary Education Completion	WB WDI	Mean (SD)	68.52 (24.33)	69.24 (24.01)	67.66 (24.68)
		Median	64.17	64.17	63.42
		[Min, Max]	[21.97, 131.9]	[21.97, 131.9]	[21.97, 131.9]
		n	223,741	121,298	102,443

Descriptive statistics for the full sample and by reform eligibility for a bandwidth of 5 years on either side of the cutoff. All country-level variables are author-constructed, merged in from outside the DHS and matched to each country's policy-introduction year (Polity IV score matched to the nearest available year for Regime Type). *Abbreviations:* World Bank (WB), World Development Indicators (WDI), Worldwide Governance Indicators (WGI), Standard Deviation (SD).

D Complete Results

D.1 Effect of CMBs on not marrying before age 18

Figure A1: First Stage: Sensitivity to the Legal Age Threshold (Ages 15–20)



Notes: Each point is the robust bias-corrected local-linear RDD coefficient (Calonico et al., 2014) for the probability of not marrying before age 18 shown on the x-axis (i.e., not marrying before age 18), estimated separately at each threshold within each subsample. Vertical bars are 95% confidence intervals. All regressions control for rural residence, religion, and country and survey-year fixed effects, and cluster standard errors at the primary sampling unit level. Solid lines and filled markers denote significance at the 5% level, dashed lines and hollow markers denote non-significance. Panels report the full sample and the four subsamples with a significant first stage at the age-18 cutoff in the main specification.

Table A4: Effect of CMBs on Marrying in Adulthood (First Stage)

Subsample	Estimate (SE)	Mean	p-value	N (Left)	N (Right)	BW
Full Sample	0.004 (0.008)	0.666	0.574	94,893	80,101	54.0
Ever Married	0.012 (0.008)	0.584	0.139	91,905	68,603	61.6
Excluding Pregnancy-Driven	0.007 (0.008)	0.679	0.388	79,581	68,709	51.0
Rural	0.015 (0.011)	0.586	0.159	48,569	40,898	49.0
Urban	-0.012 (0.010)	0.763	0.221	46,552	39,649	60.8
Age 18–24	0.021 (0.014)	0.640	0.131	22,956	26,253	34.1
Age 25–34	0.017 (0.016)	0.695	0.300	20,196	17,391	24.0
Age 35+	0.009 (0.038)	0.735	0.805	5,081	2,596	24.7
No Primary Education	-0.008 (0.013)	0.417	0.553	42,140	25,372	75.2
Primary Education	0.004 (0.008)	0.718	0.564	76,394	67,941	61.8
Not Literate	-0.003 (0.011)	0.489	0.820	58,578	41,235	73.4
Literate	0.007 (0.009)	0.798	0.431	42,600	40,429	52.5
Poor (Median)	0.014 (0.011)	0.577	0.198	51,780	42,319	58.1
Non-Poor (Median)	0.001 (0.011)	0.743	0.895	38,853	34,157	43.5
Poor (75P)	0.009 (0.009)	0.609	0.317	65,067	55,518	49.8
Non-Poor (75P)	0.001 (0.012)	0.807	0.959	26,016	21,904	57.6
Christian	-0.011 (0.012)	0.692	0.387	35,400	30,084	47.2
Muslim	0.021^{+} (0.012)	0.696	0.065	36,361	31,457	45.4
Low Child Marriage Rate	0.068^{***} (0.013)	0.825	<0.001	21,780	18,946	41.4
Medium Child Marriage Rate	0.012 (0.015)	0.694	0.401	23,853	20,757	37.0
High Child Marriage Rate	-0.021 (0.014)	0.479	0.119	39,276	32,900	68.3
Previous Age 16/17	0.029^{*} (0.013)	0.657	0.031	28,514	21,833	40.4
Previous Age 14/15	-0.010 (0.013)	0.674	0.472	27,184	25,632	34.7
No Previous Age	-0.037^{*} (0.019)	0.682	0.049	12,151	12,074	44.5
Low Adolescent Fertility	0.021^{*} (0.010)	0.789	0.045	38,947	31,464	46.7
High Adolescent Fertility	0.004 (0.011)	0.548	0.725	55,517	48,601	59.8
Autocracy	0.002 (0.023)	0.611	0.926	14,436	12,262	43.4
Anocracy	-0.000 (0.010)	0.658	0.983	57,786	47,837	51.7
Democracy	0.033^{+} (0.017)	0.731	0.061	8,719	8,744	32.7
Low GDP p.c.	0.013 (0.012)	0.585	0.298	37,189	34,291	45.0
High GDP p.c.	-0.002 (0.010)	0.744	0.870	46,399	37,486	49.5
Low Gov. Effectiveness	0.026^{+} (0.015)	0.602	0.097	23,539	21,549	30.5
High Gov. Effectiveness	-0.007 (0.010)	0.737	0.489	50,061	40,321	50.4
Low Rule of Law	0.023 (0.015)	0.642	0.116	23,656	21,435	35.6
High Rule of Law	-0.002 (0.009)	0.689	0.812	60,846	49,544	54.3
Low Primary Ed. Completion	-0.006 (0.013)	0.604	0.652	35,956	33,755	43.9
High Primary Ed. Completion	0.016 (0.010)	0.729	0.126	43,750	35,629	46.3

Notes: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05, + p<0.1. Estimates are robust bias-corrected RDD coefficients (SE in parentheses) of CMB eligibility on not marrying before age 18, using Calonico et al. (2014). Mean refers to the weighted control group mean of the outcome within the estimation bandwidth. N (Left)/N (Right) are effective observations within the MSE-optimal bandwidth on each side of the cutoff. BW: Bandwidth (months).

Table A5: First Stage by Age Threshold: 24-Country vs. 20-Country Sample

	24-Country Sample			20-Country Sample		
Age	Estimate (SE)	N	Control Mean	Estimate (SE)	N	Control Mean
15	0.010^{+} (0.005)	101,321	0.898	0.010 (0.006)	97,562	0.896
16	0.015* (0.007)	106,126	0.819	0.010 (0.007)	118,758	0.815
17	0.015* (0.007)	137,217	0.723	0.014^{+} (0.008)	123,574	0.720
18	0.005 (0.008)	159,984	0.620	0.004 (0.008)	174,994	0.616
20	0.004 (0.009)	142,788	0.438	0.007 (0.008)	209,938	0.435
25	0.006 (0.011)	70,978	0.172	0.004 (0.011)	69,172	0.168
30	0.000 (0.012)	37,633	0.085	−0.010 (0.010)	42,420	0.082

Notes: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05, + p<0.1. Robust bias-corrected estimates with clustered standard errors in parentheses. Outcome is not married before the respective age k. Each row restricted to respondents of age ≥ k. Treatment is fixed at the true eligibility cutoff throughout. N is the total sample size. The $n = 24$ columns add Gabon, Kazakhstan, Chad and Zambia, which pass the cohort-coverage condition at ages 15–17. The $n = 20$ columns restrict to the same 20 countries as the paper's main first-stage sample.

Table A6: First Stage by Subsample, M16+: 24-Country vs. 20-Country Sample

	n = 24			n = 20		
Subsample	Estimate (SE)	N	Mean	Estimate (SE)	N	Mean
Full Sample	0.015* (0.007)	106,126	0.819	0.010 (0.007)	118,758	0.815
Ever Married	0.005 (0.007)	130,921	0.765	0.009 (0.010)	68,692	0.773
Excluding Pregnancy-Driven	0.020** (0.007)	92,624	0.824	0.019* (0.008)	74,012	0.820
Rural	0.023* (0.009)	74,704	0.771	0.029** (0.010)	58,287	0.772
Urban	-0.004 (0.009)	44,224	0.885	-0.008 (0.007)	82,644	0.881
Age 18-24	0.021* (0.010)	49,292	0.823	-0.001 (0.009)	61,483	0.818
Age 25-34	0.015 (0.010)	47,538	0.812	0.010 (0.011)	39,114	0.809
Age 35+	0.036 (0.022)	9,166	0.822	0.036+ (0.021)	11,302	0.822
No Primary Education	0.010 (0.015)	44,103	0.653	0.001 (0.017)	33,938	0.664
Primary Education	-0.010 (0.008)	55,301	0.891	0.009+ (0.005)	126,781	0.889
Not Literate	0.013 (0.012)	65,459	0.706	0.011 (0.011)	68,530	0.700
Literate	0.015* (0.007)	62,199	0.919	0.007 (0.005)	138,866	0.917
Poor (Median)	0.016+ (0.010)	67,708	0.768	0.015+ (0.009)	86,767	0.768
Non-Poor (Median)	0.009 (0.008)	58,184	0.870	0.006 (0.007)	68,898	0.869
Poor (75P)	0.014* (0.007)	115,883	0.789	0.014+ (0.007)	102,954	0.789
Non-Poor (75P)	0.013 (0.008)	29,401	0.906	0.011 (0.008)	33,903	0.906
Christian	0.027** (0.010)	53,529	0.858	0.019+ (0.010)	57,804	0.855
Muslim	-0.004 (0.008)	60,373	0.796	-0.004 (0.008)	68,293	0.806
Low Child Marriage Rate	0.006 (0.007)	25,807	0.892	0.001 (0.005)	54,414	0.881
Medium Child Marriage Rate	0.013 (0.009)	64,051	0.858	-0.014 (0.012)	42,221	0.852
High Child Marriage Rate	0.012 (0.015)	45,324	0.676	0.005 (0.014)	47,118	0.691
Low Adolescent Fertility	0.003 (0.006)	59,194	0.887	0.002 (0.007)	58,147	0.880
High Adolescent Fertility	0.030* (0.012)	51,298	0.740	0.020+ (0.011)	67,058	0.731
Autocracy	0.022 (0.020)	19,468	0.775	0.071** (0.027)	10,076	0.775
Anocracy	0.011 (0.007)	111,468	0.819	0.004 (0.007)	130,233	0.822
Democracy	0.016 (0.014)	17,620	0.870	0.018 (0.012)	22,974	0.857
No Previous Age	-0.006 (0.013)	25,631	0.807	0.002 (0.016)	16,489	0.807
Previous Age 16/17	-0.002 (0.008)	69,724	0.824	0.009 (0.010)	43,072	0.804
Previous Age 14/15	0.033** (0.011)	48,197	0.816	0.024* (0.010)	57,721	0.836
Low GDP p.c.	0.022* (0.011)	57,634	0.758	0.024* (0.012)	49,812	0.758
High GDP p.c.	0.007 (0.008)	52,556	0.864	0.002 (0.007)	59,317	0.875
Low Gov. Effectiveness	0.011 (0.010)	62,805	0.742	0.006 (0.011)	53,500	0.742
High Gov. Effectiveness	0.009 (0.007)	71,072	0.863	0.002 (0.006)	115,644	0.856
Low Rule of Law	0.004 (0.011)	51,939	0.772	0.003 (0.013)	44,821	0.760
High Rule of Law	0.011+ (0.006)	114,256	0.847	0.006 (0.006)	128,049	0.842
Low Primary Ed. Completion	0.015 (0.010)	67,465	0.754	0.011 (0.008)	101,547	0.772
High Primary Ed. Completion	0.004 (0.007)	56,021	0.857	0.005 (0.007)	66,919	0.850

Notes: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05, + p<0.1. Robust bias-corrected estimates (SE in parentheses) of CMB eligibility on not marrying before age 16, using Calonico et al. (2014). Treatment is fixed at the true eligibility cutoff throughout. N is total sample size, Mean the weighted control-group mean within the estimation bandwidth. The $n = 24$ sample adds Gabon, Kazakhstan, Chad and Zambia to the main $n = 20$ sample.

Table A7: First Stage by Subsample, M17+: 24-Country vs. 20-Country Sample

	n = 24			n = 20		
Subsample	Estimate (SE)	N	Mean	Estimate (SE)	N	Mean
Full Sample	0.015* (0.007)	137,217	0.723	0.014+ (0.008)	123,574	0.720
Ever Married	0.024** (0.008)	163,687	0.651	0.006 (0.008)	153,488	0.662
Excluding Pregnancy-Driven Marriage	0.017* (0.007)	142,920	0.732	0.015* (0.007)	126,091	0.728
Rural	0.030*** (0.009)	109,100	0.656	0.027* (0.011)	73,232	0.659
Urban	-0.009 (0.008)	85,005	0.815	-0.011 (0.008)	82,607	0.810
Age 18-24	0.020* (0.010)	69,098	0.713	0.026* (0.012)	57,402	0.708
Age 25-34	0.019 (0.013)	42,204	0.725	0.016 (0.014)	34,947	0.720
Age 35+	0.023 (0.026)	10,891	0.743	0.004 (0.028)	8,761	0.742
No Primary Education	0.011 (0.015)	51,906	0.515	0.003 (0.016)	47,503	0.529
Primary Education	0.012+ (0.007)	112,802	0.815	0.024** (0.008)	80,202	0.815
Not Literate	0.019+ (0.012)	80,949	0.583	0.013 (0.012)	76,004	0.581
Literate	0.010 (0.007)	88,982	0.858	0.009 (0.007)	97,934	0.857
Poor (Median)	0.019* (0.010)	89,160	0.658	0.017+ (0.010)	94,839	0.660
Non-Poor (Median)	0.010 (0.009)	76,958	0.795	0.007 (0.009)	81,471	0.797
Poor (75P)	0.018* (0.008)	125,557	0.685	0.016* (0.008)	140,784	0.687
Non-Poor (75P)	0.005 (0.009)	49,211	0.846	0.009 (0.010)	38,551	0.848
Christian	0.017 (0.011)	54,714	0.772	0.016 (0.016)	29,156	0.775
Muslim	-0.002 (0.008)	97,110	0.698	-0.001 (0.009)	77,613	0.708
Low Child Marriage Rate	0.006 (0.009)	34,188	0.813	0.006 (0.009)	42,551	0.800
Medium Child Marriage Rate	0.026* (0.012)	55,780	0.771	0.040** (0.012)	55,686	0.767
High Child Marriage Rate	0.026+ (0.015)	54,622	0.547	0.018 (0.015)	54,461	0.566
Low Adolescent Fertility	0.009 (0.008)	66,006	0.808	0.000 (0.009)	65,110	0.800
High Adolescent Fertility	0.028* (0.011)	79,264	0.625	0.021* (0.010)	108,092	0.617
Autocracy	0.005 (0.023)	22,160	0.655	0.041 (0.029)	12,035	0.655
Anocracy	0.019+ (0.010)	83,601	0.726	0.015 (0.009)	85,765	0.731
Democracy	0.010 (0.016)	17,008	0.789	0.022 (0.017)	14,886	0.786
No Previous Age	-0.075*** (0.017)	23,404	0.710	0.110*** (0.019)	25,589	0.710
Previous Age 16/17	0.016 (0.010)	57,886	0.725	0.013 (0.011)	54,639	0.701
Previous Age 14/15	0.026* (0.012)	59,994	0.725	0.010 (0.009)	108,941	0.753
Low GDP p.c.	0.025* (0.011)	71,649	0.651	0.024* (0.011)	75,553	0.651
High GDP p.c.	0.006 (0.010)	53,767	0.776	-0.007 (0.009)	62,615	0.792
Low Gov. Effectiveness	0.023* (0.011)	65,152	0.637	0.021+ (0.012)	58,028	0.638
High Gov. Effectiveness	0.008 (0.009)	84,784	0.773	-0.003 (0.009)	79,119	0.767
Low Rule of Law	0.017 (0.013)	47,301	0.674	0.019 (0.015)	41,236	0.663
High Rule of Law	-0.006 (0.008)	124,322	0.753	0.008 (0.007)	123,384	0.748
Low Primary Ed. Completion	0.009 (0.009)	113,755	0.646	0.009 (0.011)	87,975	0.669
High Primary Ed. Completion	0.005 (0.008)	83,014	0.771	0.025* (0.011)	44,382	0.762

Notes: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05, + p<0.1. Robust bias-corrected estimates (SE in parentheses) of CMB eligibility on not marrying before age 17, using Calonico et al. (2014). Treatment is fixed at the true eligibility cutoff throughout. N is total sample size, Mean the weighted control-group mean within the estimation bandwidth. The $n = 24$ sample adds Gabon, Kazakhstan, Chad and Zambia to the main $n = 20$ sample.

D.2 Effect of CMBs on Life-Cycle Outcomes

Table A8: Effect of CMBs on Total Children

	Reduced Form			*Fuzzy RD*		
Subsample	Estimate	BW	N	Estimate	BW	N
Full Sample	0.03 (0.02)	49.4	181,145	*12.11 (11.87)*	*56.0*	*181,514*
Ever Married	0.04 (0.02)	65.7	173,834	*3.68 (3.73)*	*42.1*	*113,264*
Excluding Pregnancy-Driven	0.02 (0.03)	47.1	158,866	*1.13 (3.97)*	*42.0*	*126,248*
Rural	0.05^{+} (0.03)	51.2	107,922	*3.64 (3.48)*	*45.8*	*84,716*
Urban	-0.02 (0.04)	42.8	66,704	*-0.34 (5.89)*	*51.2*	*73,770*
Age 18–24	0.05* (0.02)	54.0	83,287	*6.00*** (1.52)*	*30.3*	*43,909*
Age 25–34	0.07 (0.06)	18.3	33,627	*-5.38 (6.33)*	*34.7*	*53,910*
Age 35+	0.06 (0.17)	23.2	7,343	*219.6 (581.2)*	*28.1*	*9,166*
No Primary Education	0.02 (0.06)	34.7	35,919	*-5.81 (113.01)*	*48.7*	*43,826*
Primary Education	0.01 (0.02)	54.6	143,043	*1.28 (3.47)*	*53.3*	*126,929*
Not Literate	0.02 (0.04)	57.3	90,520	*-62.93 (212.5)*	*51.6*	*70,403*
Literate	0.02 (0.03)	48.5	85,632	*3.63 (3.13)*	*71.3*	*110,772*
Poor (Median)	0.11*** (0.03)	61.8	109,657	*4.47 (4.35)*	*47.9*	*76,958*
Non-Poor (Median)	0.00 (0.03)	61.1	112,370	*29.61 (78.81)*	*43.3*	*73,010*
Poor (75P)	0.08** (0.03)	43.0	119,807	*9.31 (8.58)*	*58.1*	*142,244*
Non-Poor (75P)	-0.01 (0.03)	68.3	62,673	*-2.52 (9.76)*	*48.3*	*40,686*
Christian	0.07* (0.03)	55.9	88,590	*-13.44 (12.72)*	*44.0*	*61,523*
Muslim	-0.06 (0.05)	26.8	41,918	*1.61 (2.56)*	*62.9*	*91,257*
Low Child Marriage Rate	-0.07 (0.05)	27.3	27,140	*-3.69** (1.24)*	*38.6*	*37,665*
Medium Child Marriage Rate	0.02 (0.04)	49.3	64,373	*-701.9^{+} (392.1)*	*53.7*	*64,800*
High Child Marriage Rate	0.06 (0.05)	37.8	51,760	*-3.73^{+} (2.24)*	*42.9*	*47,137*
Previous Age 16/17	-0.03 (0.04)	41.6	56,721	*-0.59 (1.00)*	*47.4*	*58,982*
Previous Age 14/15	0.13** (0.05)	32.0	54,493	*10.51 (14.52)*	*33.4*	*51,369*
No Previous Age	-0.08 (0.07)	40.6	23,848	*-2.25 (2.66)*	*33.1*	*18,176*
Low Adolescent Fertility	-0.01 (0.03)	47.7	76,334	*0.38 (2.66)*	*45.9*	*68,940*
High Adolescent Fertility	0.05 (0.04)	36.7	75,666	*78.55 (52.31)*	*34.6*	*62,388*
Autocracy	0.02 (0.05)	48.9	32,395	*-1.19 (8.88)*	*34.9*	*21,315*
Anocracy	0.02 (0.04)	33.9	80,844	*6.94 (7.89)*	*56.8*	*115,252*
Democracy	0.18* (0.08)	15.1	8,578	*25.52*** (3.88)*	*29.9*	*15,786*
Low GDP p.c.	0.01 (0.04)	39.2	73,292	*-0.19 (2.10)*	*28.0*	*45,020*
High GDP p.c.	0.02 (0.03)	57.6	104,294	*25.54 (31.65)*	*48.8*	*82,294*
Low Gov. Effectiveness	-0.02 (0.04)	47.0	78,744	*1.00 (1.78)*	*32.8*	*48,626*
High Gov. Effectiveness	0.06^{+} (0.03)	38.8	78,010	*-1669 (3689)*	*35.6*	*64,933*
Low Rule of Law	-0.01 (0.04)	38.6	54,284	*4.32 (2.73)*	*33.8*	*42,747*
High Rule of Law	0.04 (0.03)	58.6	130,744	*29.00 (26.63)*	*40.7*	*82,771*
Low Primary Ed. Completion	0.06 (0.04)	29.1	54,055	*-7.33 (5.15)*	*49.6*	*77,564*
High Primary Ed. Completion	-0.06^{+} (0.04)	27.4	51,635	*-0.56 (1.36)*	*50.5*	*86,172*

Notes: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05, + p<0.1. RF is the robust bias-corrected RD estimate of CMB eligibility on total children. Fuzzy RD is the corresponding 2SLS estimate for not marrying before age 18 (Calonico et al., 2014). Each uses its own MSE-optimal bandwidth (BW, in months). N is total effective observations. Fuzzy RD estimates in italics have a weak instrument (F<10) and are unreliable. Robust standard errors in parentheses.

Table A9: Effect of CMBs on Births After Age 18

	Reduced Form			*Fuzzy RD*		
Subsample	Estimate	BW	N	Estimate	BW	N
Full Sample	0.01 (0.01)	42.6	145,215	*3.89 (3.40)*	*57.8*	*187,970*
Ever Married	0.03** (0.01)	44.7	120,816	*2.21 (1.50)*	*48.8*	*128,176*
Excluding Pregnancy-Driven	0.02* (0.01)	55.7	169,052	*1.14 (0.94)*	*34.6*	*103,149*
Rural	0.03** (0.01)	64.9	121,101	*1.56+ (0.87)*	*44.6*	*82,891*
Urban	0.01 (0.01)	38.2	57,331	*-0.65 (2.04)*	*65.0*	*92,946*
Age 18–24	0.01 (0.01)	29.6	43,894	*1.82* (0.83)*	*30.7*	*43,909*
Age 25–34	0.00 (0.01)	38.4	61,885	*2.90 (2.35)*	*28.8*	*44,057*
Age 35+	0.08* (0.03)	21.5	6,624	*45.57 (50.47)*	*24.5*	*7,677*
No Primary Education	0.02 (0.02)	51.5	47,588	*1.42 (56.88)*	*49.3*	*44,484*
Primary Education	0.02* (0.01)	61.3	149,111	*2.26 (1.97)*	*61.3*	*144,335*
Not Literate	0.03* (0.01)	39.6	56,142	*-24.08 (100.1)*	*52.3*	*71,991*
Literate	0.02 (0.01)	47.8	78,365	*1.57 (1.26)*	*60.3*	*94,789*
Poor (Median)	0.01 (0.01)	46.8	77,676	*1.16 (1.20)*	*49.7*	*79,732*
Non-Poor (Median)	0.01 (0.01)	48.9	84,051	*9.03 (22.20)*	*41.3*	*69,612*
Poor (75P)	0.02* (0.01)	44.6	112,882	*3.22 (2.88)*	*61.9*	*148,605*
Non-Poor (75P)	0.01 (0.01)	51.7	45,062	*1.22 (4.09)*	*47.8*	*39,952*
Christian	0.04*** (0.01)	47.3	69,087	*-0.54 (3.06)*	*58.4*	*80,205*
Muslim	0.01 (0.01)	78.9	116,070	*0.65 (0.65)*	*68.3*	*100,465*
Low Child Marriage Rate	0.01 (0.02)	35.0	33,781	*-0.01 (0.50)*	*46.5*	*45,482*
Medium Child Marriage Rate	0.02+ (0.01)	42.7	52,833	*-2.81*** (0.33)*	*45.5*	*55,373*
High Child Marriage Rate	0.01 (0.01)	53.3	62,246	*-0.96 (0.75)*	*55.4*	*59,849*
Previous Age 16/17	-0.01 (0.01)	37.8	47,776	*0.14 (0.46)*	*47.8*	*58,982*
Previous Age 14/15	0.02+ (0.01)	50.0	79,917	*-4.50 (28.43)*	*47.4*	*71,644*
No Previous Age	0.03 (0.02)	31.2	17,281	*-1.49 (1.55)*	*24.4*	*13,381*
Low Adolescent Fertility	0.03* (0.01)	49.4	76,280	*3.75+ (1.99)*	*57.5*	*87,006*
High Adolescent Fertility	-0.00 (0.01)	44.3	83,852	*1.13 (2.35)*	*35.2*	*64,015*
Autocracy	0.04 (0.02)	30.5	18,892	*-69.29 (1015)*	*47.4*	*29,099*
Anocracy	0.00 (0.01)	29.4	64,562	*3.77 (3.36)*	*59.2*	*120,492*
Democracy	0.05 (0.03)	14.2	8,111	8.42*** (0.97)	30.8	16,310
Low GDP p.c.	-0.01 (0.01)	34.1	58,680	*-0.18 (0.83)*	*32.1*	*52,688*
High GDP p.c.	0.03* (0.01)	40.9	69,853	*6.46 (17.09)*	*49.1*	*83,885*
Low Gov. Effectiveness	0.00 (0.01)	31.8	48,701	*-0.14 (0.54)*	*24.0*	*33,868*
High Gov. Effectiveness	0.04** (0.01)	30.6	58,101	*-11.21 (36.40)*	*40.8*	*73,491*
Low Rule of Law	0.01 (0.01)	45.2	60,305	*0.34 (0.70)*	*31.9*	*40,029*
High Rule of Law	0.04** (0.01)	31.5	66,650	*8.57 (10.63)*	*42.8*	*86,802*
Low Primary Ed. Completion	0.02* (0.01)	35.8	60,173	*-1.72 (1.87)*	*61.6*	*95,297*
High Primary Ed. Completion	0.00 (0.01)	41.3	71,984	*0.89 (0.60)*	*53.9*	*91,537*

Notes: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05, + p<0.1. RF is the robust bias-corrected RD estimate of CMB eligibility on births after age 18. Fuzzy RD is the corresponding 2SLS estimate for not marrying before age 18 (Calonico et al., 2014). Each uses its own MSE-optimal bandwidth (BW, in months). N is total effective observations. Fuzzy RD estimates in italics have a weak instrument (F<10) and are unreliable. Robust standard errors in parentheses.

Table A10: Effect of CMBs on Completed Secondary Education

	Reduced Form			*Fuzzy RD*		
Subsample	Estimate	BW	N	Estimate	BW	N
Full Sample	0.00 (0.01)	59.5	210,171	*1.75 (1.39)*	*60.9*	*190,569*
Ever Married	0.02* (0.01)	35.1	93,220	*1.02 (0.69)*	*38.2*	*98,403*
Excluding Pregnancy-Driven	0.00 (0.01)	60.4	194,231	*1.15 (0.99)*	*51.3*	*147,222*
Rural	-0.00 (0.01)	67.7	135,134	*0.03 (0.56)*	*63.5*	*111,011*
Urban	0.02 (0.01)	50.5	77,003	*-3.88 (29.86)*	*50.5*	*70,801*
Age 18–24	0.01 (0.01)	38.1	59,047	*0.38 (0.66)*	*23.4*	*34,090*
Age 25–34	-0.00 (0.01)	43.7	74,247	*2.19 (2.12)*	*27.5*	*39,847*
Age 35+	0.02 (0.04)	27.2	8,761	*-0.59 (1.50)*	*13.9*	*3,568*
Not Literate	-0.00 (0.00)	51.7	78,642	*1.44 (3.53)*	*58.2*	*78,079*
Literate	0.01 (0.01)	67.4	113,313	*1.26 (1.06)*	*61.2*	*93,271*
Poor (Median)	-0.00 (0.01)	74.7	127,726	*0.29 (0.62)*	*55.2*	*86,521*
Non-Poor (Median)	0.00 (0.01)	56.3	101,741	*23.53 (45.19)*	*66.6*	*105,980*
Poor (75P)	0.00 (0.01)	62.1	163,344	*0.31 (0.77)*	*71.0*	*165,135*
Non-Poor (75P)	0.01 (0.01)	60.1	54,253	*5.48 (9.72)*	*52.1*	*42,635*
Christian	-0.00 (0.01)	55.7	85,152	*-0.42 (0.93)*	*55.2*	*72,869*
Muslim	0.01 (0.01)	58.5	91,329	*0.78 (0.70)*	*57.9*	*83,915*
Low Child Marriage Rate	0.04+ (0.02)	27.6	26,829	0.57 (0.52)	28.3	27,763
Medium Child Marriage Rate	-0.01 (0.01)	33.5	44,612	*-2.46 (6.19)*	*42.9*	*51,789*
High Child Marriage Rate	-0.00 (0.01)	40.8	52,525	*0.45 (0.88)*	*27.1*	*27,686*
Previous Age 16/17	-0.01 (0.01)	65.7	86,459	*0.31 (0.38)*	*38.1*	*47,850*
Previous Age 14/15	0.02+ (0.01)	40.3	65,796	*2.12 (3.21)*	*45.0*	*64,546*
No Previous Age	0.01 (0.02)	41.8	24,543	*-1.20* (0.52)*	*51.5*	*27,503*
Low Adolescent Fertility	0.02 (0.01)	56.2	89,927	*1.73+ (0.95)*	*43.6*	*65,279*
High Adolescent Fertility	-0.00 (0.01)	43.7	87,236	*0.72 (2.67)*	*40.7*	*68,757*
Autocracy	0.01 (0.02)	44.2	29,942	*-1.66 (5.29)*	*36.3*	*22,389*
Anocracy	0.00 (0.01)	73.6	161,781	*1.44 (1.29)*	*44.4*	*87,904*
Democracy	-0.08*** (0.02)	39.4	20,727	*0.21 (0.99)*	*54.4*	*28,077*
Low GDP p.c.	-0.01 (0.01)	44.6	79,664	*0.30 (0.65)*	*32.6*	*49,965*
High GDP p.c.	0.02+ (0.01)	55.8	99,866	*12.23 (12.97)*	*55.0*	*93,348*
Low Gov. Effectiveness	-0.01 (0.01)	48.5	80,120	*-0.28 (0.53)*	*79.2*	*114,822*
High Gov. Effectiveness	0.01 (0.01)	55.4	105,602	*1.48 (27.86)*	*45.7*	*77,604*
Low Rule of Law	-0.01 (0.01)	47.6	67,594	*-0.39 (0.94)*	*54.8*	*67,928*
High Rule of Law	0.02* (0.01)	54.1	116,885	*-8.91 (6.14)*	*41.3*	*80,819*
Low Primary Ed. Completion	-0.01 (0.01)	45.7	79,729	*1.73 (4.04)*	*41.1*	*62,703*
High Primary Ed. Completion	0.01 (0.01)	57.0	105,627	*1.34* (0.60)*	*56.0*	*94,027*

Notes: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05, + p<0.1. RF is the robust bias-corrected RD estimate of CMB eligibility on completed secondary education. Education-level subsamples omitted as not meaningfully estimable, since the split variable and the outcome both measure educational attainment. Fuzzy RD is the corresponding 2SLS estimate for not marrying before age 18 (Calonico et al., 2014). Each uses its own MSE-optimal bandwidth (BW, in months). N is total effective observations. Fuzzy RD estimates in italics have a weak instrument (F<10) and are unreliable. Robust standard errors in parentheses.

Table A11: Effect of CMBs on Completed Higher Education

	Reduced Form			*Fuzzy RD*		
Subsample	Estimate	BW	N	Estimate	BW	N
Full Sample	0.00 (0.01)	61.3	215,956	*1.00 (1.06)*	*59.2*	*187,990*
Ever Married	0.01^{+} (0.01)	38.5	100,187	*0.65 (0.54)*	*42.1*	*109,345*
Excluding Pregnancy-Driven	0.00 (0.01)	58.7	188,871	*0.52 (0.70)*	*52.6*	*150,218*
Rural	0.00 (0.00)	71.0	140,887	*0.05 (0.36)*	*60.0*	*106,224*
Urban	0.01 (0.01)	56.8	86,046	*-2.49 (7.91)*	*55.9*	*77,820*
Age 18–24	0.01 (0.01)	39.2	60,392	*0.53 (0.54)*	*27.3*	*39,351*
Age 25–34	-0.00 (0.01)	56.5	93,381	*0.72 (1.36)*	*31.9*	*46,510*
Age 35+	-0.03 (0.04)	24.4	7,677	*-0.02 (0.81)*	*13.8*	*3,568*
Not Literate	0.00 (0.00)	39.2	60,499	*0.04 (0.10)*	*52.2*	*69,934*
Literate	0.01 (0.01)	64.8	108,526	*0.15 (0.87)*	*57.5*	*87,875*
Poor (Median)	0.00 (0.00)	59.4	103,632	*0.30 (0.39)*	*65.2*	*101,266*
Non-Poor (Median)	0.00 (0.01)	60.7	108,024	*7.27 (22.53)*	*65.4*	*104,333*
Poor (75P)	0.01 (0.00)	65.5	171,101	*0.28 (0.62)*	*68.7*	*160,750*
Non-Poor (75P)	-0.00 (0.01)	62.0	55,745	*3.84 (7.74)*	*60.7*	*48,636*
Christian	-0.00 (0.01)	49.7	76,044	*0.36 (0.63)*	*61.8*	*79,841*
Muslim	0.02^{+} (0.01)	45.8	72,092	*0.74 (0.62)*	*57.1*	*83,915*
Low Child Marriage Rate	0.03^{+} (0.02)	28.6	27,768	*0.47 (0.42)*	*25.1*	*24,881*
Medium Child Marriage Rate	-0.01 (0.01)	40.9	53,012	*-2.93 (6.60)*	*44.0*	*54,191*
High Child Marriage Rate	-0.00 (0.01)	67.2	84,134	*-0.17 (0.62)*	*29.3*	*30,099*
Previous Age 16/17	-0.01 (0.01)	42.3	57,993	*-0.40 (0.40)*	*45.4*	*56,696*
Previous Age 14/15	0.01^{+} (0.01)	44.5	72,681	*1.91 (4.97)*	*46.4*	*65,751*
No Previous Age	0.01 (0.01)	63.3	37,318	-5.09*** (0.57)	58.6	31,638
Low Adolescent Fertility	0.01 (0.01)	51.2	82,404	*0.79 (0.72)*	*40.7*	*60,933*
High Adolescent Fertility	-0.00 (0.00)	56.3	110,835	*-0.30 (5.64)*	*46.5*	*78,929*
Autocracy	-0.00 (0.01)	35.8	23,801	*0.36 (2.52)*	*40.5*	*24,577*
Anocracy	0.00 (0.01)	57.9	129,944	*0.22 (0.88)*	*63.9*	*121,266*
Democracy	-0.00 (0.01)	38.3	20,248	*0.46 (0.57)*	*44.1*	*23,335*
Low GDP p.c.	-0.01 (0.01)	49.4	86,975	*-0.46 (0.98)*	*43.4*	*66,128*
High GDP p.c.	0.01 (0.01)	52.5	94,760	*8.52 (10.04)*	*56.2*	*95,194*
Low Gov. Effectiveness	-0.00 (0.01)	59.7	97,571	*-0.23 (0.46)*	*58.8*	*86,833*
High Gov. Effectiveness	0.01 (0.01)	55.8	105,602	*1.64 (10.35)*	*56.9*	*95,251*
Low Rule of Law	-0.01 (0.01)	63.1	87,366	*-0.58 (1.26)*	*52.5*	*65,242*
High Rule of Law	0.01^{+} (0.01)	53.8	114,794	*1.14 (5.02)*	*40.9*	*78,877*
Low Primary Ed. Completion	-0.00 (0.01)	51.8	87,820	*0.61 (1.13)*	*44.2*	*67,502*
High Primary Ed. Completion	0.01 (0.01)	51.1	95,089	*0.57 (0.42)*	*62.1*	*104,846*

Notes: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05, $^{+}$ p<0.1. RF is the robust bias-corrected RD estimate of CMB eligibility on completed higher education. Education-level subsamples omitted as not meaningfully estimable, since the split variable and the outcome both measure educational attainment. Fuzzy RD is the corresponding 2SLS estimate for not marrying before age 18 (Calonico et al., 2014). Each uses its own MSE-optimal bandwidth (BW, in months). N is total effective observations. Fuzzy RD estimates in italics have a weak instrument (F<10) and are unreliable. Robust standard errors in parentheses.

Table A12: Effect of CMBs on Worked Last Year

	Reduced Form			*Fuzzy RD*		
Subsample	Estimate	BW	N	Estimate	BW	N
Full Sample	0.00 (0.01)	53.5	160,957	*0.60 (1.83)*	*49.9*	*149,094*
Ever Married	0.00 (0.01)	65.1	156,464	*-0.16 (1.00)*	*48.6*	*117,365*
Excluding Pregnancy-Driven	0.00 (0.01)	55.8	149,169	*0.34 (1.27)*	*49.0*	*133,184*
Rural	0.00 (0.01)	66.9	114,380	*0.09 (0.69)*	*47.6*	*83,170*
Urban	0.01 (0.01)	47.7	60,827	*-0.70 (1.40)*	*54.8*	*69,329*
Age 18–24	-0.01 (0.01)	57.0	72,695	*-1.59 (1.44)*	*24.6*	*32,807*
Age 25–34	0.01 (0.01)	41.6	58,215	*-1.53 (5.91)*	*21.5*	*30,101*
Age 35+	-0.04 (0.04)	23.1	7,342	*-103.3 (68.62)*	*23.4*	*7,342*
No Primary Education	0.01 (0.01)	55.7	49,312	*1.75 (31.69)*	*50.1*	*44,627*
Primary Education	0.00 (0.01)	49.3	105,183	*0.69 (1.48)*	*50.9*	*107,159*
Not Literate	0.00 (0.01)	52.7	71,191	*-2.53 (12.30)*	*65.1*	*88,497*
Literate	0.01 (0.01)	56.8	86,416	*0.71 (1.20)*	*55.9*	*84,970*
Poor (Median)	0.00 (0.01)	43.6	64,865	*0.04 (0.76)*	*65.7*	*95,677*
Non-Poor (Median)	0.01 (0.01)	56.8	86,829	*-1.25 (4.40)*	*48.5*	*74,879*
Poor (75P)	-0.00 (0.01)	59.9	132,428	*-0.26 (1.27)*	*49.4*	*110,496*
Non-Poor (75P)	0.02 (0.02)	55.9	43,144	*32.65 (107.5)*	*56.8*	*43,877*
Christian	0.01 (0.01)	43.6	57,981	*-1.22 (1.47)*	*47.7*	*63,033*
Muslim	-0.01 (0.01)	53.5	67,646	*-0.51 (0.83)*	*55.2*	*70,281*
Low Child Marriage Rate	0.00 (0.02)	40.3	31,807	*0.05 (0.55)*	*44.7*	*34,752*
Medium Child Marriage Rate	0.07* (0.03)	14.0	16,815	*-1.08 (3.50)*	*11.8*	*13,662*
High Child Marriage Rate	-0.03 (0.02)	23.4	25,978	*2.17 (3.34)*	*22.1*	*25,059*
Previous Age 16/17	-0.02 (0.01)	46.0	54,253	*-0.98+ (0.55)*	*37.9*	*44,641*
Previous Age 14/15	-0.02 (0.01)	41.4	54,564	41.27*** (5.41)	31.1	41,504
No Previous Age	0.03 (0.02)	58.8	31,674	*-0.74 (0.69)*	*58.2*	*31,674*
Low Adolescent Fertility	0.02 (0.01)	37.0	46,077	*1.63 (1.24)*	*42.3*	*53,679*
High Adolescent Fertility	-0.02+ (0.01)	32.6	58,815	*-11.66+ (6.95)*	*38.5*	*68,106*
Autocracy	-0.00 (0.03)	32.4	20,160	*-1.16 (4.42)*	*40.4*	*24,569*
Anocracy	0.00 (0.01)	44.9	80,770	*0.71 (1.66)*	*48.2*	*87,299*
Democracy	-0.09*** (0.02)	32.9	17,458	*0.40 (0.94)*	*39.0*	*20,722*
Low GDP p.c.	-0.01 (0.01)	50.3	79,154	*-1.09 (1.71)*	*57.1*	*89,876*
High GDP p.c.	0.02 (0.01)	58.1	84,396	*14.73 (21.22)*	*47.5*	*68,802*
Low Gov. Effectiveness	-0.01 (0.01)	55.3	82,033	*-0.31 (0.70)*	*61.0*	*89,893*
High Gov. Effectiveness	0.02 (0.01)	39.1	61,527	*-1.81 (4.07)*	*43.7*	*67,608*
Low Rule of Law	-0.02 (0.02)	39.2	49,120	*-0.88 (1.77)*	*55.3*	*68,761*
High Rule of Law	0.02 (0.01)	45.4	81,360	*24.79 (45.05)*	*38.6*	*68,725*
Low Primary Ed. Completion	0.00 (0.01)	47.9	74,812	*-0.77 (1.39)*	*59.3*	*92,265*
High Primary Ed. Completion	-0.00 (0.01)	65.6	94,229	*-0.05 (0.61)*	*52.2*	*76,564*

Notes: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05, + p<0.1. RF is the robust bias-corrected RD estimate of CMB eligibility on worked last year. Fuzzy RD is the corresponding 2SLS estimate for not marrying before age 18 (Calonico et al., 2014). Each uses its own MSE-optimal bandwidth (BW, in months). N is total effective observations. Fuzzy RD estimates in italics have a weak instrument (F<10) and are unreliable. Robust standard errors in parentheses.

Table A13: Effect of CMBs on Decision-Making (Empowerment)

	Reduced Form			*Fuzzy RD*		
Subsample	Estimate	BW	N	Estimate	BW	N
Full Sample	0.00 (0.01)	43.2	103,015	*0.11 (0.41)*	*46.6*	*109,839*
Ever Married	-0.00 (0.01)	61.2	136,491	*0.08 (0.41)*	*45.2*	*103,237*
Excluding Pregnancy-Driven	0.00 (0.01)	35.5	73,740	*-0.04 (0.33)*	*48.8*	*99,908*
Rural	0.00 (0.01)	55.3	78,577	*0.04 (0.39)*	*53.2*	*75,730*
Urban	0.00 (0.01)	44.2	41,425	*0.57 (1.90)*	*49.5*	*45,642*
Age 18–24	0.01 (0.01)	41.8	36,324	*0.21 (0.58)*	*43.4*	*38,108*
Age 25–34	-0.00 (0.01)	39.1	49,214	*0.18 (0.46)*	*35.7*	*44,603*
Age 35+	-0.07^{+} (0.04)	18.5	3,323	*37.89^{+} (22.77)*	*23.4*	*4,594*
No Primary Education	-0.01 (0.01)	58.1	44,743	*3.02 (23.42)*	*70.2*	*54,412*
Primary Education	0.01 (0.01)	37.4	59,592	*0.32 (0.34)*	*40.8*	*64,271*
Not Literate	-0.00 (0.01)	52.8	59,165	*-0.25 (4.65)*	*42.5*	*48,782*
Literate	0.01 (0.01)	36.3	36,757	*0.23 (0.50)*	*59.1*	*58,957*
Poor (Median)	-0.00 (0.01)	55.2	67,919	*-0.03 (0.32)*	*41.0*	*49,915*
Non-Poor (Median)	0.00 (0.01)	40.3	45,552	*0.40 (1.18)*	*51.2*	*57,316*
Poor (75P)	-0.00 (0.01)	53.9	97,006	*0.13 (0.37)*	*44.6*	*81,920*
Non-Poor (75P)	0.00 (0.01)	42.1	22,485	*0.44 (1.97)*	*57.7*	*30,034*
Christian	0.01 (0.01)	36.3	32,267	*-0.72 (0.82)*	*54.9*	*47,741*
Muslim	0.01 (0.01)	52.8	56,990	*0.22 (0.28)*	*57.6*	*62,559*
Low Child Marriage Rate	0.01 (0.01)	56.7	37,050	*0.29 (0.22)*	*51.7*	*33,857*
Medium Child Marriage Rate	0.01 (0.01)	21.3	19,039	*0.38 (0.97)*	*36.6*	*32,386*
High Child Marriage Rate	0.38*** (0.04)	36.1	29,771	*-1.71 (1.06)*	*31.1*	*25,958*
Previous Age 16/17	0.01 (0.01)	51.9	45,992	*0.12 (0.33)*	*54.3*	*48,609*
Previous Age 14/15	-0.01 (0.01)	35.6	37,010	*0.07 (0.46)*	*21.6*	*22,311*
No Previous Age	0.02 (0.02)	33.9	14,284	*-0.44 (0.40)*	*42.5*	*18,157*
Low Adolescent Fertility	0.02* (0.01)	34.3	34,270	*0.56^{+} (0.34)*	*51.3*	*51,151*
High Adolescent Fertility	-0.01 (0.01)	41.9	56,833	*145.3 (589.7)*	*39.1*	*53,665*
Autocracy	0.02 (0.02)	38.3	17,719	*0.02 (1.50)*	*36.9*	*16,966*
Anocracy	0.01 (0.01)	40.1	56,909	*0.20 (0.60)*	*54.2*	*76,070*
Democracy	-0.07*** (0.01)	31.3	12,873	*-0.48 (0.44)*	*51.0*	*19,749*
Low GDP p.c.	-0.00 (0.01)	42.8	50,308	*-0.03 (2.04)*	*42.5*	*50,308*
High GDP p.c.	0.02^{+} (0.01)	31.8	37,550	*0.72 (0.61)*	*44.6*	*52,640*
Low Gov. Effectiveness	-0.00 (0.01)	60.5	65,867	*-0.15 (0.55)*	*50.2*	*55,340*
High Gov. Effectiveness	0.01 (0.01)	32.7	41,375	*0.74 (0.82)*	*39.3*	*49,389*
Low Rule of Law	0.01 (0.01)	52.5	44,153	*0.34 (0.96)*	*45.1*	*39,133*
High Rule of Law	0.00 (0.01)	35.1	53,731	*-0.00 (0.69)*	*47.0*	*69,986*
Low Primary Ed. Completion	0.00 (0.01)	34.0	40,604	*-0.91 (2.63)*	*42.7*	*50,992*
High Primary Ed. Completion	0.00 (0.01)	61.2	70,838	*0.22 (0.29)*	*42.4*	*49,571*

Notes: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05, + p<0.1. RF is the robust bias-corrected RD estimate of CMB eligibility on decision-making (empowerment). Fuzzy RD is the corresponding 2SLS estimate for not marrying before age 18 (Calonico et al., 2014). Each uses its own MSE-optimal bandwidth (BW, in months). N is total effective observations. Fuzzy RD estimates in italics have a weak instrument (F<10) and are unreliable. Robust standard errors in parentheses.

Table A14: Effect of CMBs on IPV Justification

	Reduced Form			*Fuzzy RD*		
Subsample	Estimate	BW	N	Estimate	BW	N
Full Sample	-0.02*** (0.01)	27.6	101,330	*-1.31 (1.38)*	*54.4*	*178,325*
Ever Married	-0.01 (0.01)	36.7	98,762	0.17 (0.47)	65.0	170,945
Excluding Pregnancy-Driven	-0.02*** (0.01)	25.6	85,724	*-0.40 (0.77)*	*60.8*	*176,484*
Rural	-0.03*** (0.01)	25.7	53,623	*-0.89 (0.75)*	*55.5*	*102,012*
Urban	-0.00 (0.01)	50.8	78,533	*0.18 (1.24)*	*59.9*	*84,953*
Age 18–24	-0.02* (0.01)	57.3	87,856	*-4.47+ (2.71)*	*61.5*	*83,858*
Age 25–34	0.02* (0.01)	19.0	35,636	*2.09 (1.94)*	*28.8*	*44,057*
Age 35+	0.01 (0.02)	31.4	10,470	*117.5 (73.46)*	*19.9*	*5,849*
No Primary Education	0.01 (0.01)	56.6	58,304	*-11.04 (28.91)*	*62.1*	*55,863*
Primary Education	-0.02** (0.01)	29.5	79,020	*-2.08 (1.38)*	*60.2*	*142,316*
Not Literate	0.01 (0.01)	54.9	85,754	*-6.05 (20.11)*	*64.7*	*87,995*
Literate	-0.01 (0.01)	56.9	99,102	*-0.64 (0.49)*	*84.8*	*128,765*
Poor (Median)	-0.03*** (0.01)	26.9	47,889	*-0.81 (0.78)*	*51.6*	*82,834*
Non-Poor (Median)	-0.01+ (0.01)	38.5	71,714	*-1.79 (10.94)*	*40.7*	*67,853*
Poor (75P)	-0.02*** (0.01)	27.3	75,133	*-0.85 (1.01)*	*45.3*	*112,041*
Non-Poor (75P)	-0.01 (0.01)	44.7	41,917	*-2.75 (7.77)*	*59.3*	*49,407*
Christian	0.01 (0.01)	71.9	111,849	*-0.25 (0.80)*	*60.7*	*82,480*
Muslim	-0.02* (0.01)	33.7	53,421	*-0.76 (0.47)*	*38.1*	*56,610*
Low Child Marriage Rate	-0.04*** (0.01)	33.4	32,794	-0.69+ (0.38)	35.8	34,724
Medium Child Marriage Rate	0.00 (0.01)	67.4	87,694	*0.02 (1.55)*	*37.4*	*45,722*
High Child Marriage Rate	0.01* (0.01)	55.7	75,966	*-0.98 (0.87)*	*42.2*	*47,137*
Previous Age 16/17	-0.00 (0.01)	87.9	113,722	*-0.81* (0.39)*	*49.5*	*61,155*
Previous Age 14/15	0.00 (0.01)	64.2	109,264	*-1.01 (7.46)*	*46.9*	*70,285*
No Previous Age	0.72*** (0.07)	48.3	28,973	*-0.26 (0.46)*	*39.4*	*21,108*
Low Adolescent Fertility	-0.01+ (0.01)	65.8	103,764	*-1.56+ (0.95)*	*49.4*	*75,071*
High Adolescent Fertility	0.01 (0.01)	42.3	88,590	*2.64 (27.28)*	*47.0*	*84,356*
Autocracy	-0.02 (0.02)	42.4	28,387	*-3.24 (13.89)*	*42.0*	*25,314*
Anocracy	-0.02*** (0.01)	23.8	57,155	*-0.53 (3.39)*	*48.5*	*99,853*
Democracy	0.00 (0.02)	17.3	9,725	*0.28 (0.61)*	*49.4*	*25,576*
Low GDP p.c.	-0.03** (0.01)	21.5	40,146	*-0.55 (0.72)*	*38.7*	*61,556*
High GDP p.c.	-0.01 (0.01)	54.0	97,088	*-4.59 (5.93)*	*54.5*	*92,459*
Low Gov. Effectiveness	-0.01 (0.01)	44.4	74,245	*-0.18 (0.71)*	*32.0*	*46,908*
High Gov. Effectiveness	-0.00 (0.00)	49.5	99,672	*0.21 (2.28)*	*49.3*	*88,710*
Low Rule of Law	-0.01 (0.01)	54.8	76,762	*-0.39 (0.72)*	*43.6*	*55,163*
High Rule of Law	-0.00 (0.00)	43.5	98,500	*-0.67 (0.78)*	*66.7*	*134,267*
Low Primary Ed. Completion	0.00 (0.01)	38.0	69,982	*-0.24 (1.87)*	*53.8*	*83,457*
High Primary Ed. Completion	-0.01** (0.01)	52.0	97,671	*-0.59+ (0.31)*	*62.5*	*105,660*

Notes: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05, + p<0.1. RF is the robust bias-corrected RD estimate of CMB eligibility on IPV justification. Fuzzy RD is the corresponding 2SLS estimate for not marrying before age 18 (Calonico et al., 2014). Each uses its own MSE-optimal bandwidth (BW, in months). N is total effective observations. Fuzzy RD estimates in italics have a weak instrument (F<10) and are unreliable. Robust standard errors in parentheses.

Table A15: Effect of CMBs on IPV Experience

	Reduced Form			*Fuzzy RD*		
Subsample	Estimate	BW	N	Estimate	BW	N
Full Sample	0.00 (0.01)	57.1	47,409	*0.11 (0.28)*	*56.7*	*46,655*
Ever Married	0.00 (0.01)	57.9	46,120	*0.16 (0.28)*	*54.8*	*43,836*
Excluding Pregnancy-Driven	0.00 (0.01)	51.5	36,921	*0.09 (0.23)*	*75.2*	*52,710*
Rural	-0.00 (0.01)	58.4	26,849	*-0.55 (0.70)*	*49.6*	*22,691*
Urban	0.01 (0.01)	55.3	20,314	*0.32 (0.33)*	*58.5*	*21,322*
Age 18–24	0.01 (0.01)	43.3	8,630	*0.14 (0.50)*	*32.5*	*6,694*
Age 25–34	0.00 (0.01)	41.3	20,592	*0.07 (0.99)*	*62.4*	*29,557*
Age 35+	0.02 (0.03)	25.2	3,272	*0.24 (0.43)*	*25.3*	*3,272*
No Primary Education	-0.00 (0.01)	65.0	12,151	*-0.62 (115.52)*	*61.0*	*11,431*
Primary Education	0.01 (0.01)	60.6	38,096	*0.15 (0.19)*	*60.9*	*38,096*
Not Literate	0.00 (0.01)	57.1	19,159	*0.12 (0.37)*	*66.1*	*21,911*
Literate	0.00 (0.01)	81.8	32,805	*0.18 (0.39)*	*49.2*	*21,070*
Poor (Median)	-0.01 (0.01)	71.6	29,967	*-0.39 (0.36)*	*75.9*	*31,517*
Non-Poor (Median)	0.01 (0.01)	54.0	21,759	*0.40 (0.41)*	*68.0*	*26,743*
Poor (75P)	0.00 (0.01)	60.2	38,265	*0.10 (0.28)*	*58.6*	*37,220*
Non-Poor (75P)	0.00 (0.01)	57.0	10,620	*0.06 (0.41)*	*55.5*	*10,443*
Christian	0.02 (0.01)	56.1	17,342	*-0.05 (0.64)*	*40.7*	*12,444*
Muslim	0.00 (0.01)	49.7	20,305	*0.14 (0.23)*	*68.8*	*27,677*
Low Child Marriage Rate	-0.00 (0.01)	55.2	15,878	*0.03 (0.18)*	*68.2*	*19,375*
Medium Child Marriage Rate	0.01 (0.01)	36.0	12,834	*0.52 (0.79)*	*22.5*	*7,790*
High Child Marriage Rate	-0.01 (0.01)	49.7	9,400	*0.33 (0.59)*	*48.7*	*9,254*
Previous Age 16/17	-0.00 (0.01)	22.8	8,235	*-0.37 (1.10)*	*13.8*	*4,861*
Previous Age 14/15	0.01 (0.01)	60.4	20,006	*0.21 (0.29)*	*67.0*	*22,023*
No Previous Age	-0.01 (0.01)	55.4	7,797	*-0.04 (0.95)*	*73.6*	*9,955*
Low Adolescent Fertility	-0.00 (0.01)	56.1	27,128	*-0.08 (0.24)*	*42.3*	*20,614*
High Adolescent Fertility	0.01 (0.01)	48.6	16,708	*-5.94 (62.59)*	*76.6*	*25,800*
Autocracy	-0.01 (0.02)	47.2	8,274	*-0.15 (0.81)*	*58.6*	*10,259*
Anocracy	-0.01 (0.01)	29.6	16,442	*0.07 (0.27)*	*60.8*	*32,737*
Democracy	0.03^{+} (0.02)	57.2	4,519	*0.84 (0.89)*	*44.6*	*3,512*
Low GDP p.c.	0.03** (0.01)	48.3	19,274	*1.23 (0.84)*	*58.3*	*23,199*
High GDP p.c.	-0.01 (0.01)	40.0	17,502	*-0.15 (0.32)*	*39.3*	*17,019*
Low Gov. Effectiveness	0.01 (0.01)	51.1	19,343	*0.30 (0.40)*	*53.2*	*20,150*
High Gov. Effectiveness	-0.00 (0.01)	33.4	15,503	*-0.12 (0.47)*	*53.5*	*24,077*
Low Rule of Law	0.00 (0.01)	34.1	10,308	*0.09 (0.36)*	*20.0*	*5,685*
High Rule of Law	-0.00 (0.01)	39.6	21,262	*-0.08 (0.63)*	*37.2*	*20,200*
Low Primary Ed. Completion	-0.00 (0.01)	56.1	17,018	*0.24 (0.80)*	*54.5*	*16,406*
High Primary Ed. Completion	-0.00 (0.01)	37.7	19,802	*-0.01 (0.32)*	*40.7*	*21,412*

Notes: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05, + p<0.1. RF is the robust bias-corrected RD estimate of CMB eligibility on IPV experience. Fuzzy RD is the corresponding 2SLS estimate for not marrying before age 18 (Calonico et al., 2014). Each uses its own MSE-optimal bandwidth (BW, in months). N is total effective observations. Fuzzy RD estimates in italics have a weak instrument (F<10) and are unreliable. Robust standard errors in parentheses.

Table A16: Effect of CMBs on IPV Experience: Emotional

	Reduced Form			*Fuzzy RD*		
Subsample	Estimate	BW	N	Estimate	BW	N
Full Sample	0.00 (0.01)	58.9	48,169	*0.00 (0.40)*	*56.8*	*46,653*
Ever Married	0.00 (0.01)	61.4	48,842	*0.04 (0.41)*	*55.3*	*44,573*
Excluding Pregnancy-Driven	-0.00 (0.01)	56.3	40,485	*-0.00 (0.47)*	*51.3*	*36,919*
Rural	-0.01 (0.01)	55.5	25,517	*-0.93 (1.18)*	*51.9*	*23,604*
Urban	0.02 (0.01)	60.5	21,959	*0.35 (0.41)*	*65.7*	*23,575*
Age 18–24	-0.01 (0.02)	45.1	9,033	*-1.54 (2.05)*	*38.3*	*7,713*
Age 25–34	-0.00 (0.01)	34.6	17,310	*-0.12 (0.89)*	*41.5*	*20,590*
Age 35+	0.02 (0.04)	26.4	3,405	*0.16 (0.65)*	*21.9*	*2,735*
No Primary Education	0.00 (0.02)	63.1	11,935	*16.89 (211.12)*	*62.6*	*11,753*
Primary Education	0.00 (0.01)	64.8	40,319	*0.02 (0.31)*	*53.9*	*34,056*
Not Literate	0.01 (0.02)	61.7	20,255	*0.10 (0.54)*	*68.6*	*22,610*
Literate	-0.00 (0.01)	72.1	29,566	*-0.04 (0.56)*	*59.5*	*24,948*
Poor (Median)	-0.02 (0.01)	76.4	31,970	*-0.63 (0.69)*	*62.5*	*26,366*
Non-Poor (Median)	0.01 (0.01)	54.5	21,757	*0.52 (0.55)*	*74.8*	*28,749*
Poor (75P)	0.00 (0.01)	67.4	42,362	*0.17 (0.43)*	*59.1*	*37,751*
Non-Poor (75P)	-0.01 (0.02)	49.6	9,405	*-0.14 (0.59)*	*55.1*	*10,442*
Christian	-0.00 (0.02)	84.1	24,892	*-0.15 (0.97)*	*41.1*	*12,796*
Muslim	-0.00 (0.01)	52.5	21,531	*0.08 (0.31)*	*78.3*	*31,467*
Low Child Marriage Rate	-0.00 (0.01)	64.1	18,403	*-0.01 (0.26)*	*72.8*	*20,427*
Medium Child Marriage Rate	0.02 (0.02)	62.3	21,472	20.79*** (3.36)	47.2	16,600
High Child Marriage Rate	-0.00 (0.02)	61.4	11,421	*0.20 (0.87)*	*48.2*	*9,253*
Previous Age 16/17	-0.03* (0.01)	54.5	19,279	*-0.78 (0.99)*	*41.4*	*14,865*
Previous Age 14/15	0.01 (0.02)	76.6	25,044	*0.30 (0.46)*	*53.6*	*17,762*
No Previous Age	-0.00 (0.02)	58.0	8,055	*0.53 (2.09)*	*79.1*	*10,844*
Low Adolescent Fertility	-0.01 (0.01)	46.8	22,554	*-0.33 (0.37)*	*42.1*	*20,613*
High Adolescent Fertility	1.33*** (0.21)	47.9	16,431	*-9.28 (121.7)*	*69.9*	*23,716*
Autocracy	-0.01 (0.02)	60.0	10,533	*-0.52 (1.23)*	*70.2*	*12,116*
Anocracy	-0.03 (0.02)	15.1	8,614	*-0.07 (0.38)*	*69.5*	*37,223*
Democracy	0.03 (0.02)	68.7	5,354	*1.21 (1.34)*	*42.1*	*3,355*
Low GDP p.c.	0.03* (0.01)	53.1	21,202	*0.11 (1.04)*	*53.3*	*21,202*
High GDP p.c.	0.00 (0.01)	80.0	33,007	*-0.24 (0.50)*	*47.9*	*20,511*
Low Gov. Effectiveness	-0.05*** (0.02)	53.4	20,148	*0.12 (0.51)*	*60.0*	*22,734*
High Gov. Effectiveness	0.00 (0.02)	53.3	24,077	*-0.03 (0.79)*	*47.9*	*21,504*
Low Rule of Law	-0.01 (0.02)	28.8	8,442	*-0.11 (0.57)*	*21.5*	*6,347*
High Rule of Law	0.00 (0.01)	46.5	25,010	*0.33 (1.65)*	*42.7*	*22,928*
Low Primary Ed. Completion	0.01 (0.02)	57.8	17,318	*-0.07 (1.28)*	*56.9*	*17,018*
High Primary Ed. Completion	-0.02 (0.02)	26.7	14,193	*-0.48 (0.55)*	*31.1*	*16,790*

Notes: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05, + p<0.1. RF is the robust bias-corrected RD estimate of CMB eligibility on IPV experience: emotional. Fuzzy RD is the corresponding 2SLS estimate for not marrying before age 18 (Calonico et al., 2014). Each uses its own MSE-optimal bandwidth (BW, in months). N is total effective observations. Fuzzy RD estimates in italics have a weak instrument (F<10) and are unreliable. Robust standard errors in parentheses.

Table A17: Effect of CMBs on IPV Experience: Physical

	Reduced Form			*Fuzzy RD*		
Subsample	Estimate	BW	N	Estimate	BW	N
Full Sample	0.00 (0.01)	77.3	62,302	*0.14 (0.26)*	*69.6*	*56,322*
Ever Married	0.01 (0.01)	77.6	60,586	*0.19 (0.26)*	*74.2*	*58,192*
Excluding Pregnancy-Driven	0.00 (0.01)	60.5	43,015	*0.13 (0.25)*	*78.7*	*54,760*
Rural	-0.00 (0.01)	75.3	33,793	*-0.17 (0.71)*	*55.6*	*25,517*
Urban	0.01 (0.01)	66.0	23,577	*0.25 (0.26)*	*77.7*	*27,564*
Age 18–24	0.01 (0.01)	53.4	10,439	*-0.39 (3.49)*	*39.2*	*7,897*
Age 25–34	0.00 (0.01)	53.6	25,944	*-0.25 (0.54)*	*37.6*	*18,612*
Age 35+	0.02 (0.03)	26.7	3,405	*0.10 (0.30)*	*33.9*	*4,505*
No Primary Education	-0.01 (0.01)	75.1	14,170	*-1.28 (4.28)*	*74.8*	*13,968*
Primary Education	0.01 (0.01)	76.6	47,026	*0.17 (0.22)*	*61.5*	*38,604*
Not Literate	0.00 (0.01)	61.1	20,257	*0.09 (0.41)*	*63.5*	*20,876*
Literate	0.01 (0.01)	59.3	24,948	*0.38 (0.50)*	*53.2*	*22,664*
Poor (Median)	-0.01 (0.01)	84.3	35,050	*-0.91 (0.69)*	*57.3*	*24,562*
Non-Poor (Median)	0.02* (0.01)	58.8	23,209	*0.56 (0.46)*	*65.3*	*25,620*
Poor (75P)	0.00 (0.01)	72.3	45,217	*0.07 (0.29)*	*66.5*	*41,764*
Non-Poor (75P)	0.01 (0.01)	66.8	12,237	*0.22 (0.46)*	*78.3*	*14,299*
Christian	0.01 (0.01)	64.1	19,356	*0.26 (0.68)*	*45.8*	*14,033*
Muslim	0.00 (0.01)	62.2	25,441	*0.16 (0.28)*	*67.7*	*27,318*
Low Child Marriage Rate	0.00 (0.01)	70.4	19,899	*0.01 (0.19)*	*73.1*	*20,704*
Medium Child Marriage Rate	0.01 (0.01)	37.2	13,163	*0.13 (0.53)*	*54.6*	*19,144*
High Child Marriage Rate	-0.01 (0.01)	44.5	8,624	*0.46 (0.73)*	*40.6*	*7,753*
Previous Age 16/17	0.09*** (0.02)	49.3	17,587	*0.90 (1.56)*	*40.2*	*14,492*
Previous Age 14/15	0.01 (0.01)	72.7	23,799	*0.09 (0.27)*	*66.1*	*22,023*
No Previous Age	-0.00 (0.01)	70.0	9,632	*-0.09 (0.66)*	*83.4*	*11,326*
Low Adolescent Fertility	0.00 (0.01)	83.0	38,205	*0.04 (0.25)*	*49.5*	*23,933*
High Adolescent Fertility	0.01 (0.01)	52.7	18,001	*-9.46 (224.4)*	*68.0*	*23,091*
Autocracy	-0.01 (0.02)	37.0	6,505	*-0.92 (1.09)*	*50.6*	*8,703*
Anocracy	-0.19*** (0.03)	55.3	30,380	*0.00 (0.28)*	*66.7*	*35,660*
Democracy	0.03 (0.02)	48.4	3,756	*0.68 (0.85)*	*45.3*	*3,566*
Low GDP p.c.	0.01 (0.01)	63.3	24,964	*1.68 (1.19)*	*58.1*	*23,199*
High GDP p.c.	-0.00 (0.01)	33.4	14,664	*0.82 (1.11)*	*17.0*	*7,215*
Low Gov. Effectiveness	0.01 (0.01)	56.1	21,374	9.69*** (1.33)	58.1	22,113
High Gov. Effectiveness	-0.01 (0.01)	68.6	29,877	*-0.43 (0.55)*	*46.8*	*21,079*
Low Rule of Law	0.01 (0.01)	38.6	11,286	*0.29 (0.48)*	*36.1*	*10,790*
High Rule of Law	-0.00 (0.01)	49.6	26,514	*-0.35 (0.65)*	*50.6*	*27,016*
Low Primary Ed. Completion	0.00 (0.01)	70.1	20,924	*0.16 (0.63)*	*62.6*	*18,561*
High Primary Ed. Completion	0.01 (0.01)	37.0	19,802	*0.21 (0.38)*	*44.7*	*23,495*

Notes: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05, + p<0.1. RF is the robust bias-corrected RD estimate of CMB eligibility on IPV experience: physical. Fuzzy RD is the corresponding 2SLS estimate for not marrying before age 18 (Calonico et al., 2014). Each uses its own MSE-optimal bandwidth (BW, in months). N is total effective observations. Fuzzy RD estimates in italics have a weak instrument (F<10) and are unreliable. Robust standard errors in parentheses.

Table A18: Effect of CMBs on IPV Experience: Sexual

	Reduced Form			*Fuzzy RD*		
Subsample	Estimate	BW	N	Estimate	BW	N
Full Sample	0.01 (0.01)	50.8	41,672	*0.34 (0.33)*	*47.8*	*39,444*
Ever Married	0.01 (0.01)	51.5	41,367	*0.30 (0.31)*	*54.1*	*43,831*
Excluding Pregnancy-Driven	0.01 (0.01)	48.3	34,853	*0.39 (0.41)*	*48.7*	*34,853*
Rural	0.01 (0.01)	69.1	31,407	*0.48 (0.72)*	*56.9*	*26,002*
Urban	0.01 (0.01)	50.2	18,562	*0.27 (0.32)*	*56.5*	*20,648*
Age 18–24	0.02 (0.01)	48.1	9,581	*0.60 (1.51)*	*36.4*	*7,379*
Age 25–34	0.01 (0.01)	44.3	21,966	*0.25 (0.65)*	*51.5*	*24,919*
Age 35+	-0.01 (0.03)	25.4	3,272	*-0.09 (0.32)*	*31.7*	*4,188*
No Primary Education	0.01 (0.01)	53.6	10,165	*12.48 (116.18)*	*65.9*	*12,338*
Primary Education	0.01 (0.01)	54.4	34,640	*0.18 (0.21)*	*56.1*	*35,821*
Not Literate	0.01 (0.01)	54.1	18,147	*0.17 (0.39)*	*68.6*	*22,609*
Literate	0.00 (0.01)	65.7	27,058	*0.11 (0.38)*	*67.9*	*27,761*
Poor (Median)	0.01 (0.01)	54.0	22,848	*0.47 (0.57)*	*51.6*	*21,903*
Non-Poor (Median)	0.00 (0.01)	50.1	20,236	*0.14 (0.28)*	*68.2*	*26,739*
Poor (75P)	0.01 (0.01)	52.6	33,463	*0.32 (0.34)*	*59.9*	*37,749*
Non-Poor (75P)	0.00 (0.01)	59.7	11,114	*0.04 (0.37)*	*56.3*	*10,618*
Christian	-0.00 (0.02)	33.0	10,475	*0.03 (0.48)*	*28.6*	*8,761*
Muslim	0.01 (0.01)	49.1	20,302	*0.17 (0.22)*	*75.7*	*30,249*
Low Child Marriage Rate	0.01 (0.01)	52.4	15,112	*0.20 (0.23)*	*62.0*	*17,566*
Medium Child Marriage Rate	0.00 (0.01)	35.2	12,557	*0.08 (0.46)*	*30.7*	*10,757*
High Child Marriage Rate	-0.01 (0.01)	48.7	9,251	*0.24 (0.53)*	*43.5*	*8,442*
Previous Age 16/17	0.01 (0.01)	65.5	22,523	*0.82 (1.55)*	*32.1*	*11,834*
Previous Age 14/15	0.02 (0.01)	50.3	16,707	*0.35 (0.38)*	*50.3*	*16,707*
No Previous Age	-0.01 (0.01)	52.5	7,312	*-1.23 (2.54)*	*63.7*	*8,818*
Low Adolescent Fertility	0.01 (0.01)	77.1	36,133	*0.50 (0.49)*	*19.9*	*9,693*
High Adolescent Fertility	0.00 (0.01)	50.0	17,278	1929*** (479.9)	55.7	19,133
Autocracy	-0.00 (0.02)	46.1	8,119	*-0.03 (1.01)*	*53.2*	*9,306*
Anocracy	0.01 (0.01)	45.7	25,184	*0.32 (0.32)*	*74.0*	*39,194*
Democracy	0.01 (0.02)	66.8	5,208	*0.14 (0.37)*	*71.3*	*5,537*
Low GDP p.c.	0.02* (0.01)	47.2	18,936	93.73*** (15.11)	54.6	21,628
High GDP p.c.	-0.00 (0.01)	47.9	20,508	*0.01 (0.38)*	*25.3*	*11,181*
Low Gov. Effectiveness	0.00 (0.01)	49.8	18,601	*2.21*** (0.62)*	*50.6*	*18,950*
High Gov. Effectiveness	0.00 (0.01)	53.1	24,076	*0.14 (0.45)*	*43.3*	*19,740*
Low Rule of Law	0.01 (0.01)	50.2	14,657	*0.60+ (0.36)*	*46.8*	*13,669*
High Rule of Law	0.00 (0.01)	26.7	14,346	*0.27 (1.31)*	*19.1*	*10,721*
Low Primary Ed. Completion	-0.01 (0.01)	54.8	16,406	*-0.15 (0.77)*	*68.7*	*20,447*
High Primary Ed. Completion	0.01 (0.01)	44.9	23,491	*0.36 (0.47)*	*23.5*	*12,652*

Notes: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05, + p<0.1. RF is the robust bias-corrected RD estimate of CMB eligibility on IPV experience: sexual. Fuzzy RD is the corresponding 2SLS estimate for not marrying before age 18 (Calonico et al., 2014). Each uses its own MSE-optimal bandwidth (BW, in months). N is total effective observations. Fuzzy RD estimates in italics have a weak instrument (F<10) and are unreliable. Robust standard errors in parentheses.

Table A19: Effect of CMBs on Husband Education Level (0-3, Continuous)

	Reduced Form			*Fuzzy RD*		
Subsample	Estimate	BW	N	Estimate	BW	N
Full Sample	0.05** (0.02)	49.0	117,729	*2.62 (1.79)*	*57.2*	*136,455*
Ever Married	0.05** (0.02)	50.4	119,827	*2.94 (1.80)*	*59.7*	*140,727*
Excluding Pregnancy-Driven	0.05** (0.02)	52.2	109,177	*1.99+ (1.06)*	*64.7*	*132,900*
Rural	0.04* (0.02)	60.9	86,109	*1.47 (1.37)*	*62.1*	*88,662*
Urban	0.07** (0.03)	50.5	47,457	*9.03 (11.93)*	*69.8*	*64,873*
Age 18–24	0.14*** (0.03)	34.5	29,404	*1.96 (1.78)*	*38.1*	*32,058*
Age 25–34	-0.01 (0.03)	37.0	46,132	*0.12 (2.09)*	*41.6*	*52,608*
Age 35+	0.17* (0.08)	25.6	6,939	*1010 (1948)*	*32.0*	*9,399*
No Primary Education	0.04 (0.03)	47.0	36,966	*3.23 (17.43)*	*73.4*	*56,702*
Primary Education	0.06** (0.02)	48.6	78,131	*2.25 (1.39)*	*48.4*	*78,120*
Not Literate	0.03 (0.02)	57.7	65,343	*1.90 (18.12)*	*53.7*	*60,608*
Literate	0.05** (0.02)	59.6	61,248	*2.58 (2.75)*	*48.5*	*50,410*
Poor (Median)	0.03 (0.02)	73.7	91,633	*1.00 (1.19)*	*58.8*	*73,808*
Non-Poor (Median)	0.08** (0.02)	45.1	51,203	*4.39 (5.19)*	*51.5*	*57,199*
Poor (75P)	0.05** (0.02)	56.4	105,411	*1.84 (1.48)*	*58.7*	*108,811*
Non-Poor (75P)	0.07* (0.03)	62.2	31,547	*5.47 (7.66)*	*60.0*	*30,247*
Christian	0.02 (0.02)	65.6	55,261	*-2.59 (17.30)*	*60.7*	*51,229*
Muslim	0.08*** (0.02)	48.5	56,755	*2.69+ (1.49)*	*45.3*	*53,823*
Low Child Marriage Rate	0.20** (0.07)	24.9	18,279	0.67 (0.99)	34.5	25,658
Medium Child Marriage Rate	0.02 (0.03)	61.0	49,666	*1.96 (1.83)*	*58.8*	*48,166*
High Child Marriage Rate	-0.06 (0.09)	11.9	8,956	*0.22 (2.36)*	*12.8*	*9,604*
Previous Age 16/17	0.03 (0.02)	64.0	56,652	*1.85 (1.20)*	*50.6*	*45,211*
Previous Age 14/15	0.06* (0.02)	40.5	44,244	*2.21 (1.43)*	*46.0*	*50,410*
No Previous Age	-0.02 (0.06)	25.1	10,511	*1.58 (1.28)*	*28.6*	*11,622*
Low Adolescent Fertility	0.07* (0.03)	39.7	42,357	1.79** (0.60)	69.5	73,380
High Adolescent Fertility	0.03 (0.02)	47.5	62,680	*-592.8 (4626)*	*41.9*	*55,227*
Autocracy	-0.05 (0.05)	25.1	11,367	*2.32 (3.98)*	*50.7*	*23,184*
Anocracy	0.06** (0.02)	46.6	69,856	*2.45+ (1.31)*	*52.8*	*77,971*
Democracy	-0.20** (0.06)	44.2	15,796	*0.44 (3.23)*	*41.8*	*14,816*
Low GDP p.c.	0.03 (0.02)	49.3	58,486	*3.25 (2.80)*	*42.9*	*51,159*
High GDP p.c.	0.06** (0.02)	56.2	67,773	*2.77 (2.06)*	*43.9*	*52,343*
Low Gov. Effectiveness	0.06* (0.02)	59.3	66,404	*1.37 (1.33)*	*65.2*	*72,339*
High Gov. Effectiveness	-0.07** (0.03)	45.0	57,642	*3.19 (2.61)*	*38.1*	*48,679*
Low Rule of Law	-0.01 (0.03)	31.9	28,314	*2.08 (1.78)*	*48.8*	*43,069*
High Rule of Law	0.05* (0.02)	48.4	72,646	*4.36 (3.55)*	*59.9*	*88,743*
Low Primary Ed. Completion	0.01 (0.02)	59.8	67,265	*1.20 (6.24)*	*41.0*	*46,970*
High Primary Ed. Completion	0.09*** (0.03)	37.4	46,410	*3.14* (1.59)*	*38.9*	*47,583*

Notes: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05, + p<0.1. RF is the robust bias-corrected RD estimate of CMB eligibility on husband education level (0-3, continuous). Fuzzy RD is the corresponding 2SLS estimate for not marrying before age 18 (Calonico et al., 2014). Each uses its own MSE-optimal bandwidth (BW, in months). N is total effective observations. Fuzzy RD estimates in italics have a weak instrument (F<10) and are unreliable. Robust standard errors in parentheses.

Table A20: Effect of CMBs on P(Husband: No Education)

	Reduced Form			*Fuzzy RD*		
Subsample	Estimate	BW	N	Estimate	BW	N
Full Sample	-0.01 (0.01)	56.4	134,255	*-0.62 (0.47)*	*83.4*	*194,410*
Ever Married	-0.01^{+} (0.01)	64.3	151,865	*-0.54 (0.47)*	*70.9*	*165,936*
Excluding Pregnancy-Driven	-0.01 (0.01)	62.6	128,695	-0.42 (0.34)	64.7	132,900
Rural	-0.01 (0.01)	71.5	101,435	*-0.12 (0.49)*	*61.2*	*87,351*
Urban	-0.01 (0.01)	56.2	53,111	*-1.08 (1.49)*	*51.1*	*48,386*
Age 18–24	-0.00 (0.01)	38.8	32,058	*-0.15 (0.57)*	*33.6*	*28,640*
Age 25–34	-0.00 (0.01)	67.1	82,675	*0.39 (1.16)*	*49.3*	*61,391*
Age 35+	-0.04 (0.03)	21.1	5,748	*-18.11 (23.47)*	*33.1*	*9,754*
No Primary Education	-0.02 (0.02)	53.2	41,161	*-6.38 (26.55)*	*61.5*	*47,188*
Primary Education	-0.00 (0.01)	57.4	91,911	*-0.07 (0.29)*	*46.1*	*75,133*
Not Literate	-0.01 (0.01)	56.7	64,337	*-0.82 (5.93)*	*54.5*	*61,868*
Literate	-0.00 (0.01)	79.1	79,799	*-0.08 (0.44)*	*48.4*	*50,410*
Poor (Median)	-0.00 (0.01)	71.8	89,592	*0.28 (0.55)*	*50.4*	*63,706*
Non-Poor (Median)	-0.02^{+} (0.01)	46.2	52,177	*-0.71 (0.87)*	*41.9*	*46,713*
Poor (75P)	-0.01^{+} (0.01)	65.9	121,186	*-0.41 (0.58)*	*54.4*	*101,624*
Non-Poor (75P)	-0.00 (0.01)	56.9	28,844	*-0.30 (0.76)*	*53.3*	*27,309*
Christian	-0.01 (0.01)	54.7	46,550	*1.69 (12.44)*	*48.7*	*41,571*
Muslim	-0.01^{+} (0.01)	63.1	73,372	*-0.49 (0.35)*	*64.9*	*74,619*
Low Child Marriage Rate	-0.01 (0.01)	31.6	23,398	*-0.14 (0.14)*	*57.9*	*42,720*
Medium Child Marriage Rate	-0.00 (0.01)	60.5	49,666	0.35 (0.82)	58.9	48,166
High Child Marriage Rate	0.06^{+} (0.03)	12.2	9,604	*0.39 (2.51)*	*8.7*	*6,751*
Previous Age 16/17	-0.01 (0.01)	67.9	59,373	*-0.41 (0.45)*	*37.3*	*33,754*
Previous Age 14/15	-0.01 (0.01)	52.6	56,284	*-0.30 (0.51)*	*47.2*	*51,324*
No Previous Age	0.03 (0.02)	30.3	12,600	*-0.67 (1.33)*	*28.9*	*11,622*
Low Adolescent Fertility	-0.01 (0.01)	85.7	89,355	*-0.18 (0.22)*	*44.9*	*47,751*
High Adolescent Fertility	-0.01 (0.01)	52.1	68,204	*4.08 (28.13)*	*41.7*	*55,227*
Autocracy	0.02 (0.02)	26.3	11,826	*-0.86 (1.40)*	*45.3*	*21,151*
Anocracy	-0.01 (0.01)	53.5	79,338	*-0.34 (0.39)*	*47.3*	*71,168*
Democracy	0.01 (0.02)	48.0	16,585	*-0.09 (1.22)*	*37.9*	*13,359*
Low GDP p.c.	-0.01 (0.01)	53.1	62,962	*-0.42 (0.83)*	*43.8*	*52,429*
High GDP p.c.	-0.01 (0.01)	61.7	73,295	*-0.30 (0.52)*	*46.9*	*55,952*
Low Gov. Effectiveness	-0.02* (0.01)	59.4	66,404	*-0.46 (0.50)*	*65.4*	*72,339*
High Gov. Effectiveness	-0.00 (0.01)	73.1	91,679	*-0.26 (0.70)*	*47.2*	*59,919*
Low Rule of Law	0.00 (0.02)	32.3	29,402	*0.11 (0.69)*	*45.1*	*40,990*
High Rule of Law	-0.00 (0.01)	64.3	96,357	*-0.59 (0.66)*	*61.9*	*91,568*
Low Primary Ed. Completion	-0.00 (0.01)	55.3	62,886	*-0.33 (1.85)*	*59.2*	*67,265*
High Primary Ed. Completion	-0.01^{+} (0.01)	48.9	60,206	*-0.66^{+} (0.38)*	*44.4*	*55,232*

Notes: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05, + p<0.1. RF is the robust bias-corrected RD estimate of CMB eligibility on p(husband: no education). Fuzzy RD is the corresponding 2SLS estimate for not marrying before age 18 (Calonico et al., 2014). Each uses its own MSE-optimal bandwidth (BW, in months). N is total effective observations. Fuzzy RD estimates in italics have a weak instrument (F<10) and are unreliable. Robust standard errors in parentheses.

Table A21: Effect of CMBs on P(Husband: Primary)

	Reduced Form			*Fuzzy RD*		
Subsample	Estimate	BW	N	Estimate	BW	N
Full Sample	-0.02** (0.01)	52.9	124,658	*-1.08 (0.80)*	*53.9*	*127,017*
Ever Married	-0.02** (0.01)	45.8	109,548	*-1.43 (0.87)*	*47.3*	*113,683*
Excluding Pregnancy-Driven	-0.02* (0.01)	65.4	134,967	*-0.86 (0.55)*	*48.8*	*101,304*
Rural	-0.02* (0.01)	48.8	69,927	*-1.03 (0.87)*	*49.1*	*71,106*
Urban	-0.02* (0.01)	64.2	60,253	*-2.85 (2.99)*	*45.4*	*43,230*
Age 18–24	-0.02 (0.01)	52.8	42,568	*-0.65 (0.56)*	*38.3*	*32,058*
Age 25–34	-0.03** (0.01)	43.8	55,135	*-5.14* (2.38)*	*44.7*	*56,319*
Age 35+	-0.01 (0.03)	29.6	8,286	*-2.86 (14.38)*	*34.2*	*10,115*
No Primary Education	-0.01 (0.02)	44.1	35,127	*-36.21 (451.8)*	*50.1*	*38,771*
Primary Education	-0.03*** (0.01)	52.7	84,295	*-1.35 (0.67)*	*54.2*	*87,370*
Not Literate	-0.01 (0.01)	63.7	71,422	*-1.83 (8.74)*	*51.1*	*58,084*
Literate	-0.03** (0.01)	41.1	43,504	*-1.64 (1.44)*	*48.8*	*50,410*
Poor (Median)	-0.02+ (0.01)	50.9	63,710	*-0.60 (0.60)*	*63.6*	*79,535*
Non-Poor (Median)	-0.03** (0.01)	44.3	50,145	*-2.09 (2.29)*	*54.0*	*60,537*
Poor (75P)	-0.02* (0.01)	49.5	92,373	*-0.93 (0.73)*	*53.9*	*99,708*
Non-Poor (75P)	-0.05*** (0.01)	46.5	23,985	*-2.89 (3.82)*	*61.0*	*30,663*
Christian	-0.00 (0.01)	81.1	68,171	*0.53 (5.74)*	*63.5*	*53,509*
Muslim	-0.03** (0.01)	50.9	58,717	*-0.67+ (0.37)*	*72.1*	*83,168*
Low Child Marriage Rate	-0.03+ (0.02)	27.9	20,515	*-0.40 (0.42)*	*31.7*	*23,391*
Medium Child Marriage Rate	-0.05*** (0.01)	42.0	34,357	*-2.83* (1.25)*	*56.1*	*46,638*
High Child Marriage Rate	-0.00 (0.03)	17.7	14,001	*1.06 (1.60)*	*13.6*	*10,324*
Previous Age 16/17	-0.02 (0.01)	45.8	41,166	*-0.59 (0.45)*	*36.0*	*32,117*
Previous Age 14/15	-0.02+ (0.01)	50.8	54,126	*-0.93 (0.74)*	*55.4*	*59,406*
No Previous Age	-0.04* (0.02)	39.3	16,068	*1.65 (1.95)*	*27.4*	*11,242*
Low Adolescent Fertility	-0.03** (0.01)	47.6	51,024	*-0.82** (0.31)*	*52.3*	*56,442*
High Adolescent Fertility	-0.02+ (0.01)	45.7	60,637	*19.56 (72.38)*	*41.8*	*55,227*
Autocracy	0.00 (0.02)	35.2	16,467	*-0.14 (1.23)*	*38.8*	*17,577*
Anocracy	-0.03*** (0.01)	52.4	77,983	*-1.23* (0.61)*	*53.2*	*79,326*
Democracy	-0.01 (0.02)	56.3	19,630	*-0.98 (2.06)*	*43.2*	*15,420*
Low GDP p.c.	-0.02+ (0.01)	45.7	54,662	*-0.66 (1.50)*	*37.6*	*45,014*
High GDP p.c.	-0.03** (0.01)	45.0	53,663	*-1.13 (1.01)*	*43.4*	*52,343*
Low Gov. Effectiveness	-0.02+ (0.01)	52.3	58,690	*-0.36 (0.51)*	*62.5*	*69,179*
High Gov. Effectiveness	-0.03** (0.01)	50.9	63,338	*-1.41 (1.53)*	*40.9*	*51,464*
Low Rule of Law	-0.02 (0.01)	47.1	42,417	*-0.29 (0.64)*	*52.6*	*46,154*
High Rule of Law	-0.03*** (0.01)	76.8	113,909	*-2.11 (2.15)*	*52.8*	*78,492*
Low Primary Ed. Completion	-0.01 (0.01)	65.3	73,922	*-1.88 (6.62)*	*42.5*	*49,623*
High Primary Ed. Completion	-0.03** (0.01)	35.7	44,045	*-1.14+ (0.66)*	*38.3*	*47,583*

Notes: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05, + p<0.1. RF is the robust bias-corrected RD estimate of CMB eligibility on p(husband: primary). Fuzzy RD is the corresponding 2SLS estimate for not marrying before age 18 (Calonico et al., 2014). Each uses its own MSE-optimal bandwidth (BW, in months). N is total effective observations. Fuzzy RD estimates in italics have a weak instrument (F<10) and are unreliable. Robust standard errors in parentheses.

Table A22: Effect of CMBs on P(Husband: Secondary)

	Reduced Form			*Fuzzy RD*		
Subsample	Estimate	BW	N	Estimate	BW	N
Full Sample	0.02* (0.01)	43.6	104,783	*1.12 (0.81)*	*49.6*	*117,718*
Ever Married	0.01 (0.01)	64.4	151,865	*1.05 (0.76)*	*45.7*	*109,537*
Excluding Pregnancy-Driven	0.01 (0.01)	54.0	111,253	*0.77 (0.53)*	*53.0*	*109,165*
Rural	0.01 (0.01)	54.5	78,224	*0.55 (0.58)*	*62.4*	*88,662*
Urban	0.03+ (0.02)	47.8	44,984	*2.35 (2.84)*	*51.7*	*48,386*
Age 18–24	0.01 (0.01)	56.9	45,586	-0.10 (0.60)	34.7	29,404
Age 25–34	0.02 (0.02)	37.9	47,297	*0.09 (1.85)*	*47.1*	*59,450*
Age 35+	0.10* (0.05)	19.8	5,059	*-0.79 (21.67)*	*30.4*	*8,711*
No Primary Education	0.03* (0.01)	43.4	34,244	*29.90 (1339)*	*55.1*	*42,860*
Primary Education	0.00 (0.01)	83.3	129,625	*0.48 (0.57)*	*52.1*	*84,283*
Not Literate	0.02* (0.01)	50.1	57,114	*1.09 (8.19)*	*63.1*	*71,422*
Literate	0.02 (0.02)	43.6	45,439	*0.97 (1.11)*	*47.9*	*49,476*
Poor (Median)	0.01 (0.01)	57.7	72,674	*0.13 (0.60)*	*49.5*	*62,586*
Non-Poor (Median)	0.03* (0.01)	45.2	51,203	*1.97 (2.25)*	*54.5*	*60,537*
Poor (75P)	0.02+ (0.01)	49.2	92,373	*0.99 (0.75)*	*55.1*	*103,399*
Non-Poor (75P)	0.05* (0.02)	36.9	18,879	*1.41 (2.02)*	*52.8*	*26,825*
Christian	0.04* (0.02)	46.6	40,022	*-2.29 (53.81)*	*48.2*	*41,571*
Muslim	0.01 (0.01)	48.3	56,755	*0.28 (0.48)*	*59.2*	*69,098*
Low Child Marriage Rate	0.00 (0.03)	22.9	16,784	6.56*** (0.69)	35.3	26,391
Medium Child Marriage Rate	0.02 (0.02)	44.5	36,948	*-2.29 (2.50)*	*47.7*	*39,176*
High Child Marriage Rate	-0.01 (0.02)	17.4	14,001	*0.46 (1.85)*	*12.8*	*9,604*
Previous Age 16/17	0.01 (0.02)	49.8	44,407	*0.24 (0.67)*	*36.3*	*32,895*
Previous Age 14/15	0.02 (0.02)	43.1	47,442	*0.70 (0.85)*	*37.0*	*40,775*
No Previous Age	0.07* (0.03)	27.0	11,242	*-4.69 (3.10)*	*46.4*	*19,183*
Low Adolescent Fertility	0.02 (0.02)	34.9	37,058	*0.34 (0.39)*	*48.4*	*52,069*
High Adolescent Fertility	0.02* (0.01)	52.9	68,204	*-13.52 (110.4)*	*41.5*	*55,227*
Autocracy	-0.01 (0.03)	25.9	11,367	*-0.58 (0.95)*	*33.6*	*15,586*
Anocracy	0.02+ (0.01)	59.1	87,252	*0.86 (0.58)*	*51.5*	*76,519*
Democracy	-0.00 (0.02)	47.5	16,585	4.10* (1.63)	43.5	15,420
Low GDP p.c.	0.02+ (0.01)	47.6	56,617	*0.85 (0.90)*	*47.8*	*56,617*
High GDP p.c.	0.02 (0.01)	50.1	60,307	*0.69 (0.78)*	*38.1*	*45,933*
Low Gov. Effectiveness	0.03* (0.01)	54.8	61,150	*0.59 (0.61)*	*67.9*	*74,771*
High Gov. Effectiveness	0.01 (0.01)	46.6	58,727	*0.98 (1.07)*	*42.0*	*52,730*
Low Rule of Law	0.01 (0.02)	46.5	41,726	*-0.01 (0.83)*	*38.9*	*34,196*
High Rule of Law	0.02+ (0.01)	54.2	81,422	*1.79 (1.62)*	*45.9*	*68,557*
Low Primary Ed. Completion	0.02+ (0.01)	60.6	68,152	*1.98 (5.24)*	*39.2*	*45,554*
High Primary Ed. Completion	0.02 (0.01)	46.5	57,797	*0.10 (0.45)*	*61.7*	*75,648*

Notes: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05, + p<0.1. RF is the robust bias-corrected RD estimate of CMB eligibility on p(husband: secondary). Fuzzy RD is the corresponding 2SLS estimate for not marrying before age 18 (Calonico et al., 2014). Each uses its own MSE-optimal bandwidth (BW, in months). N is total effective observations. Fuzzy RD estimates in italics have a weak instrument (F<10) and are unreliable. Robust standard errors in parentheses.

Table A23: Effect of CMBs on P(Husband: Higher)

	Reduced Form			*Fuzzy RD*		
Subsample	Estimate	BW	N	Estimate	BW	N
Full Sample	0.01* (0.01)	65.2	154,216	*0.65 (0.59)*	*49.7*	*117,718*
Ever Married	0.01* (0.01)	66.1	156,708	*0.68 (0.65)*	*55.7*	*131,736*
Excluding Pregnancy-Driven	0.01* (0.01)	71.6	146,913	*0.50 (0.40)*	*43.6*	*91,755*
Rural	0.01+ (0.01)	59.2	84,991	*0.43 (0.43)*	*59.4*	*84,984*
Urban	0.02 (0.01)	65.4	61,124	*2.40 (4.09)*	*62.0*	*57,431*
Age 18–24	0.03** (0.01)	53.7	43,343	*0.44 (0.60)*	*35.6*	*30,093*
Age 25–34	0.00 (0.01)	40.1	51,273	*0.35 (1.14)*	*67.1*	*82,666*
Age 35+	-0.06 (0.04)	21.9	5,748	*-0.84 (9.78)*	*30.6*	*8,711*
No Primary Education	-0.01+ (0.00)	36.1	28,337	*0.04 (4.70)*	*56.9*	*43,855*
Primary Education	0.02* (0.01)	60.6	96,193	*0.75 (0.63)*	*50.3*	*81,023*
Not Literate	-0.00 (0.00)	54.6	61,868	*-0.49 (2.50)*	*53.2*	*60,608*
Literate	0.02+ (0.01)	65.2	66,801	*0.84 (1.30)*	*50.4*	*52,291*
Poor (Median)	0.01+ (0.01)	66.0	83,544	*0.38 (0.38)*	*60.7*	*75,946*
Non-Poor (Median)	0.01 (0.01)	59.2	65,798	*0.51 (0.97)*	*42.3*	*47,876*
Poor (75P)	0.01 (0.01)	58.0	108,819	*0.38 (0.43)*	*54.1*	*101,624*
Non-Poor (75P)	0.02 (0.02)	56.4	28,844	*1.86 (3.08)*	*59.3*	*30,247*
Christian	-0.01 (0.01)	52.9	44,796	*4.48 (15.99)*	*58.3*	*49,807*
Muslim	0.03** (0.01)	57.5	67,047	*1.22* (0.57)*	*62.7*	*72,185*
Low Child Marriage Rate	0.05* (0.02)	30.7	22,701	*0.79 (0.58)*	*26.8*	*19,759*
Medium Child Marriage Rate	-0.01 (0.01)	40.9	33,494	*-0.19 (0.25)*	*63.6*	*52,070*
High Child Marriage Rate	-0.00 (0.01)	16.1	12,968	*-0.83 (0.85)*	*12.4*	*9,604*
Previous Age 16/17	0.02* (0.01)	52.2	47,064	*0.70 (0.54)*	*41.0*	*37,442*
Previous Age 14/15	0.01 (0.01)	47.8	51,324	*0.58 (0.56)*	*47.4*	*51,324*
No Previous Age	-0.03 (0.02)	27.4	11,242	*0.89 (1.13)*	*38.7*	*15,702*
Low Adolescent Fertility	0.02+ (0.01)	55.5	59,464	*0.66+ (0.35)*	*52.4*	*56,442*
High Adolescent Fertility	0.00 (0.01)	57.4	74,939	*-2.04 (4.08)*	*42.6*	*56,750*
Autocracy	-0.01 (0.02)	30.8	14,088	*-0.01 (0.69)*	*47.1*	*22,017*
Anocracy	0.02* (0.01)	73.0	105,852	*0.64 (0.52)*	*48.7*	*72,472*
Democracy	0.01 (0.01)	47.5	16,585	*0.88 (1.31)*	*40.5*	*14,499*
Low GDP p.c.	0.00 (0.01)	76.6	87,522	*0.60 (0.69)*	*42.4*	*51,159*
High GDP p.c.	0.02* (0.01)	78.7	93,732	*0.43 (0.78)*	*42.5*	*51,195*
Low Gov. Effectiveness	0.01 (0.01)	68.0	75,877	*0.20 (0.37)*	*67.4*	*74,771*
High Gov. Effectiveness	0.02+ (0.01)	57.1	72,017	*0.99 (0.98)*	*38.2*	*48,679*
Low Rule of Law	0.01 (0.01)	64.8	55,519	*0.40 (0.55)*	*54.1*	*48,036*
High Rule of Law	0.01 (0.01)	64.1	96,357	*1.18 (1.30)*	*53.6*	*79,904*
Low Primary Ed. Completion	-0.00 (0.01)	68.1	77,997	*-0.82 (1.94)*	*39.8*	*45,554*
High Primary Ed. Completion	0.03** (0.01)	60.0	73,486	*1.10 (0.72)*	*32.7*	*40,402*

Notes: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05, + p<0.1. RF is the robust bias-corrected RD estimate of CMB eligibility on p(husband: higher). Fuzzy RD is the corresponding 2SLS estimate for not marrying before age 18 (Calonico et al., 2014). Each uses its own MSE-optimal bandwidth (BW, in months). N is total effective observations. Fuzzy RD estimates in italics have a weak instrument (F<10) and are unreliable. Robust standard errors in parentheses.

Table A24: Effect of CMBs on Spousal Age Gap (Current)

	Reduced Form			*Fuzzy RD*		
Subsample	Estimate	BW	N	Estimate	BW	N
Full Sample	0.08 (0.12)	50.8	118,254	*5.41 (11.00)*	*52.3*	*123,000*
Ever Married	0.08 (0.12)	50.8	118,254	*5.41 (11.00)*	*52.3*	*123,000*
Excluding Pregnancy-Driven	0.06 (0.13)	51.2	105,606	*2.09 (6.57)*	*42.0*	*88,432*
Rural	0.11 (0.15)	54.2	77,066	*3.51 (8.65)*	*59.6*	*83,729*
Urban	0.00 (0.19)	50.6	46,966	*0.80 (174.8)*	*63.6*	*58,720*
Age 18–24	0.07 (0.24)	31.3	26,347	*3.46 (10.85)*	*34.6*	*28,672*
Age 25–34	-0.06 (0.19)	40.6	50,708	*-6.06 (13.79)*	*40.5*	*50,702*
Age 35+	0.64 (0.49)	22.3	6,072	*-25.59 (124.2)*	*31.5*	*9,039*
No Primary Education	0.18 (0.28)	42.6	32,704	*-47.96 (1987.38)*	*51.9*	*38,659*
Primary Education	0.08 (0.12)	62.3	97,974	*1.90 (7.51)*	*50.4*	*80,160*
Not Literate	0.19 (0.20)	54.1	60,768	*-1921 (5277)*	*82.0*	*90,503*
Literate	0.07 (0.14)	68.3	68,294	*3.50 (13.05)*	*54.2*	*55,383*
Poor (Median)	0.24 (0.17)	48.8	60,839	*11.65 (12.38)*	*55.0*	*69,321*
Non-Poor (Median)	-0.08 (0.17)	50.0	54,305	*-2.51 (18.63)*	*61.4*	*66,697*
Poor (75P)	0.09 (0.14)	53.4	98,389	*4.91 (10.10)*	*50.2*	*92,775*
Non-Poor (75P)	-0.00 (0.25)	50.7	25,471	*3.05 (46.02)*	*75.9*	*37,436*
Christian	0.15 (0.17)	63.8	51,343	*-47.34 (42.06)*	*78.1*	*63,089*
Muslim	0.13 (0.19)	51.5	60,141	*4.43 (7.03)*	*49.1*	*57,929*
Low Child Marriage Rate	-0.09 (0.26)	23.4	17,662	*-0.01 (4.49)*	*52.3*	*39,342*
Medium Child Marriage Rate	0.21 (0.22)	53.6	43,295	*10.17 (17.42)*	*58.7*	*47,487*
High Child Marriage Rate	0.36 (0.30)	28.1	22,600	*22.26 (30.85)*	*20.9*	*16,513*
Previous Age 16/17	-0.19 (0.17)	54.7	48,606	*-3.54 (5.87)*	*55.8*	*49,459*
Previous Age 14/15	-0.04 (0.16)	69.9	73,252	*-2.30 (12.64)*	*43.7*	*46,288*
No Previous Age	0.44 (0.31)	45.8	18,611	*-25.60 (60.98)*	*53.9*	*21,527*
Low Adolescent Fertility	0.08 (0.16)	54.4	58,180	*0.43 (4.63)*	*42.1*	*45,360*
High Adolescent Fertility	0.15 (0.19)	49.2	63,332	*-22.40 (44.79)*	*46.3*	*60,417*
Autocracy	0.10 (0.39)	42.8	19,346	*5.03 (32.82)*	*55.6*	*25,628*
Anocracy	0.00 (0.14)	51.8	74,971	*-0.18 (6.83)*	*47.9*	*69,685*
Democracy	0.34 (0.34)	43.7	15,509	*-1.11 (33.00)*	*32.8*	*11,882*
Low GDP p.c.	0.10 (0.19)	40.3	47,276	*17.45 (23.51)*	*43.1*	*51,071*
High GDP p.c.	0.02 (0.19)	37.6	44,802	*9.03 (11.56)*	*59.3*	*71,064*
Low Gov. Effectiveness	0.10 (0.20)	48.7	52,811	*10.19 (16.98)*	*36.4*	*39,843*
High Gov. Effectiveness	0.15 (0.14)	63.9	79,548	*1.71 (17.48)*	*43.9*	*55,333*
Low Rule of Law	-0.04 (0.28)	30.1	26,161	*3.06 (14.39)*	*40.1*	*34,641*
High Rule of Law	0.21 (0.13)	57.5	86,092	*18.99 (34.05)*	*50.4*	*75,545*
Low Primary Ed. Completion	0.22 (0.20)	49.4	54,918	*-219.5 (198.3)*	*37.1*	*42,324*
High Primary Ed. Completion	-0.02 (0.14)	52.8	65,158	*0.72 (5.03)*	*63.3*	*77,841*

Notes: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05, + p<0.1. RF is the robust bias-corrected RD estimate of CMB eligibility on spousal age gap (current). Fuzzy RD is the corresponding 2SLS estimate for not marrying before age 18 (Calonico et al., 2014). Each uses its own MSE-optimal bandwidth (BW, in months). N is total effective observations. Fuzzy RD estimates in italics have a weak instrument (F<10) and are unreliable. Robust standard errors in parentheses.

Table A25: Effect of CMBs on Spousal Age Gap >= 5 yrs

	Reduced Form			*Fuzzy RD*		
Subsample	Estimate	BW	N	Estimate	BW	N
Full Sample	-0.01 (0.01)	54.4	127,787	*-0.70 (0.90)*	*56.1*	*132,516*
Ever Married	-0.01 (0.01)	54.4	127,787	*-0.70 (0.90)*	*56.1*	*132,516*
Excluding Pregnancy-Driven	-0.01 (0.01)	47.3	98,263	*-0.50 (0.59)*	*44.7*	*92,661*
Rural	-0.02^{+} (0.01)	55.6	78,429	*-0.72 (0.91)*	*58.5*	*82,459*
Urban	0.01 (0.02)	57.7	53,506	*0.18 (11.96)*	*62.7*	*57,754*
Age 18–24	-0.01 (0.02)	41.5	33,641	*-0.25 (0.98)*	*33.5*	*27,935*
Age 25–34	-0.01 (0.02)	36.0	44,622	*-0.47 (1.17)*	*41.4*	*52,014*
Age 35+	-0.01 (0.05)	24.8	6,650	*0.68 (10.90)*	*31.3*	*9,039*
No Primary Education	-0.03 (0.02)	49.5	37,407	*32.53 (392.46)*	*52.9*	*39,571*
Primary Education	-0.00 (0.01)	63.1	99,503	*-0.15 (0.67)*	*49.4*	*78,709*
Not Literate	-0.02^{+} (0.01)	57.5	64,211	*7.20 (47.48)*	*76.0*	*83,238*
Literate	-0.00 (0.01)	56.9	57,287	*-0.14 (1.09)*	*48.5*	*49,496*
Poor (Median)	-0.01 (0.01)	66.6	82,598	*-0.21 (0.75)*	*53.2*	*66,818*
Non-Poor (Median)	-0.02 (0.01)	46.4	51,383	*-0.94 (1.63)*	*67.1*	*73,267*
Poor (75P)	-0.01 (0.01)	57.4	105,747	*-1.52* (0.77)*	*79.7*	*143,957*
Non-Poor (75P)	0.00 (0.02)	51.1	25,970	*-0.17 (2.85)*	*70.5*	*35,120*
Christian	-0.02 (0.02)	51.9	42,131	*5.85 (7.03)*	*68.3*	*55,668*
Muslim	-0.01 (0.01)	55.1	65,023	*-0.37 (0.49)*	*53.3*	*62,607*
Low Child Marriage Rate	0.01 (0.03)	24.9	18,400	*0.40 (0.50)*	*49.4*	*37,016*
Medium Child Marriage Rate	-0.01 (0.02)	43.0	34,746	*-0.49 (1.11)*	*56.4*	*46,007*
High Child Marriage Rate	-0.02 (0.03)	22.5	18,122	*1.20 (1.63)*	*16.2*	*12,557*
Previous Age 16/17	-0.02^{+} (0.01)	51.0	45,980	*-0.78 (0.62)*	*58.2*	*51,860*
Previous Age 14/15	0.00 (0.01)	72.8	75,965	*0.29 (1.04)*	*49.3*	*51,934*
No Previous Age	0.00 (0.02)	48.9	19,635	*-0.11 (1.58)*	*57.3*	*23,312*
Low Adolescent Fertility	0.01 (0.02)	52.5	56,153	*0.14 (0.46)*	*39.5*	*42,116*
High Adolescent Fertility	-0.03* (0.01)	46.8	60,417	*3.29 (12.35)*	*42.9*	*55,572*
Autocracy	-0.03 (0.03)	45.7	20,831	*-0.67 (0.75)*	*50.8*	*22,827*
Anocracy	-0.01 (0.01)	48.7	70,966	*-0.56 (0.64)*	*53.2*	*77,718*
Democracy	0.08** (0.02)	30.6	11,053	*11.18*** (2.84)*	*27.6*	*9,910*
Low GDP p.c.	-0.02 (0.01)	46.3	54,212	*-1.95 (2.99)*	*43.4*	*51,071*
High GDP p.c.	0.01 (0.01)	61.4	73,243	*0.29 (0.89)*	*31.5*	*38,012*
Low Gov. Effectiveness	-0.02 (0.01)	45.3	50,147	*-1.27 (0.83)*	*58.7*	*63,320*
High Gov. Effectiveness	0.01 (0.01)	56.5	71,146	*1.65 (2.97)*	*52.1*	*66,276*
Low Rule of Law	-0.02 (0.02)	35.1	30,745	*-1.83 (1.65)*	*40.0*	*33,684*
High Rule of Law	0.02 (0.01)	50.4	75,545	*2.32 (2.82)*	*52.2*	*78,662*
Low Primary Ed. Completion	-0.02^{+} (0.01)	53.7	58,995	*-1.47 (17.46)*	*40.5*	*45,754*
High Primary Ed. Completion	0.01 (0.01)	59.4	73,343	*0.18 (0.45)*	*68.9*	*83,519*

Notes: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05, + p<0.1. RF is the robust bias-corrected RD estimate of CMB eligibility on spousal age gap >= 5 yrs. Fuzzy RD is the corresponding 2SLS estimate for not marrying before age 18 (Calonico et al., 2014). Each uses its own MSE-optimal bandwidth (BW, in months). N is total effective observations. Fuzzy RD estimates in italics have a weak instrument (F<10) and are unreliable. Robust standard errors in parentheses.

Table A26: Effect of CMBs on Spousal Age Gap >= 10 yrs

	Reduced Form			*Fuzzy RD*		
Subsample	Estimate	BW	N	Estimate	BW	N
Full Sample	0.00 (0.01)	53.0	123,012	*0.07 (0.69)*	*52.6*	*123,000*
Ever Married	0.00 (0.01)	53.0	123,012	*0.07 (0.69)*	*52.6*	*123,000*
Excluding Pregnancy-Driven	-0.00 (0.01)	51.8	105,606	*0.05 (0.45)*	*43.1*	*90,527*
Rural	0.01 (0.01)	55.2	78,429	*0.18 (0.53)*	*62.4*	*87,351*
Urban	-0.01 (0.01)	48.1	45,314	*-2.11 (6.67)*	*57.2*	*53,500*
Age 18–24	-0.00 (0.01)	48.5	38,865	*0.34 (0.70)*	*36.3*	*29,993*
Age 25–34	0.00 (0.01)	33.3	42,339	*0.33 (0.95)*	*39.2*	*49,228*
Age 35+	0.01 (0.04)	22.6	6,072	*-32.89 (29.98)*	*33.1*	*9,751*
No Primary Education	0.00 (0.02)	48.8	36,846	*33.77 (106.02)*	*54.4*	*41,270*
Primary Education	0.00 (0.01)	61.3	96,559	*0.10 (0.54)*	*48.3*	*77,278*
Not Literate	0.00 (0.01)	62.5	69,066	*-17.09 (50.66)*	*81.2*	*90,503*
Literate	0.00 (0.01)	66.4	66,492	*0.33 (1.13)*	*77.1*	*76,546*
Poor (Median)	0.00 (0.01)	56.1	70,685	*0.27 (0.68)*	*56.2*	*70,681*
Non-Poor (Median)	-0.01 (0.01)	48.4	53,332	*-0.47 (1.09)*	*42.4*	*47,134*
Poor (75P)	0.00 (0.01)	55.8	102,070	*0.14 (0.65)*	*49.5*	*91,134*
Non-Poor (75P)	-0.01 (0.02)	49.1	25,023	*-0.56 (1.69)*	*50.3*	*25,467*
Christian	0.00 (0.01)	64.6	52,190	*-1.63 (2.09)*	*74.3*	*59,911*
Muslim	0.00 (0.01)	52.6	61,427	*0.04 (0.43)*	*52.6*	*61,416*
Low Child Marriage Rate	-0.02 (0.02)	23.1	17,662	*-0.10 (0.35)*	*45.3*	*34,105*
Medium Child Marriage Rate	-0.01 (0.02)	50.7	40,750	*0.23 (1.31)*	*48.7*	*39,342*
High Child Marriage Rate	0.06** (0.02)	26.9	20,865	*-1.57 (1.76)*	*19.4*	*15,575*
Previous Age 16/17	0.01 (0.01)	44.8	40,166	*-0.03 (0.35)*	*57.8*	*51,064*
Previous Age 14/15	-0.01 (0.01)	59.4	62,215	*-0.05 (0.96)*	*43.8*	*46,288*
No Previous Age	0.01 (0.02)	45.8	18,611	*-1.19 (6.24)*	*56.2*	*22,932*
Low Adolescent Fertility	0.00 (0.01)	47.2	50,764	*0.05 (0.33)*	*50.8*	*53,845*
High Adolescent Fertility	-0.00 (0.01)	59.8	75,759	*-3.74 (5.93)*	*42.5*	*55,572*
Autocracy	0.01 (0.03)	39.8	17,810	*0.02 (2.15)*	*54.7*	*25,070*
Anocracy	-0.00 (0.01)	56.7	81,833	*0.08 (0.51)*	*47.0*	*69,685*
Democracy	-0.25*** (0.04)	33.6	12,185	*2.60+ (1.40)*	*34.4*	*12,498*
Low GDP p.c.	0.01 (0.01)	47.8	55,173	*0.98 (1.35)*	*46.7*	*54,212*
High GDP p.c.	-0.00 (0.01)	50.3	60,235	*-0.13 (0.72)*	*40.3*	*48,589*
Low Gov. Effectiveness	0.00 (0.01)	51.6	55,602	*-0.19 (0.45)*	*64.9*	*68,906*
High Gov. Effectiveness	0.00 (0.01)	61.5	77,015	*0.14 (1.69)*	*50.3*	*63,636*
Low Rule of Law	0.02 (0.02)	35.0	30,745	*0.58 (1.09)*	*43.5*	*37,675*
High Rule of Law	0.00 (0.01)	48.9	72,787	*-0.07 (1.17)*	*46.1*	*70,015*
Low Primary Ed. Completion	0.01 (0.01)	60.6	66,455	*-1.52 (14.99)*	*36.1*	*41,407*
High Primary Ed. Completion	-0.01 (0.01)	45.3	56,481	*-0.24 (0.40)*	*56.5*	*69,907*

Notes: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05, + p<0.1. RF is the robust bias-corrected RD estimate of CMB eligibility on spousal age gap >= 10 yrs. Fuzzy RD is the corresponding 2SLS estimate for not marrying before age 18 (Calonico et al., 2014). Each uses its own MSE-optimal bandwidth (BW, in months). N is total effective observations. Fuzzy RD estimates in italics have a weak instrument (F<10) and are unreliable. Robust standard errors in parentheses.

Table A27: Effect of CMBs on Husband Works

	Reduced Form			*Fuzzy RD*		
Subsample	Estimate	BW	N	Estimate	BW	N
Full Sample	-0.00 (0.01)	54.3	52,719	*1.28 (6.71)*	*75.1*	*70,718*
Ever Married	-0.00 (0.01)	54.3	52,719	*1.28 (6.71)*	*75.1*	*70,718*
Excluding Pregnancy-Driven	-0.01 (0.01)	57.8	47,637	*-1.88 (4.55)*	*76.3*	*61,757*
Rural	-0.00 (0.01)	60.0	33,493	*-0.39 (1.78)*	*86.1*	*46,543*
Urban	-0.01 (0.01)	61.7	24,586	*1.52 (3.71)*	*48.4*	*19,800*
Age 18–24	-0.10 (0.08)	11.2	1,216	*2.34 (8.28)*	*19.0*	*2,215*
Age 25–34	0.00 (0.01)	23.1	15,904	*0.04 (0.32)*	*24.9*	*16,454*
Age 35+	-0.08*** (0.02)	32.7	6,250	*-12.80 (36.96)*	*25.7*	*4,473*
No Primary Education	-0.05*** (0.01)	77.3	21,648	*1.15 (4.43)*	*70.4*	*19,935*
Primary Education	0.00 (0.01)	50.4	34,472	*-106.14 (2087.57)*	*77.1*	*50,989*
Not Literate	0.00 (0.01)	60.3	28,091	*0.14 (1.10)*	*78.1*	*36,098*
Literate	-0.01 (0.01)	58.2	28,676	*-0.28 (2.70)*	*51.6*	*25,545*
Poor (Median)	-0.02 (0.01)	84.2	41,081	*-1.95 (8.67)*	*72.0*	*35,613*
Non-Poor (Median)	0.01 (0.01)	43.7	20,546	*-0.67 (1.28)*	*64.8*	*29,306*
Poor (75P)	-0.01 (0.01)	65.1	47,884	*56.75 (535.7)*	*81.5*	*58,927*
Non-Poor (75P)	0.00 (0.01)	48.6	10,947	*-0.11 (1.56)*	*73.4*	*15,891*
Christian	-0.01 (0.01)	81.4	28,988	*0.25 (1.07)*	*46.4*	*17,337*
Muslim	0.00 (0.01)	52.4	22,927	*-2.03 (9.02)*	*78.8*	*33,231*
Low Child Marriage Rate	0.00 (0.01)	49.4	12,649	*-0.00 (0.53)*	*50.4*	*12,874*
Medium Child Marriage Rate	-0.00 (0.01)	74.9	27,073	*0.02 (0.76)*	*57.6*	*21,502*
High Child Marriage Rate	-0.01 (0.01)	86.7	28,111	*0.28 (0.49)*	*67.5*	*22,510*
Previous Age 16/17	-0.01 (0.01)	82.3	35,270	*0.44 (1.68)*	*61.6*	*27,498*
Previous Age 14/15	-0.01 (0.01)	45.0	17,256	*-0.23 (1.27)*	*40.2*	*15,200*
No Previous Age	0.00 (0.01)	58.9	7,745	*0.10 (0.47)*	*63.3*	*8,329*
Low Adolescent Fertility	-0.00 (0.01)	58.4	23,933	*-0.08 (0.55)*	*66.9*	*26,617*
High Adolescent Fertility	-0.01 (0.01)	64.7	35,319	*0.73 (1.01)*	*63.9*	*34,582*
Autocracy	-0.03 (0.04)	73.8	9,817	*27.21 (81.10)*	*45.8*	*6,431*
Anocracy	0.00 (0.01)	59.5	39,415	*0.39 (1.64)*	*57.9*	*38,273*
Democracy	-0.00 (0.02)	52.5	6,376	*-0.06 (0.55)*	*54.8*	*6,675*
Low GDP p.c.	-0.00 (0.01)	53.9	30,535	*1.76 (7.07)*	*60.2*	*34,194*
High GDP p.c.	-0.00 (0.01)	60.6	23,554	*-1.14 (8.93)*	*67.7*	*25,951*
Low Gov. Effectiveness	0.00 (0.01)	49.2	22,674	*-0.05 (0.55)*	*65.7*	*29,798*
High Gov. Effectiveness	-0.01 (0.01)	63.2	31,399	*0.47 (0.69)*	*70.1*	*34,656*
Low Rule of Law	0.00 (0.02)	52.4	19,802	*68.56 (307.9)*	*86.3*	*31,082*
High Rule of Law	-0.00 (0.01)	53.1	31,555	*0.30 (4.81)*	*42.7*	*25,186*
Low Primary Ed. Completion	-0.00 (0.01)	60.9	28,762	*0.72 (1.18)*	*71.0*	*33,961*
High Primary Ed. Completion	-0.00 (0.01)	58.4	28,187	*-0.82 (2.76)*	*53.0*	*26,066*

Notes: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05, + p<0.1. RF is the robust bias-corrected RD estimate of CMB eligibility on husband works. Fuzzy RD is the corresponding 2SLS estimate for not marrying before age 18 (Calonico et al., 2014). Each uses its own MSE-optimal bandwidth (BW, in months). N is total effective observations. Fuzzy RD estimates in italics have a weak instrument (F<10) and are unreliable. Robust standard errors in parentheses.

D.3 Robustness

Table A28: First Stage: Ever-Married Subsample

Subsample	Estimate (SE)	Mean	p-value	N (Left)	N (Right)	BW
Full Sample	0.012 (0.008)	0.585	0.139	91,905	68,603	61.6
Rural	0.023^{+} (0.012)	0.509	0.051	41,358	33,349	47.6
Urban	-0.007 (0.011)	0.679	0.501	51,628	34,599	81.9
Age 18–24	0.045* (0.018)	0.440	0.013	14,078	16,362	32.1
Age 25–34	0.014 (0.014)	0.654	0.315	29,353	23,236	37.2
Age 35+	-0.030 (0.039)	0.717	0.439	5,570	2,848	27.0
No Primary Education	0.009 (0.015)	0.382	0.549	29,992	19,490	60.3
Primary Education	0.021^{+} (0.011)	0.685	0.064	39,407	34,609	40.4
Not Literate	0.009 (0.013)	0.426	0.517	32,913	25,867	47.2
Literate	0.016 (0.012)	0.728	0.189	30,077	25,560	49.1
Poor (Median)	0.019^{+} (0.011)	0.507	0.070	52,228	38,708	65.4
Non-Poor (Median)	0.008 (0.012)	0.662	0.496	35,714	27,748	51.3
Poor (75P)	0.019^{+} (0.010)	0.533	0.070	53,103	43,800	46.7
Non-Poor (75P)	0.002 (0.016)	0.731	0.885	20,633	14,471	62.9
Christian	0.007 (0.016)	0.563	0.686	22,472	18,512	42.6
Muslim	0.016 (0.012)	0.651	0.188	37,145	29,754	51.5
Low Child Marriage Rate	0.030* (0.012)	0.781	0.013	33,928	23,741	68.9
Medium Child Marriage Rate	0.014 (0.018)	0.580	0.442	18,740	15,912	37.5
High Child Marriage Rate	-0.005 (0.018)	0.379	0.799	20,542	17,213	42.8
Previous Age 16/17	0.027^{+} (0.016)	0.569	0.092	24,324	16,923	42.8
Previous Age 14/15	0.020 (0.015)	0.592	0.188	23,658	21,587	36.9
No Previous Age	-0.012 (0.019)	0.611	0.526	11,601	10,845	50.8
Low Adolescent Fertility	0.026* (0.013)	0.740	0.050	30,736	24,189	44.5
High Adolescent Fertility	-0.000 (0.014)	0.436	0.989	31,692	27,483	41.1
Autocracy	0.049 (0.037)	0.483	0.189	5,974	5,245	23.4
Anocracy	0.019* (0.009)	0.571	0.046	73,892	51,990	77.8
Democracy	0.022 (0.022)	0.650	0.310	7,747	6,709	37.9
Low GDP p.c.	0.015 (0.014)	0.483	0.275	32,061	27,431	46.6
High GDP p.c.	0.010 (0.012)	0.681	0.382	41,401	30,791	52.8
Low Gov. Effectiveness	0.013 (0.015)	0.490	0.370	27,226	23,521	42.0
High Gov. Effectiveness	0.010 (0.012)	0.678	0.431	34,662	27,855	42.1
Low Rule of Law	0.021 (0.015)	0.518	0.173	25,570	20,765	49.1
High Rule of Law	0.003 (0.011)	0.631	0.783	49,117	38,293	51.4
Low Primary Ed. Completion	0.008 (0.014)	0.489	0.563	26,902	24,259	40.0
High Primary Ed. Completion	0.013 (0.012)	0.680	0.256	40,398	30,058	51.0
Excluding Pregnancy-Driven	0.017^{+} (0.009)	0.589	0.057	68,906	54,109	53.7

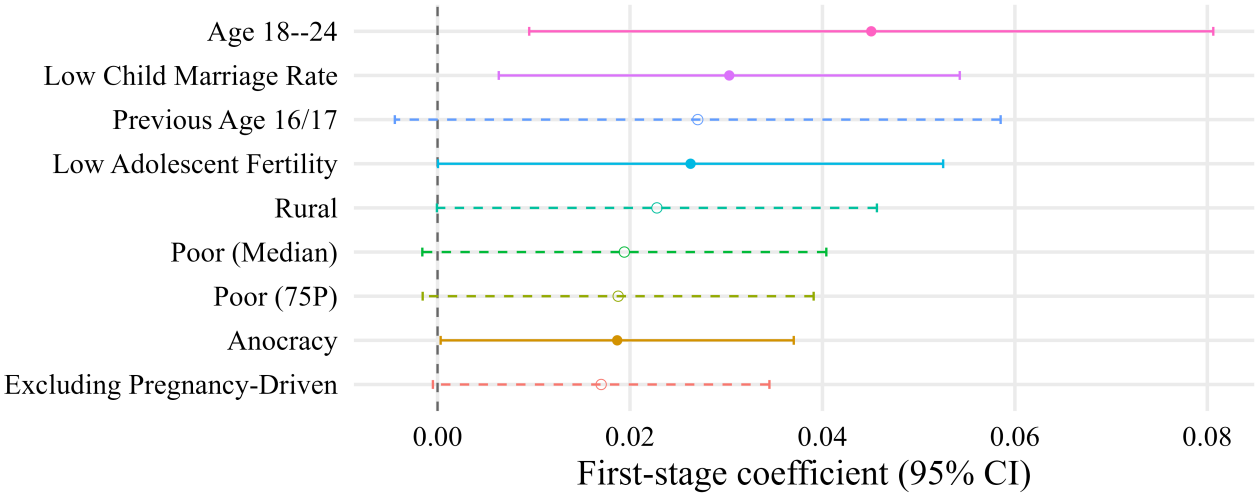
Notes: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05, + p<0.1. Estimates are robust bias-corrected RDD coefficients (SE in parentheses) of CMB eligibility on not marrying before age 18, using Calonico et al. (2014), restricted to women who were ever married. Mean refers to the weighted control group mean of the outcome within the estimation bandwidth. N (Left)/N (Right) are effective observations within the MSE-optimal bandwidth on each side of the cutoff. BW: Bandwidth (months).

Table A29: First Stage: Excluding Pregnancy-Driven

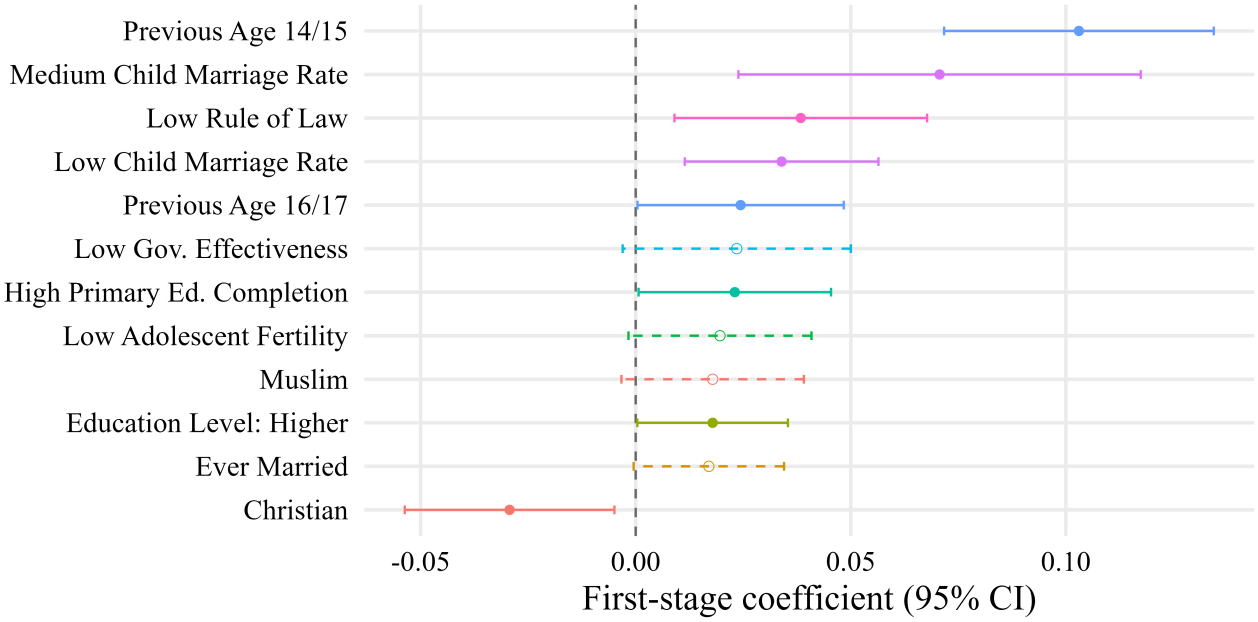
Subsample	Estimate (SE)	Mean	p-value	N (Left)	N (Right)	BW
Full Sample	0.007 (0.008)	0.680	0.388	79,581	68,709	51.0
Rural	0.014 (0.011)	0.602	0.214	46,377	38,940	52.7
Urban	-0.007 (0.010)	0.771	0.520	44,458	38,070	63.1
Age 18–24	0.021 (0.015)	0.667	0.150	18,836	20,997	30.6
Age 25–34	0.007 (0.015)	0.699	0.670	22,009	18,575	29.7
Age 35+	0.010 (0.035)	0.729	0.783	6,587	3,083	31.3
No Primary Education	0.002 (0.016)	0.450	0.914	30,436	20,107	64.8
Primary Education	0.014 (0.009)	0.772	0.139	44,282	41,375	39.1
Not Literate	-0.002 (0.012)	0.502	0.861	52,404	36,838	76.0
Literate	0.011 (0.009)	0.806	0.211	40,751	39,437	55.5
Poor (Median)	0.015 (0.011)	0.592	0.182	44,674	37,192	57.3
Non-Poor (Median)	0.002 (0.010)	0.753	0.841	42,449	37,021	52.3
Poor (75P)	0.012 (0.010)	0.622	0.237	58,765	50,593	50.5
Non-Poor (75P)	0.005 (0.012)	0.816	0.664	23,413	20,041	56.8
Christian	-0.029* (0.012)	0.711	0.018	32,433	27,679	50.4
Muslim	0.018+ (0.011)	0.701	0.098	40,082	33,813	54.4
Low Child Marriage Rate	0.034** (0.011)	0.825	0.003	26,233	21,889	51.4
Medium Child Marriage Rate	0.071** (0.024)	0.720	0.003	8,832	8,087	16.9
High Child Marriage Rate	-0.018 (0.015)	0.499	0.222	32,583	28,303	62.1
Previous Age 16/17	0.024* (0.012)	0.661	0.046	30,177	22,741	46.8
Previous Age 14/15	0.103*** (0.016)	0.686	<0.001	21,323	20,359	30.6
No Previous Age	-0.033 (0.021)	0.705	0.111	9,422	9,433	40.5
Low Adolescent Fertility	0.020+ (0.011)	0.797	0.071	35,318	28,829	46.1
High Adolescent Fertility	0.004 (0.011)	0.567	0.748	53,025	46,272	64.3
Autocracy	-0.002 (0.025)	0.631	0.940	13,211	11,007	45.4
Anocracy	0.010 (0.009)	0.665	0.243	72,961	58,545	71.6
Democracy	0.022 (0.015)	0.747	0.148	10,656	10,561	48.9
Low GDP p.c.	0.019 (0.013)	0.602	0.169	30,533	28,541	40.2
High GDP p.c.	0.001 (0.010)	0.754	0.912	47,053	37,787	57.0
Low Gov. Effectiveness	0.023+ (0.014)	0.609	0.083	29,013	26,616	40.8
High Gov. Effectiveness	-0.001 (0.010)	0.749	0.903	45,672	36,808	52.4
Low Rule of Law	0.038* (0.015)	0.657	0.010	22,352	20,327	37.2
High Rule of Law	-0.003 (0.010)	0.701	0.794	44,680	38,153	45.4
Low Primary Ed. Completion	-0.009 (0.012)	0.622	0.440	40,903	37,037	57.4
High Primary Ed. Completion	0.023* (0.011)	0.742	0.043	34,114	28,397	39.6
Ever Married	0.017+ (0.009)	0.585	0.057	68,906	54,109	53.7

Notes: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05, + p<0.1. Estimates are robust bias-corrected RDD coefficients (SE in parentheses) of CMB eligibility on not marrying before age 18, using Calonico et al. (2014), excluding women whose marriage was potentially caused by pregnancy. Mean refers to the weighted control group mean of the outcome within the estimation bandwidth. N (Left)/N (Right) are effective observations within the MSE-optimal bandwidth on each side of the cutoff. BW: Bandwidth (months).

Figure A2: Ever-Married Women and Excluding Pregnancy-Drivens



(a) Ever-Married Women



(b) Excluding Pregnancy-Drivens

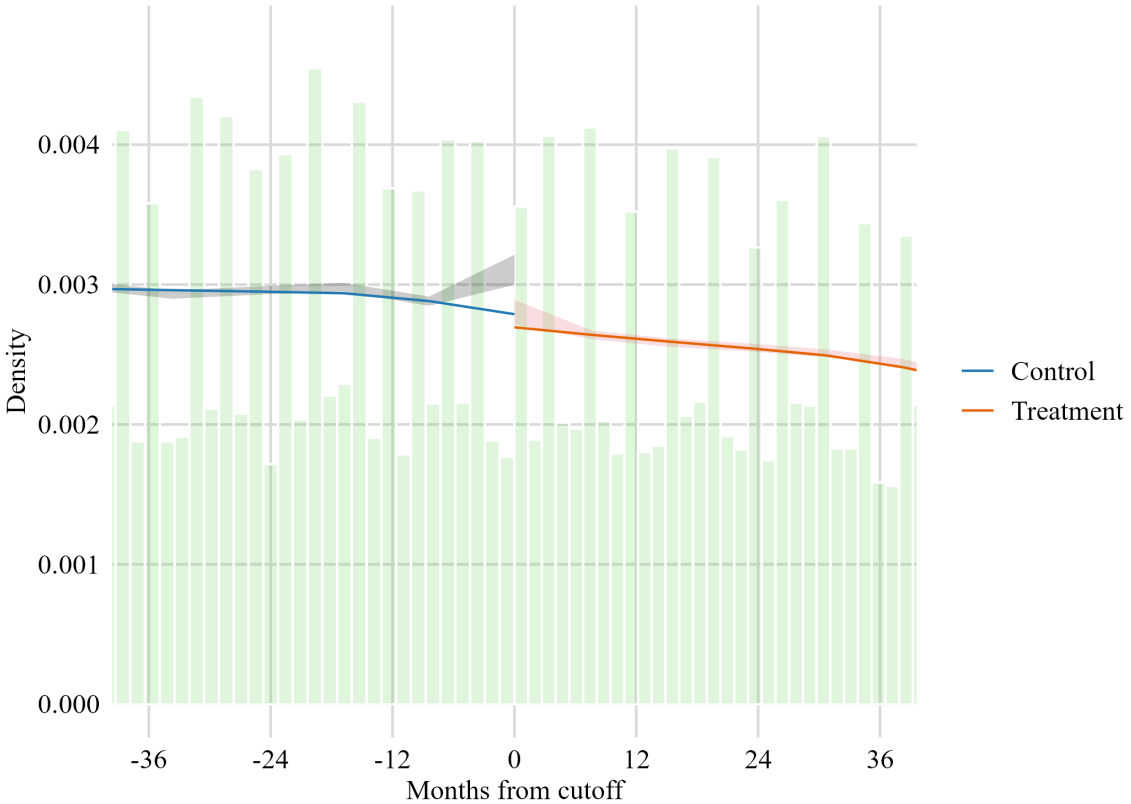
Notes: Both figures feature only subsamples that are statistically significant at the 10% level, in panel (a) for women that were ever married and in panel (b) excluding marriages that were motivated by pregnancy. Each point is the robust bias-corrected local-linear RDD coefficient (Calonico et al., 2014) for the probability of marrying at or after the legal minimum age (i.e., not marrying before age 18) at the reform cutoff, estimated separately within each subsample. Horizontal bars are 95% confidence intervals. All regressions control for rural residence, religion, and country and survey-year fixed effects, and cluster standard errors at the primary sampling unit level. Solid lines and filled markers denote significance at the 5% level, dashed lines and hollow markers denote significance only at the 10% level.

Table A30: Manipulation Test: Pooled Density Test

Robust T	p-value	N (Effective, Left / Right)	N (Raw, Left / Right)
-4.26	<0.001	50,050 / 42,898	475,338 / 211,717

Notes: Cattaneo et al. (2020)'s manipulation test on the running variable at the reform cutoff, pooled across all countries. N (Effective) is the number of observations used by the local polynomial density estimator on each side of the cutoff; N (Raw) is the full sample on each side.

Figure A3: Manipulation Test: Density of the Running Variable at the Cutoff (Pooled Sample)



Notes: Estimated density of the running variable (months from the reform cutoff) on either side of the cutoff, pooled across all countries, using Cattaneo et al. (2020)'s local polynomial density estimator. Shaded regions are 95% confidence bands. A discontinuity in the density at the cutoff would indicate manipulation or sorting of the running variable; Appendix Table A30 reports the corresponding formal test.

Table A31: Manipulation Test: Country-Level Heaping Collision Check

Country	Cutoff Month	Heaping Ratio	t_{jk}	p-value (BH)	Flagged
Benin	Sep	0.86	-8.70	<0.001	Yes
Ghana	Jan	1.30	-8.25	<0.001	Yes
Comoros	Jan	1.30	5.73	<0.001	Yes
Guinea	Sep	0.86	-4.53	<0.001	Yes
Tajikistan	Jan	1.30	3.98	<0.001	Yes
Sierra Leone	Sep	0.86	-2.88	0.013	Yes
Madagascar	Aug	0.97	-2.64	0.024	Yes
Mozambique	Dec	0.88	2.31	0.052	Yes
Liberia	Feb	1.05	2.07	0.086	Yes
DR Congo	Jan	1.30	1.78	0.150	No
Namibia	Jul	1.00	-1.64	0.185	No
Nepal	Sep	0.86	-1.54	0.206	No
Kenya	May	1.08	-1.33	0.280	No
Jordan	Apr	1.11	-0.66	0.669	No
Albania	May	1.08	0.64	0.669	No
Ethiopia	Jul	1.00	-0.58	0.669	No
Egypt	Jun	1.04	0.57	0.669	No
Maldives	Jan	1.30	-0.48	0.699	No
Gambia	Jul	1.00	-0.31	0.755	No
Togo	Jul	1.00	-0.31	0.755	No

Notes: Per-country Cattaneo et al. (2020) density test at each country's own reform cutoff. Cutoff Month is the calendar month the country's cutoff falls on. Heaping Ratio is the ratio of births in that calendar month to the count expected under a uniform distribution across months, pooled across the full sample. p-values are Benjamini-Hochberg adjusted across the 20 countries; Flagged indicates significance at the 10% level after adjustment.

Table A32: Balance of Predetermined Covariates and Subsamples at CMB Cutoff

Covariate	Estimate (SE)	p-value	N (Left)	N (Right)	BW
Rural	0.0042 (0.0106)	0.692	129,589	107,794	64.6
Christian	-0.0162 (0.0105)	0.124	96,462	84,683	49.1
Muslim	0.0187^{+} (0.0111)	0.091	74,060	66,955	38.7
GDP p.c.	-2.78 (31.03)	0.929	96,829	84,903	48.5
Gov. Effectiveness	-0.0122 (0.0131)	0.352	91,071	80,647	45.5
Rule of Law	-0.0410^{***} (0.0116)	<0.001	64,643	58,804	32.4
Primary Ed. Completion	1.42^{*} (0.587)	0.015	77,993	69,737	39.5

Notes: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05, + p<0.1. Each row is a separate robust bias-corrected local-linear RD estimate (Calonico et al., 2014) of the listed covariate on the running variable at the reform cutoff, for the full sample, with no additional controls. Rural, Christian, and Muslim are individual-level covariates; GDP p.c., Gov. Effectiveness, Rule of Law, and Primary Ed. Completion are country-level institutional covariates. Standard errors clustered at the primary sampling unit level in parentheses. BW: Bandwidth (months).

Table A33: Effect of CMBs on Age at First Marriage, Months (First Stage)

Subsample	Estimate (SE)	Mean	p-value	N (Left)	N (Right)	BW
Full Sample	1.111 (0.904)	231.33	0.219	58,188	45,777	48.5
Ever Married	0.806 (0.912)	231.33	0.377	56,954	45,113	47.3
Excluding Pregnancy-Driven	1.061 (0.934)	232.87	0.256	57,105	43,111	55.8
Rural	1.905* (0.902)	222.53	0.035	43,597	31,781	61.2
Urban	-0.474 (1.845)	243.86	0.797	16,548	14,180	33.0
Age 18–24	3.671** (1.313)	210.05	0.005	8,290	9,930	23.0
Age 25–34	1.068 (1.735)	234.86	0.538	21,207	16,542	32.7
Age 35+	4.599 (7.556)	251.87	0.543	4,239	1,993	28.6
No Primary Education	-0.708 (1.379)	213.12	0.608	21,234	13,059	61.6
Primary Education	2.224+ (1.302)	240.25	0.088	25,661	23,439	30.9
Not Literate	0.029 (1.062)	220.51	0.978	39,683	25,907	70.1
Literate	0.528 (1.403)	251.44	0.707	28,860	23,185	55.5
Poor (Median)	1.927 (1.188)	224.93	0.105	23,016	19,804	37.6
Non-Poor (Median)	0.645 (1.153)	242.78	0.576	38,439	26,681	65.1
Poor (75P)	0.522 (0.960)	227.93	0.586	44,208	35,746	47.4
Non-Poor (75P)	1.365 (1.655)	251.08	0.410	21,364	13,115	75.7
Christian	2.163 (2.008)	232.19	0.281	12,005	10,940	28.5
Muslim	0.451 (1.299)	233.54	0.728	25,908	21,554	39.8
Low Child Marriage Rate	5.509** (1.762)	243.29	0.002	14,288	12,444	31.2
Medium Child Marriage Rate	-2.426 (2.024)	228.66	0.231	14,306	12,914	29.9
High Child Marriage Rate	2.841 (1.882)	212.27	0.131	7,377	6,290	35.8
Low Adolescent Fertility	0.902 (1.465)	238.63	0.538	26,207	21,155	38.2
High Adolescent Fertility	0.832 (1.145)	219.28	0.467	23,745	19,556	47.1
Autocracy	3.047 (3.357)	222.19	0.364	2,766	2,953	13.7
Anocracy	0.425 (1.134)	233.72	0.708	41,725	30,391	62.6
Democracy	-0.090 (3.052)	239.76	0.977	4,006	3,818	19.0
No Previous Age	-3.603 (2.708)	229.04	0.183	6,613	6,105	28.1
Previous Age 16/17	3.298* (1.497)	226.34	0.028	11,077	8,414	27.8
Previous Age 14/15	1.659 (1.522)	239.57	0.276	19,544	18,246	38.9
Low GDP p.c.	0.888 (1.461)	221.65	0.544	13,110	12,756	32.4
High GDP p.c.	0.349 (1.069)	236.58	0.744	43,109	31,798	55.0
Low Gov. Effectiveness	4.061* (1.794)	224.48	0.024	11,221	10,510	31.3
High Gov. Effectiveness	0.145 (1.254)	234.10	0.908	33,818	27,306	41.4
Low Rule of Law	—†	225.43	—	12,151	11,044	32.5
High Rule of Law	0.658 (1.493)	234.39	0.659	24,011	20,727	30.8
Low Primary Ed. Completion	0.178 (1.627)	222.46	0.913	17,279	16,487	32.8
High Primary Ed. Completion	0.896 (1.221)	238.74	0.463	33,557	24,256	50.3

Notes: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05, + p<0.1. Estimates are robust bias-corrected RDD coefficients (SE in parentheses) of CMB eligibility on age at first marriage in months, using Calonico et al. (2014). The outcome is constructed directly from month-level marriage- and birth-date components, not by rescaling the years variable. Mean refers to the weighted control group mean of the outcome within the estimation bandwidth. N (Left)/N (Right) are effective observations within the bandwidth on each side of the cutoff. BW: Bandwidth (months). Since age at first marriage is only observed for ever-married respondents, the estimation sample is restricted relative to the binary first stage and is not directly comparable to it. † Excluded: the Low Rule of Law estimate is numerically implausible (exceeding 100 years) and reflects a degenerate fit rather than a meaningful result.

Table A34: First Stage by Subsample: Raw and Benjamini-Hochberg Adjusted p-values

Subsample	Estimate (SE)	Mean	p-value	BH p-value	N (Left)	N (Right)	BW
Full Sample	0.004 (0.008)	0.666	0.574	0.787	94,893	80,101	54.0
Ever Married	0.012 (0.008)	0.584	0.139	0.428	91,905	68,603	61.6
Excluding Pregnancy-Driven	0.007 (0.008)	0.679	0.388	0.707	79,581	68,709	51.0
Rural	0.015 (0.011)	0.586	0.159	0.453	48,569	40,898	49.0
Urban	-0.012 (0.010)	0.763	0.221	0.544	46,552	39,649	60.8
Age 18-24	0.021 (0.014)	0.640	0.131	0.428	22,956	26,253	34.1
Age 25-34	0.017 (0.016)	0.695	0.300	0.652	20,196	17,391	24.0
Age 35+	0.009 (0.038)	0.735	0.805	0.949	5,081	2,596	24.7
No Primary Education	-0.008 (0.013)	0.417	0.553	0.787	42,140	25,372	75.2
Primary Education	0.004 (0.008)	0.718	0.564	0.787	76,394	67,941	61.8
Not Literate	-0.003 (0.011)	0.489	0.820	0.949	58,578	41,235	73.4
Literate	0.007 (0.009)	0.798	0.431	0.725	42,600	40,429	52.5
Poor (Median)	0.014 (0.011)	0.577	0.198	0.523	51,780	42,319	58.1
Non-Poor (Median)	0.001 (0.011)	0.743	0.895	0.974	38,853	34,157	43.5
Poor (75P)	0.009 (0.009)	0.609	0.317	0.652	65,067	55,518	49.8
Non-Poor (75P)	0.001 (0.012)	0.807	0.959	0.983	26,016	21,904	57.6
Christian	-0.011 (0.012)	0.692	0.387	0.707	35,400	30,084	47.2
Muslim	0.021^{+} (0.012)	0.696	0.065	0.398	36,361	31,457	45.4
Low Child Marriage Rate	0.068*** (0.013)	0.825	<0.001	<0.001	21,780	18,946	41.4
Medium Child Marriage Rate	0.012 (0.015)	0.694	0.401	0.707	23,853	20,757	37.0
High Child Marriage Rate	-0.021 (0.014)	0.479	0.119	0.428	39,276	32,900	68.3
Previous Age 16/17	0.029* (0.013)	0.657	0.031	0.398	28,514	21,833	40.4
Previous Age 14/15	-0.010 (0.013)	0.674	0.472	0.754	27,184	25,632	34.7
No Previous Age	-0.037* (0.019)	0.682	0.049	0.398	12,151	12,074	44.5
Low Adolescent Fertility	0.021* (0.010)	0.789	0.045	0.398	38,947	31,464	46.7
High Adolescent Fertility	0.004 (0.011)	0.548	0.725	0.924	55,517	48,601	59.8
Autocracy	0.002 (0.023)	0.611	0.926	0.979	14,436	12,262	43.4
Anocracy	-0.000 (0.010)	0.658	0.983	0.983	57,786	47,837	51.7
Democracy	0.033^{+} (0.017)	0.731	0.061	0.398	8,719	8,744	32.7
Low GDP p.c.	0.013 (0.012)	0.585	0.298	0.652	37,189	34,291	45.0
High GDP p.c.	-0.002 (0.010)	0.744	0.870	0.974	46,399	37,486	49.5
Low Gov. Effectiveness	0.026^{+} (0.015)	0.602	0.097	0.428	23,539	21,549	30.5
High Gov. Effectiveness	-0.007 (0.010)	0.737	0.489	0.754	50,061	40,321	50.4
Low Rule of Law	0.023 (0.015)	0.642	0.116	0.428	23,656	21,435	35.6
High Rule of Law	-0.002 (0.009)	0.689	0.812	0.949	60,846	49,544	54.3
Low Primary Ed. Completion	-0.006 (0.013)	0.604	0.652	0.861	35,956	33,755	43.9
High Primary Ed. Completion	0.016 (0.010)	0.729	0.126	0.428	43,750	35,629	46.3

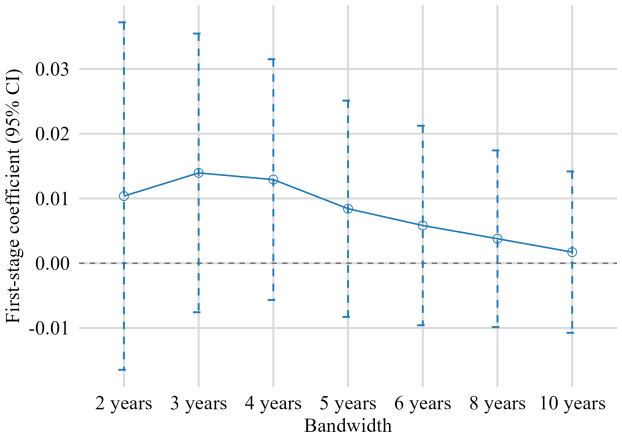
Notes: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05, + p<0.1 (uncorrected). Estimates are robust bias-corrected RDD coefficients (SE in parentheses) of CMB eligibility on not marrying before age 18, using Calonico et al. (2014). Mean refers to the weighted control-group mean of the outcome within the estimation bandwidth. BH p-value is the Benjamini-Hochberg adjusted p-value, correcting for multiple testing across all 37 subsamples reported here. N (Left)/N (Right) are effective observations within the MSE-optimal bandwidth on each side of the cutoff. BW: Bandwidth (months).

Table A35: Effect of CMBs on Marrying in Adulthood: Annual Running Variable (First Stage)

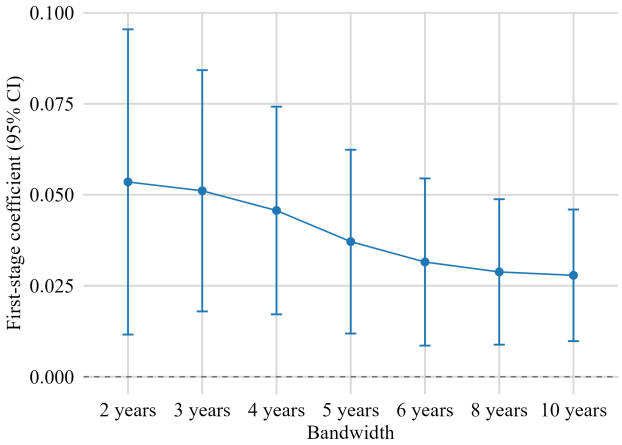
Subsample	Estimate (SE)	Mean	p-value	N (Left)	N (Right)	BW
Full Sample	0.002 (0.008)	0.665	0.812	86,112	90,871	4.5
Ever Married	0.011 (0.012)	0.586	0.355	53,111	58,282	3.5
Excluding Pregnancy-Driven	0.006 (0.008)	0.677	0.486	76,700	82,170	4.8
Rural	0.003 (0.012)	0.587	0.810	48,904	50,618	4.2
Urban	-0.008 (0.010)	0.762	0.432	46,660	46,707	5.2
Age 18–24	-0.003 (0.015)	0.627	0.859	22,697	35,967	3.8
Age 25–34	0.009 (0.014)	0.688	0.531	31,274	33,509	3.7
Age 35+	0.043 (0.028)	0.723	0.123	9,957	4,896	3.4
No Primary Education	-0.004 (0.014)	0.440	0.780	33,514	26,365	5.8
Primary Education	-0.000 (0.008)	0.756	0.980	60,315	67,630	4.6
Not Literate	0.006 (0.012)	0.489	0.634	47,903	42,579	5.8
Literate	0.006 (0.012)	0.801	0.577	29,420	37,229	3.7
Poor (Median)	0.001 (0.012)	0.577	0.913	42,704	44,476	4.5
Non-Poor (Median)	0.007 (0.010)	0.740	0.529	43,408	46,395	5.0
Poor (75P)	0.003 (0.010)	0.609	0.767	64,166	67,587	4.6
Non-Poor (75P)	0.002 (0.012)	0.806	0.884	27,294	26,851	5.2
Christian	-0.032* (0.013)	0.692	0.016	26,708	31,090	3.9
Muslim	0.015 (0.013)	0.696	0.240	38,908	40,621	4.1
Low Child Marriage Rate	0.004 (0.015)	0.824	0.810	19,249	21,676	3.6
Medium Child Marriage Rate	–†	0.696	–	23,190	27,411	3.9
High Child Marriage Rate	0.011 (0.017)	0.483	0.532	28,018	30,788	4.2
Previous Age 16/17	0.052*** (0.014)	0.644	<0.001	35,087	31,472	4.2
Previous Age 14/15	0.002 (0.014)	0.678	0.915	27,971	35,566	3.8
No Previous Age	-0.038* (0.016)	0.672	0.019	15,937	19,374	5.6
Low Adolescent Fertility	-0.001 (0.014)	0.794	0.941	30,522	32,752	3.3
High Adolescent Fertility	0.012 (0.013)	0.546	0.335	44,555	50,631	4.7
Autocracy	0.002 (0.027)	0.611	0.952	12,144	13,395	3.6
Anocracy	0.010 (0.009)	0.652	0.283	67,235	64,748	5.5
Democracy	-0.054** (0.020)	0.733	0.007	9,102	12,992	3.8
Low GDP p.c.	0.028+ (0.016)	0.590	0.076	30,167	36,836	3.4
High GDP p.c.	-0.026* (0.012)	0.743	0.037	33,761	37,536	3.7
Low Gov. Effectiveness	0.020 (0.016)	0.593	0.200	28,429	33,704	3.5
High Gov. Effectiveness	-0.006 (0.011)	0.736	0.578	48,422	48,579	4.1
Low Rule of Law	0.023 (0.017)	0.641	0.191	24,157	28,463	3.4
High Rule of Law	-0.011 (0.010)	0.690	0.274	54,074	55,568	4.3
Low Primary Ed. Completion	-0.020+ (0.012)	0.598	0.082	50,393	52,105	5.6
High Primary Ed. Completion	0.011 (0.012)	0.729	0.337	46,805	45,362	4.0

Notes: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05, + p<0.1. Estimates are robust bias-corrected RDD coefficients (SE in parentheses) of CMB eligibility on not marrying before age 18, using Calonico et al. (2014), with the running variable collapsed to years since the reform in place of the baseline monthly measure. Mean refers to the weighted control group mean of the outcome within the estimation bandwidth. N (Left)/N (Right) are effective observations within the bandwidth on each side of the cutoff. BW: Bandwidth (years). † Excluded: the fitted coefficient for this subsample is outside the $[-1, 1]$ range mechanically implied by a binary outcome, reflecting an unstable fit rather than a meaningful effect.

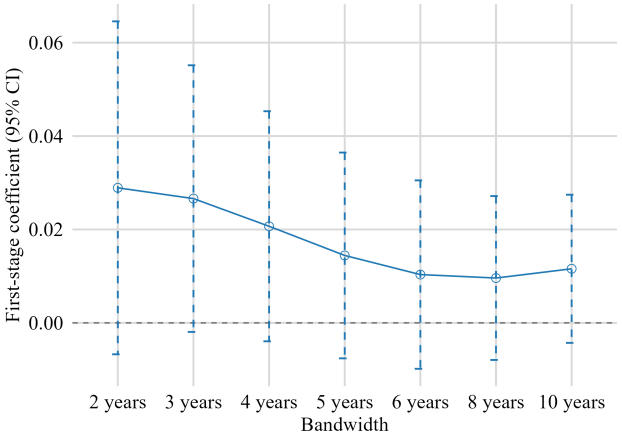
Figure A4: First Stage Across Fixed Bandwidths: Full Sample and Headline Subsamples



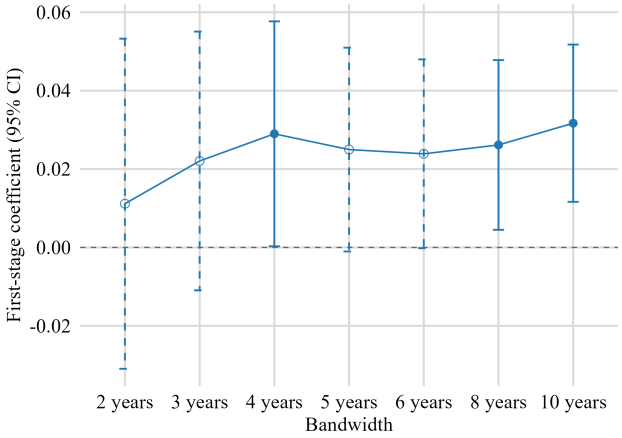
(a) Full Sample



(b) Low Child Marriage Rate



(c) Low Adolescent Fertility



(d) Previous Age 16/17

Notes: Each point is the robust bias-corrected first-stage RDD coefficient (Calonico et al., 2014), estimated at the fixed bandwidth (h = b, not data-driven) shown on the x-axis, in place of the baseline MSE-optimal bandwidth, with 95% confidence intervals. Solid lines and filled markers denote significance at the 5% level, dashed lines and hollow markers denote non-significance. Appendix Table A36 reports the full comparison across all subsamples.

Table A36: First Stage Across Fixed Bandwidths

Subsample	2 yrs	3 yrs	4 yrs	5 yrs	6 yrs	8 yrs	10 yrs
Full Sample	0.010	0.014	0.013	0.008	0.006	0.004	0.002
Ever Married	0.011	0.016	0.020^{+}	0.016	0.014	0.013	0.010
Excluding Pregnancy-Driven	0.019	0.019^{+}	0.016	0.011	0.008	0.007	0.005
Rural	0.021	0.031*	0.023^{+}	0.017	0.015	0.013	0.010
Urban	0.004	-0.004	0.002	-0.001	-0.005	-0.009	-0.009
Age 18–24	0.013	0.022	0.015	0.007	0.003	0.003	0.002
Age 25–34	0.021	0.011	0.015	0.011	0.012	0.006	0.001
Age 35+	-0.051	-0.010	0.004	0.000	-0.001	-0.001	-0.001
No Primary Education	-0.009	-0.000	-0.003	-0.007	-0.008	-0.004	-0.003
Primary Education	0.014	0.017	0.017	0.012	0.009	0.005	0.003
Not Literate	-0.019	0.002	0.006	0.001	-0.001	-0.002	-0.004
Literate	0.004	0.009	0.007	0.008	0.007	0.006	0.008
Poor (Median)	0.034^{+}	0.040*	0.029*	0.021^{+}	0.016	0.012	0.007
Non-Poor (Median)	-0.000	-0.003	0.001	-0.001	-0.003	-0.004	-0.003
Poor (75P)	0.021	0.022^{+}	0.018	0.014	0.010	0.007	0.004
Non-Poor (75P)	-0.002	0.007	0.012	0.006	0.002	-0.001	-0.003
Christian	-0.012	-0.005	-0.003	-0.007	-0.010	-0.014	-0.013
Muslim	0.037^{+}	0.036*	0.036*	0.029*	0.022^{+}	0.017^{+}	0.012
Low Child Marriage Rate	0.054*	0.051**	0.046**	0.037**	0.032**	0.029**	0.028**
Medium Child Marriage Rate	0.012	0.012	0.014	0.008	0.006	0.003	0.001
High Child Marriage Rate	-0.040	-0.022	-0.017	-0.022	-0.022	-0.025^{+}	-0.027*
Previous Age 16/17	0.011	0.022	0.029*	0.025^{+}	0.024^{+}	0.026*	0.032**
Previous Age 14/15	0.012	0.019	0.014	0.011	0.008	0.000	-0.007
No Previous Age	-0.004	-0.016	-0.022	-0.031	-0.034^{+}	-0.031^{+}	-0.029*
Low Adolescent Fertility	0.029	0.027^{+}	0.021^{+}	0.014	0.010	0.010	0.012
High Adolescent Fertility	-0.009	0.002	0.004	0.002	0.001	-0.001	-0.006
Autocracy	0.041	0.031	0.032	0.016	0.006	0.000	-0.011
Anocracy	0.007	0.010	0.009	0.005	0.003	0.003	0.004
Democracy	0.035	0.033	0.035^{+}	0.028^{+}	0.026^{+}	0.016	0.011
Low GDP p.c.	0.006	0.013	0.016	0.012	0.010	0.007	0.006
High GDP p.c.	0.014	0.015	0.011	0.005	0.002	0.001	-0.001
Low Gov. Effectiveness	0.034	0.029^{+}	0.028^{+}	0.022^{+}	0.020	0.018^{+}	0.015
High Gov. Effectiveness	-0.008	0.003	0.001	-0.004	-0.006	-0.008	-0.008
Low Rule of Law	0.026	0.021	0.027^{+}	0.018	0.017	0.002	0.007
High Rule of Law	-0.001	0.007	0.002	-0.002	-0.002	0.001	-0.000
Low Primary Ed. Completion	-0.015	-0.003	0.002	-0.002	-0.004	-0.010	-0.012
High Primary Ed. Completion	0.036*	0.032*	0.026*	0.019^{+}	0.015	0.016^{+}	0.015^{+}

Notes: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05, + p<0.1. Each cell is a separate robust bias-corrected first-stage RDD coefficient (Calonico et al., 2014), estimated at the fixed bandwidth (h = b, not data-driven) shown in the column header, in place of the baseline MSE-optimal bandwidth. Standard errors clustered at the primary sampling unit level (omitted from the table for space; available on request).

Table A37: Effect of CMBs on Marrying in Adulthood (CER-Optimal Bandwidth, First Stage)

Subsample	Estimate (SE)	Mean	p-value	N (Left)	N (Right)	BW
Full Sample	0.012 (0.009)	0.674	0.176	55,293	49,672	31.0
Ever Married	0.017^{+} (0.009)	0.588	0.073	51,163	43,599	35.5
Excluding Pregnancy-Driven	0.015^{+} (0.009)	0.687	0.093	46,312	41,717	29.3
Rural	0.025* (0.012)	0.595	0.041	29,020	25,794	29.0
Urban	-0.000 (0.011)	0.775	0.973	27,724	25,070	36.4
Age 18–24	0.015 (0.016)	0.651	0.345	14,656	15,322	20.0
Age 25–34	0.018 (0.019)	0.690	0.335	10,898	11,176	14.1
Age 35+	-0.038 (0.045)	0.779	0.398	2,449	1,410	14.8
No Primary Education	-0.005 (0.015)	0.435	0.755	23,444	17,513	44.6
Primary Education	0.014^{+} (0.009)	0.763	0.095	44,152	41,354	35.7
Not Literate	0.001 (0.013)	0.490	0.936	33,279	27,621	43.2
Literate	0.008 (0.010)	0.806	0.431	24,924	24,086	30.8
Poor (Median)	0.023^{+} (0.012)	0.583	0.055	29,182	25,816	33.9
Non-Poor (Median)	0.001 (0.012)	0.753	0.940	22,524	20,348	25.3
Poor (75P)	0.018^{+} (0.011)	0.619	0.085	36,869	33,092	28.8
Non-Poor (75P)	0.010 (0.013)	0.820	0.449	15,547	13,860	34.4
Christian	-0.009 (0.014)	0.704	0.502	20,902	18,793	28.0
Muslim	0.032* (0.013)	0.705	0.017	20,657	18,317	26.8
Low Child Marriage Rate	0.041** (0.015)	0.829	0.005	12,433	11,724	24.9
Medium Child Marriage Rate	-0.072*** (0.018)	0.700	<0.001	14,565	12,923	22.4
High Child Marriage Rate	-0.020 (0.015)	0.489	0.190	24,780	22,357	42.0
Previous Age 16/17	0.032* (0.015)	0.665	0.030	16,833	13,938	24.2
Previous Age 14/15	0.019 (0.016)	0.679	0.238	15,776	15,445	20.8
No Previous Age	-0.039^{+} (0.021)	0.696	0.065	7,849	7,422	28.3
Low Adolescent Fertility	0.018 (0.012)	0.799	0.135	22,754	19,325	27.6
High Adolescent Fertility	0.007 (0.012)	0.554	0.552	33,005	31,010	36.0
Autocracy	0.002 (0.026)	0.605	0.946	8,014	7,699	27.0
Anocracy	0.009 (0.011)	0.667	0.395	34,510	29,020	30.4
Democracy	-0.840*** (0.090)	0.719	<0.001	5,648	5,692	20.8
Low GDP p.c.	0.005 (0.014)	0.596	0.716	22,189	20,995	27.2
High GDP p.c.	0.010 (0.012)	0.751	0.386	27,570	23,314	29.1
Low Gov. Effectiveness	0.021 (0.017)	0.613	0.220	13,608	12,619	18.6
High Gov. Effectiveness	-0.002 (0.011)	0.743	0.889	28,995	25,704	29.5
Low Rule of Law	0.027^{+} (0.017)	0.646	0.100	14,079	12,457	21.7
High Rule of Law	0.003 (0.010)	0.697	0.765	34,378	30,558	31.8
Low Primary Ed. Completion	-0.001 (0.014)	0.613	0.947	21,371	20,166	26.4
High Primary Ed. Completion	0.024* (0.012)	0.739	0.039	25,616	21,784	27.3

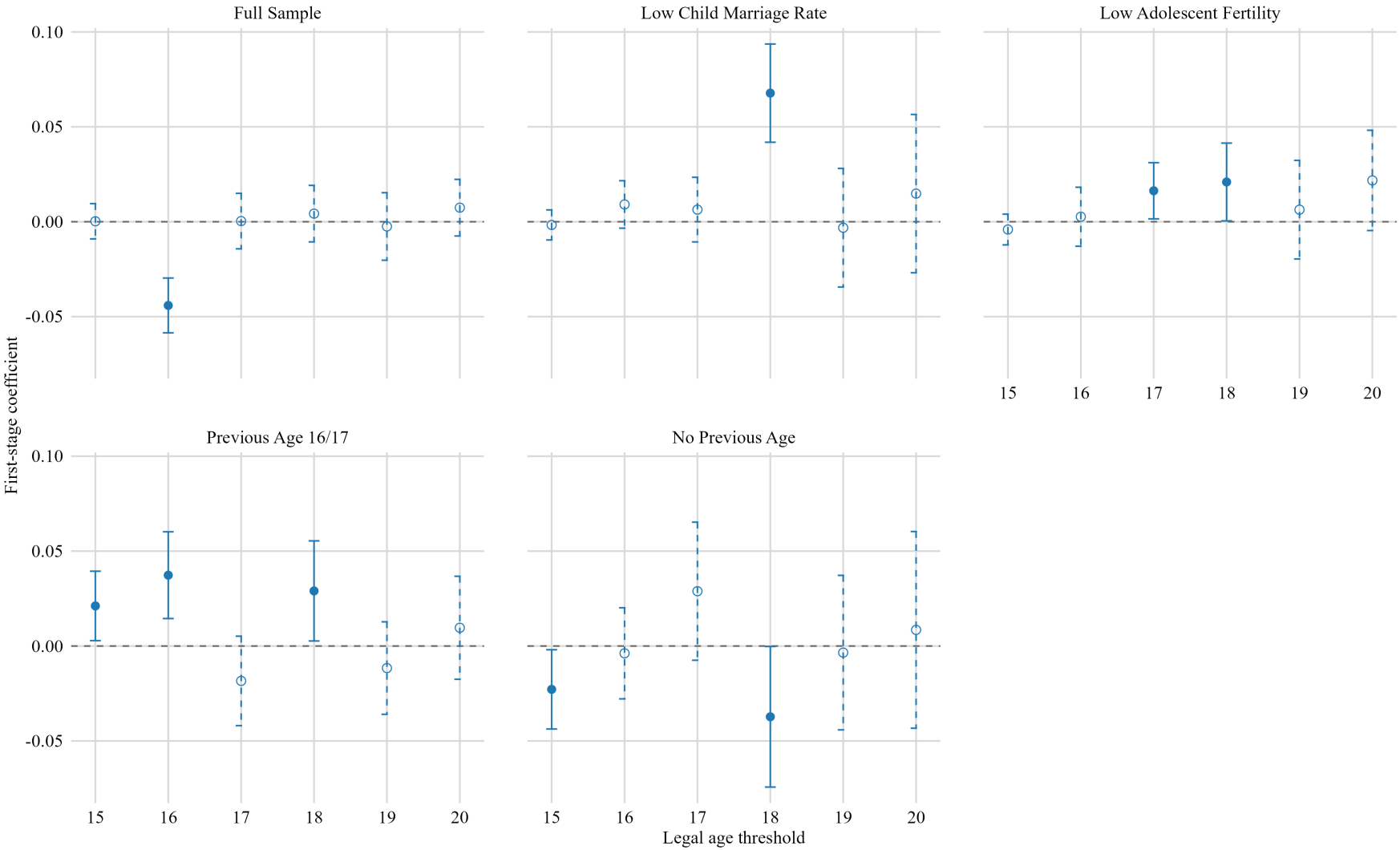
Notes: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05, $^{+}$ p<0.1. Estimates are robust bias-corrected RDD coefficients (SE in parentheses) of CMB eligibility on not marrying before age 18, using Calonico et al. (2014)'s CER-optimal bandwidth (bwselect = cerrd) in place of the baseline MSE-optimal bandwidth. Mean refers to the weighted control group mean of the outcome within the estimation bandwidth. N (Left)/N (Right) are effective observations within the bandwidth on each side of the cutoff. BW: Bandwidth (months).

Table A38: Effect of CMBs on Marrying in Adulthood (Local Quadratic, First Stage)

Subsample	Estimate (SE)	Mean	p-value	N (Left)	N (Right)	BW
Full Sample	0.006 (0.009)	0.661	0.478	134,414	104,801	74.1
Ever Married	0.018 (0.011)	0.585	0.120	90,317	67,857	60.0
Excluding Pregnancy-Driven	0.017 (0.010)	0.678	0.106	84,707	72,482	53.8
Rural	0.018 (0.013)	0.587	0.157	65,397	51,848	64.2
Urban	0.005 (0.015)	0.764	0.737	41,874	36,220	54.2
Age 18–24	0.023 (0.016)	0.628	0.157	28,619	33,443	44.3
Age 25–34	0.029 (0.024)	0.693	0.230	17,782	15,744	21.3
Age 35+	-0.021 (0.045)	0.725	0.639	7,798	3,504	34.0
No Primary Education	-0.008 (0.019)	0.442	0.677	37,408	23,810	67.2
Primary Education	0.013 (0.010)	0.754	0.201	77,570	68,843	62.7
Not Literate	0.000 (0.014)	0.487	0.995	69,614	45,469	85.8
Literate	0.005 (0.010)	0.791	0.587	61,359	56,335	76.5
Poor (Median)	0.015 (0.011)	0.570	0.179	90,857	62,585	98.9
Non-Poor (Median)	0.001 (0.012)	0.741	0.945	54,157	45,538	60.5
Poor (75P)	0.010 (0.010)	0.605	0.291	117,036	86,198	85.4
Non-Poor (75P)	0.003 (0.015)	0.806	0.863	29,039	24,005	64.9
Christian	0.001 (0.015)	0.693	0.959	40,797	34,177	54.8
Muslim	0.032* (0.014)	0.693	0.019	48,559	40,077	60.7
Low Child Marriage Rate	0.038** (0.014)	0.817	0.006	35,467	27,677	64.5
Medium Child Marriage Rate	0.020 (0.018)	0.688	0.258	30,710	25,756	46.3
High Child Marriage Rate	-0.023 (0.016)	0.469	0.166	49,954	38,099	86.0
Previous Age 16/17	0.023+ (0.013)	0.641	0.087	51,876	34,101	71.8
Previous Age 14/15	0.017 (0.015)	0.677	0.239	44,989	40,082	56.5
No Previous Age	-0.031 (0.024)	0.680	0.199	13,941	14,189	52.2
Low Adolescent Fertility	0.029* (0.015)	0.790	0.047	36,253	29,538	43.6
High Adolescent Fertility	-0.002 (0.013)	0.544	0.877	67,130	55,644	70.7
Autocracy	0.032 (0.028)	0.604	0.253	19,401	14,945	55.2
Anocracy	0.003 (0.010)	0.647	0.740	109,002	78,864	95.4
Democracy	0.030 (0.023)	0.731	0.200	10,216	10,032	38.1
Low GDP p.c.	0.021 (0.017)	0.585	0.221	37,189	34,291	44.8
High GDP p.c.	0.002 (0.010)	0.728	0.884	95,561	64,206	96.8
Low Gov. Effectiveness	0.057** (0.019)	0.600	0.003	29,791	27,169	38.3
High Gov. Effectiveness	-0.006 (0.011)	0.724	0.576	80,253	56,729	77.8
Low Rule of Law	0.029 (0.019)	0.633	0.115	30,318	27,358	45.1
High Rule of Law	-0.001 (0.012)	0.687	0.950	69,090	54,802	61.1
Low Primary Ed. Completion	-0.005 (0.013)	0.598	0.728	61,280	50,360	72.7
High Primary Ed. Completion	0.018 (0.012)	0.726	0.142	59,523	46,137	62.2

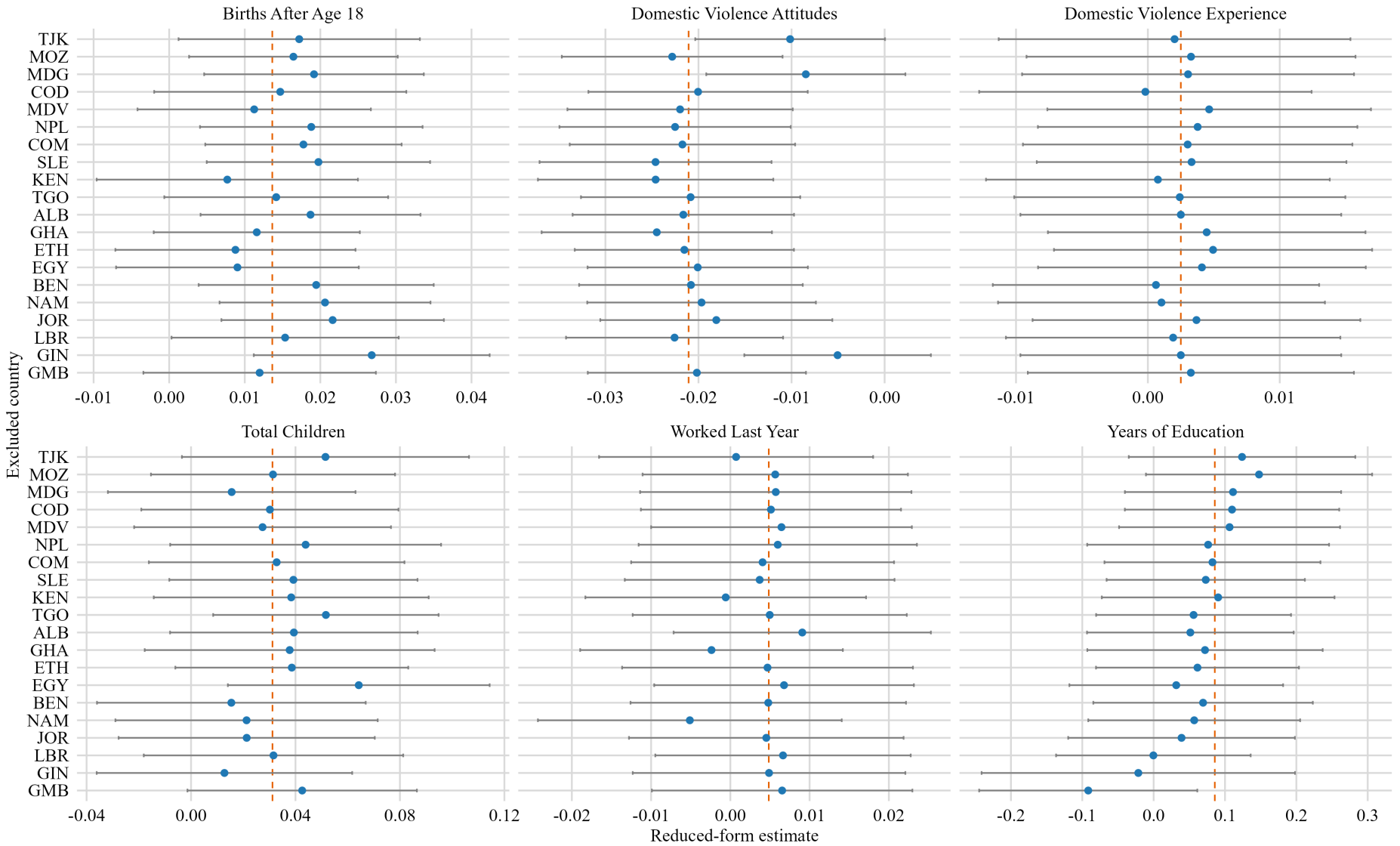
Notes: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05, + p<0.1. Estimates are robust bias-corrected RDD coefficients (SE in parentheses) of CMB eligibility on not marrying before age 18, using Calonico et al. (2014), with a local quadratic polynomial (p = 2) in the running variable in place of the baseline local linear specification. Mean refers to the weighted control group mean of the outcome within the estimation bandwidth. N (Left)/N (Right) are effective observations within the bandwidth on each side of the cutoff. BW: Bandwidth (months).

Figure A5: First Stage: Robustness to the Legal Age Threshold



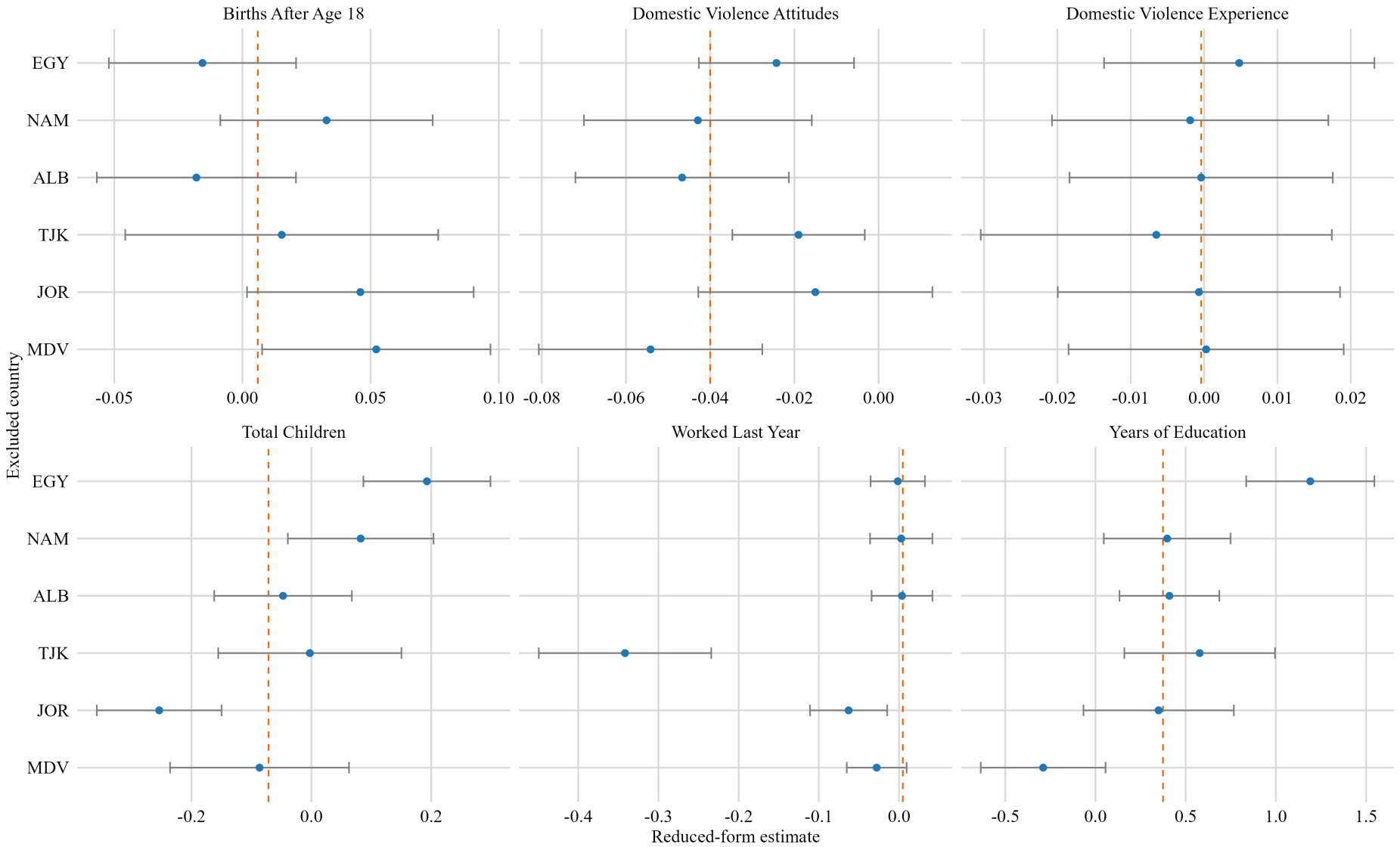
Notes: Each point is the robust bias-corrected local-linear RDD coefficient (Calonico et al., 2014) for the probability of marrying at or after the legal age threshold shown on the x-axis (i.e., not marrying before age 18), estimated separately at each threshold within each subsample within the MSE-optimal bandwidth. Vertical bars are 95% confidence intervals. All regressions control for rural residence, religion, and country and survey-year fixed effects, and cluster standard errors at the primary sampling unit level. Solid lines and filled markers denote significance at the 5% level, dashed lines and hollow markers denote non-significance. Panels report the full sample and the four subsamples with a significant first stage at the age-18 cutoff in the main specification.

Figure A6: Leave-One-Country-Out: Full Sample



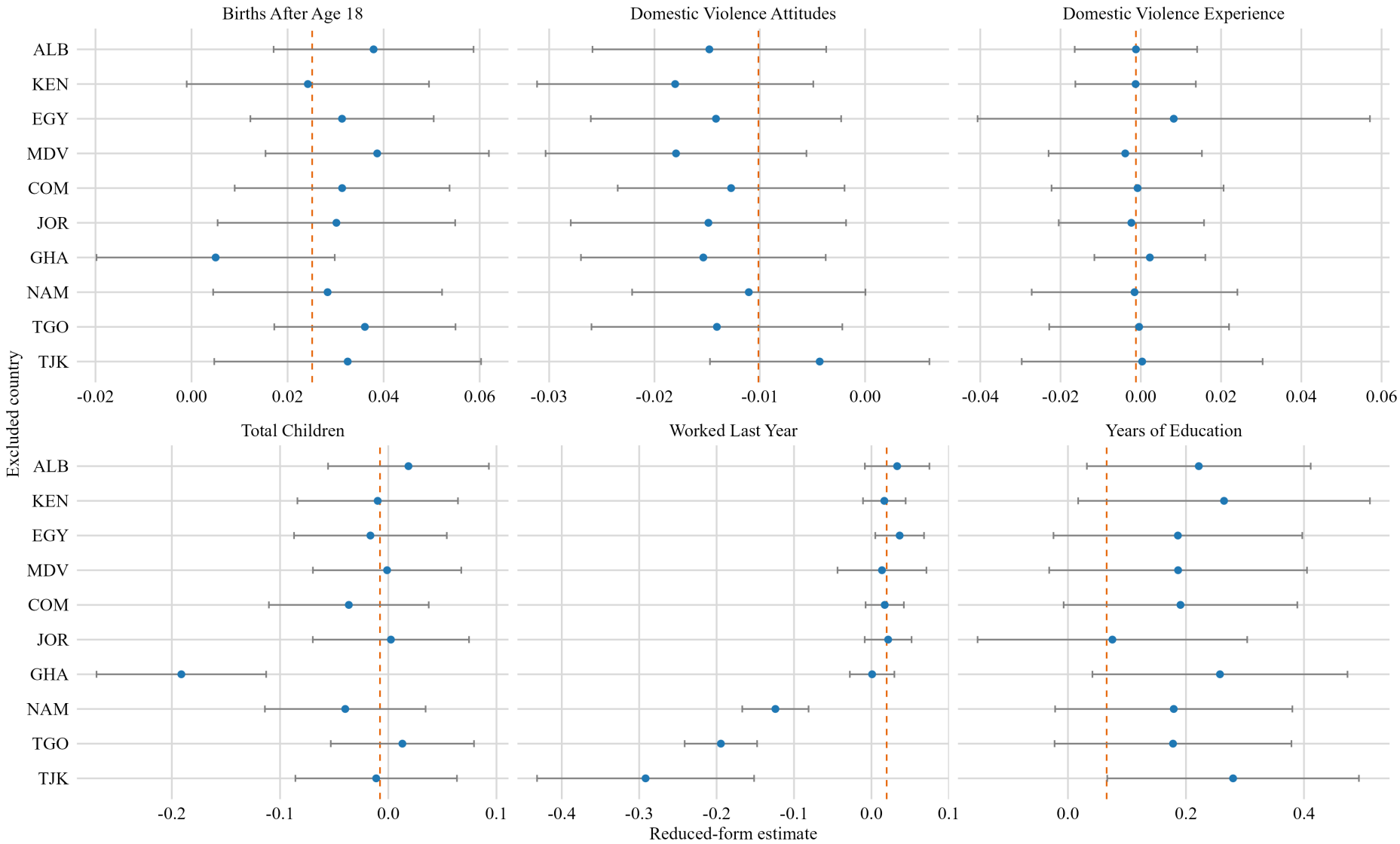
Notes: Each panel re-estimates the reduced-form effect of CMB eligibility on the labelled outcome, dropping one country at a time from the estimation sample. Points are the point estimate excluding that country; horizontal bars are 95% confidence intervals. The dashed line is the baseline estimate using all countries.

Figure A7: Leave-One-Country-Out: Low Child Marriage Rate



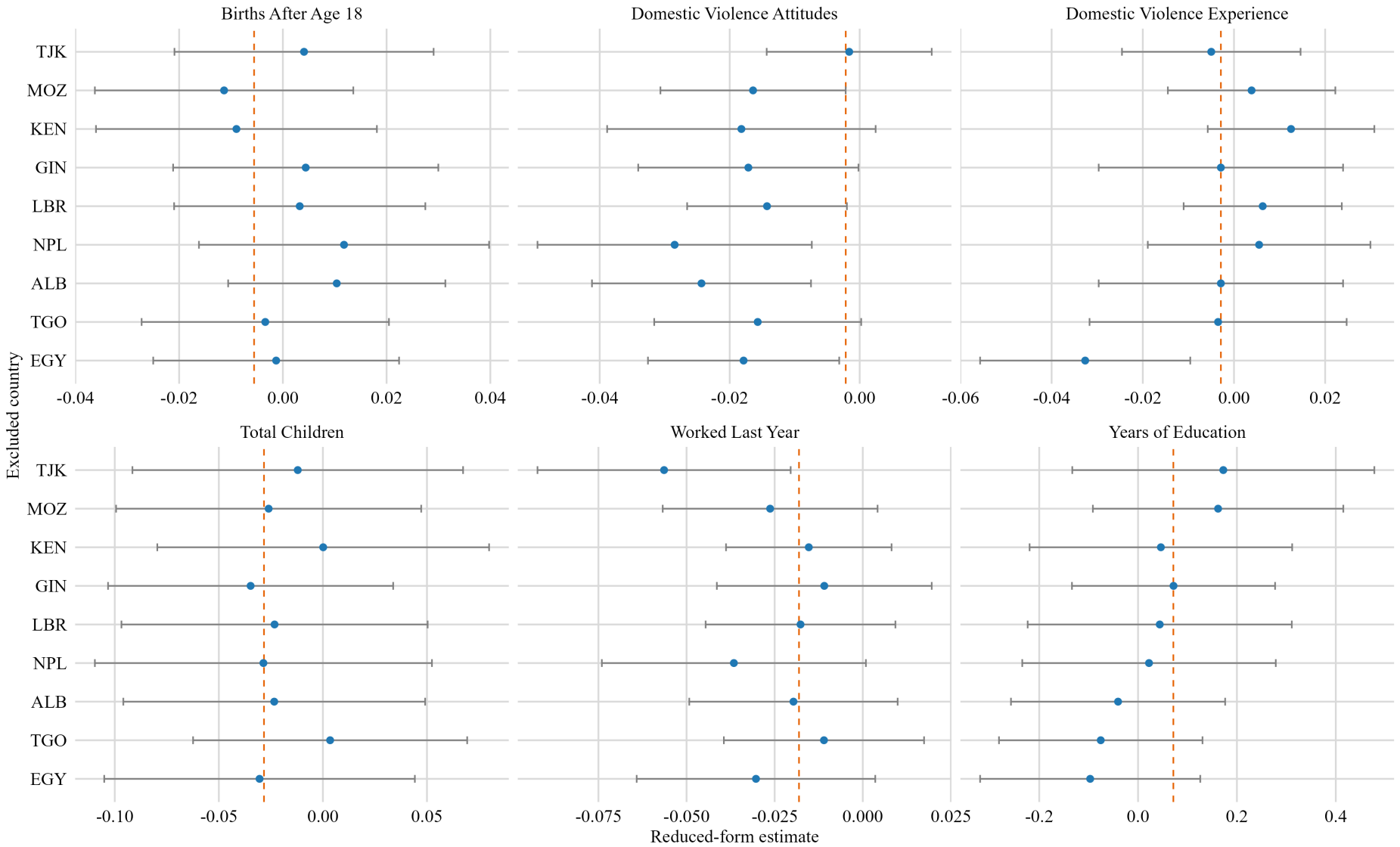
Notes: Each panel re-estimates the reduced-form effect of CMB eligibility on the labelled outcome, dropping one country at a time from the estimation sample. Points are the point estimate excluding that country; horizontal bars are 95% confidence intervals. The dashed line is the baseline estimate using all countries.

Figure A8: Leave-One-Country-Out: Low Adolescent Fertility



Notes: Each panel re-estimates the reduced-form effect of CMB eligibility on the labelled outcome, dropping one country at a time from the estimation sample. Points are the point estimate excluding that country; horizontal bars are 95% confidence intervals. The dashed line is the baseline estimate using all countries.

Figure A9: Leave-One-Country-Out: Previous Age 16/17



Notes: Each panel re-estimates the reduced-form effect of CMB eligibility on the labelled outcome, dropping one country at a time from the estimation sample. Points are the point estimate excluding that country; horizontal bars are 95% confidence intervals. The dashed line is the baseline estimate using all countries.